

RTL Design Sherpa

Bridge Hardware Architecture Specification 2.0

October 13, 2026

Table of Contents

1 Bridge Has Index....24

2 Bridge Micro-Architecture Specification Index....25

2.1 Overview....26

2.1.1 Key Features....26

2.1.2 Protocol Conversion Matrix....26

2.1.3 Design Philosophy....27

2.2 Design Notes....28

2.2.1 Version History....28

2.3 References....29

2.3.1 Visual Assets....29

2.3.2 Companion Specifications....29

2.3.3 Project-Level....29

2.3.4 Generator....29

2.4 Navigation....31

2.4.1 Document Organization....31

2.4.2 Quick Navigation....32

3 Bridge: AXI4 Full Crossbar Generator - Product Requirements Document....33

3.1 Executive Summary....34

3.2 Design Philosophy....35

3.2.1 Core Principles....35

3.2.2 Architecture Philosophy....36

3.3 CRITICAL: RTL Regeneration Requirements....38

3.4 1. Product Overview..... 39
3.4.1 1.1 Purpose..... 39
3.4.2 1.2 Target Audience..... 39
3.4.3 1.3 Success Criteria..... 39
3.4.4 1.4 Implementation Status and Phases..... 40
3.5 2. Architecture Overview..... 42
3.5.1 2.1 AXI4 vs AXIS vs APB..... 42
3.5.2 2.2 Block Diagram..... 43
3.5.3 2.3 Key Components..... 44
3.6 3. Functional Requirements..... 45
3.6.1 3.1 AXI4 Protocol Compliance..... 45
3.6.2 3.2 Address Decoding..... 45
3.6.3 3.3 Arbitration Strategy..... 46
3.6.4 3.4 Burst Handling..... 46
3.7 4. Non-Functional Requirements..... 47
3.7.1 4.1 Performance..... 47
3.7.2 4.2 Resource Usage (Measured)..... 47
3.7.3 4.3 Quality Requirements..... 48
3.8 5. Interface Specifications..... 49
3.8.1 5.1 AXI4 Master Interfaces (M × 5 channels)..... 49
3.8.2 5.2 AXI4 Slave Interfaces (S × 5 channels)..... 50
3.8.3 5.3 Configuration Is Generation-Time, Not Parameters..... 50
3.9 6. Performance Modeling..... 52
3.9.1 6.1 Analytical Model..... 52

3.9.2 6.2 Resource Scaling..... 52
3.9.3 6.3 Comparison with Other Crossbars..... 53
3.10 7. Generator Architecture..... 54
3.10.1 7.1 Python Generator Structure..... 54
3.10.2 7.2 Address Map Configuration..... 55
3.11 8. Comparison with APB and Delta..... 57
3.11.1 8.1 Code Reuse from APB Generator..... 57
3.11.2 8.2 Code Reuse from Delta Generator..... 57
3.11.3 8.3 Complexity Comparison..... 57
3.12 9. Use Cases..... 59
3.12.1 9.1 Multi-Core Processor Interconnect..... 59
3.12.2 9.2 DMA + Accelerator System..... 59
3.12.3 9.3 FPGA System Integration..... 59
3.13 10. Testing Strategy..... 60
3.13.1 10.1 FUB (Functional Unit Block) Tests..... 60
3.13.2 10.2 Integration Tests..... 60
3.13.3 10.3 Performance Validation..... 60
3.14 11. Documentation Plan..... 61
3.14.1 11.1 Specifications (Before Code)..... 61
3.14.2 11.2 Performance Analysis (Before Implementation)..... 61
3.14.3 11.3 Code Generation..... 61
3.14.4 11.4 Verification..... 61
3.15 12. Success Metrics..... 62
3.15.1 12.1 Functional Completeness..... 62

3.15.2 12.2 Performance Targets....62
3.15.3 12.3 Educational Value....62
3.15.4 12.4 Reusability....62
3.16 12.2 PDF Generation Location....63
3.17 13. Future Enhancements....64
3.17.1 13.1 Short-Term (Post-Initial Release)....64
3.17.2 13.2 Long-Term....64
3.18 14. Risk Assessment....65
3.19 15. Project Timeline (Estimated)....66
3.20 16. Glossary....67
3.21 References....68
4 Claude Code Guide: Bridge Subsystem....70
4.1 CRITICAL: Read Architecture Documents First....71
4.2 Quick Context....72
4.3 Target Architecture: Intelligent Width-Aware Routing....73
4.3.1 Efficient Multi-Width Design....73
4.3.2 Why This Architecture....73
4.3.3 Per-Master Output Paths....73
4.3.4 Benefits....74
4.3.5 Implementation Status....74
4.4 CRITICAL RULE #0: RTL Regeneration Requirements....75
4.5 Critical Pitfalls: slave_select_* Reversion After Handshake....77
4.5.1 The Problem: Combinational Address Decode....77
4.5.2 Visible Symptoms....77

4.5.3 The Solution (MANDATORY in All Generators)....77
4.5.4 When This Bug Appears....78
4.6 MANDATORY: Project Organization Pattern....79
4.6.1 Required Directory Structure....79
4.6.2 Testbench Class Location (MANDATORY)....80
4.6.3 Test File Pattern (MANDATORY)....80
4.7 Critical Rules for This Subsystem....81
4.7.1 Rule #0.1: Testbench Architecture - MANDATORY SEPARATION....81
4.7.2 Rule #1: TBBase and the three mandatory methods....81
4.7.3 Rule #3: Use GAXI Components for Protocol Handling....81
4.7.4 Rule #4: Queue-Based Verification....82
4.8 TOML/CSV-Based Bridge Generator (Phase 2 Complete)....83
4.8.1 Overview....83
4.8.2 Quick Start....83
4.8.3 Configuration Format Details....84
4.8.4 Channel-Specific Masters (Phase 2 Feature)....85
4.8.5 Example: RAPIDS-Style Configuration....85
4.8.6 Common User Questions....86
4.8.7 Generator Output Structure....89
4.8.8 Testing Generated Bridges....89
4.9 Bridge Architecture Quick Reference....91
4.9.1 Generated Bridge Crossbar Structure....91
4.9.2 Key Features....91
4.9.3 Address Map....92

4.10 Test Organization....93
4.10.1 Test Levels....93
4.11 Common User Questions and Responses....94
4.11.1 Q: “How does the Bridge work?”....94
4.11.2 Q: “How do I generate a Bridge?”....95
4.11.3 Q: “How do I test a Bridge?”....95
4.12 PDF Generation Location....96
5 Document Information....97
5.1 Bridge Hardware Architecture Specification....97
5.2 Revision History....98
5.3 Document Purpose....102
5.4 Intended Audience....103
5.5 Related Documents....104
6 Purpose and Scope....105
6.1 What is Bridge?....105
6.2 The Problem Bridge Solves....106
6.3 Scope....107
6.4 Out of Scope....108
7 Document Conventions....109
7.1 Terminology....109
7.2 Signal Naming....110
7.3 Diagrams....111
7.3.1 Figure 1.1: Block Diagram Legend....111
7.4 Code Examples....112

7.5 Parameter Notation....113
8 Definitions and Acronyms....114
8.1 Acronyms....114
8.2 Definitions....116
9 Use Cases....117
9.1 Primary Applications....117
9.1.1 SoC Interconnects....117
9.1.2 Memory Systems....117
9.1.3 Accelerator Systems....117
9.2 Example: RAPIDS Accelerator....118
9.2.1 Figure 2.1: RAPIDS System Topology....118
9.2.2 Configuration....118
9.2.3 Benefits....118
9.3 Rapid Prototyping....120
10 Key Features....121
10.1 Configuration-Driven Generation....121
10.1.1 CSV/TOML Configuration....121
10.1.2 Example Configuration....121
10.2 Multi-Protocol Support....122
10.2.1 Protocol Features....123
10.3 Channel-Specific Masters....124
10.3.1 Write-Only Masters (wr)....124
10.3.2 Read-Only Masters (rd)....124
10.3.3 Full Masters (rw)....124

10.3.4 Resource Savings....124
10.4 Automatic Converters....125
10.4.1 Width Conversion....125
10.4.2 Protocol Conversion....125
10.5 Flexible Topology....126
10.5.1 Scalability....126
10.5.2 Mixed Configurations....126
11 System Context....127
11.1 Bridge in SoC Architecture....127
11.1.1 Figure 2.2: Bridge System Context....127
11.2 Interface Boundaries....128
11.2.1 Master-Side (Upstream)....128
11.2.2 Slave-Side (Downstream)....128
11.3 Address Space....129
11.3.1 Address Map Organization....129
11.3.2 Address Decode....129
11.4 Clock and Reset....130
11.4.1 Clock Domain....130
11.4.2 Reset....130
11.5 Dependencies....131
11.5.1 Required Infrastructure....131
11.5.2 Optional Features....131
11.6 References....132
12 Block Diagram....133

12.1 Bridge Architecture Overview....133
12.1.1 Figure 3.1: Bridge Block Diagram....133
12.2 Functional Blocks....134
12.2.1 Master Adapter....134
12.2.2 Crossbar Core....134
12.2.3 Slave Adapter....134
12.3 Data Flow....135
12.3.1 Figure 3.2: Write Path....135
12.3.2 Figure 3.3: Read Path....136
12.4 Scalability....137
12.4.1 Topology Parameters....137
12.4.2 Resource Scaling....137
12.5 References....138
13 Data Flow....139
13.1 Transaction Flow Overview....139
13.1.1 Write Transaction Flow....139
13.1.2 Read Transaction Flow....139
13.2 Channel Independence....140
13.2.1 AXI4 Channel Separation....140
13.2.2 Parallel Operation....140
13.3 Bridge ID and ID Widening....141
13.3.1 Bridge ID (BID) Concept....141
13.3.2 IDs are widened inside the fabric....141
13.4 Response Routing....142

13.4.1 B Channel (Write Response)....142
13.4.2 R Channel (Read Data)....142
13.4.3 The requirement the FIFO form creates....143
13.5 Ordering: what the fabric actually guarantees....144
13.6 References....145
14 Protocol Support....146
14.1 Supported Protocols....146
14.1.1 AXI4 Full....146
14.1.2 AXI4-Lite....146
14.1.3 AXI3....146
14.1.4 APB (Advanced Peripheral Bus)....146
14.2 Protocol Conversion Matrix....148
14.3 Automatic Conversion Shims at Slave Boundary....150
14.4 Automatic Conversion at the Master Boundary....151
14.5 AXI4 to APB Conversion....153
14.5.1 Conversion Process....153
14.5.2 Figure 3.4: AXI4 to APB Conversion Sequence....153
14.5.3 Burst Handling....153
14.5.4 Timing Considerations....153
14.6 Width Conversion....154
14.6.1 Upsize (Narrow to Wide)....154
14.6.2 Figure 3.5: Width Upsize Conversion....154
14.6.3 Downsize (Wide to Narrow)....155
14.6.4 Figure 3.6: Width Downsize Conversion....155

14.7 Channel-Specific Protocol....156
14.7.1 Write-Only Masters....156
14.7.2 Read-Only Masters....156
14.8 ACE and Coherency — Explicitly Out of Scope....157
14.9 References....158
15 AXI4 Interface Overview....159
15.1 Interface Organization....159
15.1.1 Master-Side Interfaces....159
15.1.2 Slave-Side Interfaces....159
15.2 Signal Naming Convention....161
15.2.1 Custom Prefixes....161
15.2.2 ID Width Extension....161
15.3 Channel-Specific Interfaces....162
15.3.1 Write-Only Master (wr)....162
15.3.2 Read-Only Master (rd)....162
15.4 Monitor Bus Output (when variants includes mon)....163
15.5 Handshake Protocol....164
15.5.1 Valid/Ready Handshake....164
15.5.2 Backpressure....164
15.6 Burst Support....165
15.6.1 Supported Burst Types....165
15.6.2 Burst Length....165
16 APB Interface....166
16.1 Overview....166

16.2 Ports....167
16.2.1 Signal Definition....167
16.2.2 Signal Naming....167
16.3 Functional Description....168
16.3.1 AXI4 to APB Conversion....168
16.3.2 Burst Handling....168
16.3.3 Error Mapping....168
16.4 Timing....169
16.5 Waveforms....170
16.5.1 Write Transaction....170
16.5.2 Read Transaction....170
16.6 APB Requester Ports....171
16.7 Design Notes....172
17 Clock and Reset....173
17.1 Overview....173
17.2 Ports....174
17.2.1 Clock....174
17.2.2 Reset....174
17.3 Functional Description....175
17.3.1 One Fabric Clock....175
17.3.2 Clock Domain Crossing: CDC Slave Ports....175
17.3.3 Reset Behavior....177
17.3.4 Reset Effects....177
17.3.5 Outstanding Transactions....177

17.3.6 Reset Release....177
17.4 Timing....178
17.4.1 Setup and Hold....178
17.4.2 Clock-to-Output....178
17.5 Usage Example....179
17.5.1 Recommended Constraints....179
17.6 Design Notes....180
17.6.1 External CDC Required....180
17.6.2 CDC Recommendations....180
18 AXI5 and APB5 Interfaces (AMBA5 Support)....181
18.1 Overview....181
18.2 Parameters....182
18.2.1 Declaring AMBA5 Ports....182
18.3 Ports....183
18.3.1 AXI5 Port Surface....183
18.3.2 APB5 Slave Surface....184
18.3.3 AXI5-Lite Master Surface....184
18.3.4 APB5 Master Surface....185
18.3.5 AXI5-Lite Slave Surface....185
18.4 Functional Description....187
18.4.1 Interop Matrix....189
19 Unmapped-Address Handling....190
19.1 Overview....190
19.1.1 Why the bridge answers an address no slave owns....190

19.2 Ports....191
19.2.1 Status, interrupt and clearing....191
19.3 Functional Description....192
19.3.1 Behaviour....192
19.3.2 Register access (cfg regblock builds)....192
19.3.3 When it can never fire....193
19.3.4 What this does not do....193
19.4 Navigation....194
20 Wishbone B4 Interface....195
20.1 Overview....195
20.2 Ports....196
20.2.1 Signal Definition....196
20.2.2 Signal Naming....197
20.3 Functional Description....198
20.3.1 Slave port: AXI4 to Wishbone....198
20.3.2 Master port: Wishbone to AXI4....198
20.3.3 Rules the validator enforces....198
20.4 Design Notes....199
21 Throughput Characteristics....200
21.1 Overview....200
21.2 Functional Description....201
21.2.1 Peak Throughput....201
21.2.2 Formula....201
21.2.3 Measured (2026-09-11)....201

21.2.4 Factors Affecting Throughput....202
21.2.5 Multi-Master Scaling....203
21.2.6 Burst Efficiency....203
21.2.7 Width Conversion Impact....203
21.2.8 Protocol Conversion Impact....204
21.3 Design Notes....205
21.4 References....206
22 Latency Analysis....207
22.1 Overview....207
22.2 Timing....208
22.2.1 Address Path Latency....208
22.2.2 Data Path Latency....208
22.2.3 Response Path Latency....208
22.2.4 Loaded Write Latency (measured)....209
22.2.5 End-to-End Latency....210
22.2.6 Width Conversion Latency....211
22.2.7 Protocol Conversion Latency....211
22.3 Design Notes....212
22.3.1 Design Recommendations....212
22.4 References....213
23 Resources....214
23.1 Overview....214
23.2 Measured Utilization and Timing....215
23.2.1 Scaling....217

23.3 Design Notes....218
23.3.1 Resource Reduction....218
23.3.2 Performance/Resource Trade-off....218
23.4 References....219
24 System Requirements....220
24.1 Overview....220
24.1.1 Clock Infrastructure....220
24.1.2 Reset Infrastructure....220
24.1.3 Power....220
24.2 Parameters....221
24.2.1 Address Map....221
24.2.2 Connectivity....221
24.3 Ports....222
24.3.1 Master Requirements....222
24.3.2 Slave Requirements....222
24.4 Timing....223
24.4.1 Setup/Hold....223
24.4.2 Recommended Margins....223
24.5 Testing....224
24.5.1 Pre-Integration Checks....224
24.5.2 Integration Checks....224
24.5.3 Post-Integration Checks....224
24.6 Assumptions and Known Limitations....225
24.6.1 Response-Ordering Assumption....225

24.6.2 Buffer and CAM Depths....225
24.7 References....226
25 Parameter Configuration....227
25.1 Overview....227
25.2 Parameters....228
25.2.1 Core Parameters....228
25.2.2 Registered Crossbar (xbar_pipeline)....228
25.2.3 Derived Parameters....231
25.2.4 Per-Port Configuration....232
25.2.5 Top-Level Monitor Configuration....234
25.2.6 Parameter Validation....235
25.3 Usage Example....236
25.3.1 TOML Configuration....236
25.3.2 CSV Connectivity....236
25.3.3 Simple 2x2....236
25.3.4 Mixed Protocol....237
26 Verification Strategy....238
26.1 Overview....238
26.2 Testing....239
26.2.1 Verification Levels....239
26.2.2 Test Infrastructure....240
26.2.3 Test Execution Model....241
26.2.4 Coverage Goals....241
26.2.5 Debug Features....242

26.2.6 Regression Testing....243
26.2.7 Known Limitations....243
27 Synthesis and Implementation....245
27.1 Overview....245
27.2 The Flow....246
27.2.1 Where it lives....246
27.2.2 How the bridge is constrained....247
27.2.3 Reading the summary line....247
27.3 Measured Results....249
27.3.1 What the first run found....249
27.3.2 The reference set....249
27.3.3 Reading the rows....251
27.4 Design Notes....253
27.4.1 What moves the numbers....253
27.4.2 Before a board build....253
28 AXI3 Integration....254
28.1 Boundary-Conversion Architecture....254
28.2 Converter-Sourced Constraints....255
28.3 Validation Evidence....256
28.3.1 Configuration constraints....256
28.4 References....257

List of Figures

Figure 1.1: Block Diagram Legend....110
Figure 2.1: RAPIDS System Topology....117
Figure 2.2: Bridge System Context....126
Figure 3.1: Bridge Block Diagram....132
Figure 3.2: Write Path....134
Figure 3.3: Read Path....135
Figure 3.4: AXI4 to APB Conversion Sequence....152
Figure 3.5: Width Upsize Conversion....153
Figure 3.6: Width Downsize Conversion....154
Figure 4.1: Clock Distribution....174
Figure 4.2: Reset Timing....176
Figure 4.3: Multi-Clock CDC....179

List of Tables

Table 1: Table 1.1: Common Terminology....108
Table 2: Table 1.2: Signal Naming Prefixes....109
Table 3: Table 1.3: Block Diagram Symbols....110
Table 4: Table 1.4: Parameter Format Example....112
Table 5: Table 1.5: Acronyms and Abbreviations....113
Table 6: Table 2.1: Supported Protocols....121
Table 7: Table 2.2: Channel-Specific Resource Savings....123
Table 8: Table 2.3: Address Map Organization....128
Table 9: Table 3.1: Topology Parameter Scaling....136
Table 10: Table 3.2: AXI4 Channel Summary....139
Table 11: Table 3.3: Protocol Conversion Matrix....147
Table 12: Table 3.4: Slave-port protocol values....149
Table 13: Table 3.5: Master-port protocol values....150
Table 14: Table 4.9: Master-Side Interface Channels....158
Table 15: Table 4.10: Slave-Side Interface Channels....159
Table 16: Table 4.11: Supported Burst Types....164
Table 17: Table 4.1: APB Signal Definitions....166
Table 18: Table 4.2: AXI4 to APB Burst Conversion....167
Table 19: Table 4.3: APB to AXI4 Error Mapping....167
Table 20: Table 4.4: Clock Requirements....173
Table 21: Table 4.5: Reset Signal....173
Table 22: Table 4.5a: CDC slave port clock pins (cdc = true)....175
Table 23: Table 4.6: Reset Effects....176
Table 24: Table 4.7: Timing Constraints....177
Table 25: Table 4.8: Clock-to-Output Delays....177
Table 26: AXI5-Lite sideband groups at an axil5 master boundary....184
Table 27: AXI5-Lite sideband groups at an axil5 slave boundary....185
Table 28: Unmapped-address status registers....191
Table 29: Table 4.7: Wishbone B4 Signal Definitions....195
Table 30: Table 4.8: Wishbone termination to AXI4 response....197
Table 31: Table 5.1: Peak Throughput by Data Width....200
Table 32: Table 5.1a: Measured throughput, direct 32-bit AXI4 paths....200
Table 33: Table 5.2: Factors Affecting Throughput....201
Table 34: Table 5.3: Burst Efficiency Comparison....202
Table 35: Table 5.4: AXI4 vs APB Protocol Impact....203
Table 36: Table 5.5: Address Path Latency....207

Table 37: Table 5.6: Data Path Latency....207
Table 38: Table 5.7: Response Path Latency....207
Table 39: Table 5.7a: Write latency under load, bridge_2x2_rw, 32-bit direct path 209
Table 40: Table 5.8: Upsize Latency by Ratio....210
Table 41: Table 5.9: Downsize Latency by Ratio....210
Table 42: Table 5.10: AXI4 to APB Conversion Latency....210
Table 43: Table 5.11: Measured utilization and timing, Artix-7 100T -1 at 10 ns (HAS 6.4 flow)....214
Table 44: Table 5.12: Measured utilization and timing, Kintex-7 325T -2 at 6.667 ns 214
Table 45: Table 5.13: Resource Scaling....216
Table 46: Table 5.14: Performance/Resource Trade-offs....217
Table 47: Table 6.1: Clock Requirements....219
Table 48: Table 6.2: Reset Requirements....219
Table 49: Table 6.3: Power Requirements....219
Table 50: Table 6.4: Address Map Requirements....220
Table 51: Table 6.5: Connectivity Requirements....220
Table 52: Table 6.6: Timing Requirements....222
Table 53: Table 6.7: Recommended Timing Margins....222
Table 54: Table 6.8: Bridge Core Parameters....227
Table 55: Table 6.8a: Crossbar options (bridge TASK-006, was BRIDGE-017)....227
Table 56: Table 6.8b: CDC slave port option (bridge TASK-006, was BRIDGE-017) 229
Table 57: Table 6.8c: Monitor preset....229
Table 58: Table 6.9: Derived Parameters....231
Table 59: Table 6.10: Master Port Configuration....231
Table 60: Table 6.11: Slave Port Configuration....232
Table 61: Table 6.12: Generator Validation Checks....234
Table 62: Table 6.13: Unit Level Test Focus....238
Table 63: Table 6.14: Integration Test Coverage....238
Table 64: Table 6.15: System Level Tests....238
Table 65: Table 6.16: Test Categories....239
Table 66: Table 6.17: Functional Coverage Goals....240
Table 67: Table 6.18: Code Coverage Goals....241
Table 68: Table 6.19: Debug Signals....241
Table 69: Table 6.20: CI Test Schedule....242
Table 70: Table 6.21: Configuration Test Matrix....242

Table 71: Table 6.22: Known Test Gaps....242
Table 72: Table 6.23: Simulator Support Status....242
Table 73: Table 6.24: Synthesis flow knobs....245
Table 74: Table 6.25: summary.csv columns....246
Table 75: Table 6.26: The CAM ordering-count scan, before and after (2026-09-11) 248
Table 76: Table 6.27: Reference set on the Artix-7 100T -1 (Nexys A7), constrained at 10 ns....248
Table 77: Table 6.28: Reference set on the Kintex-7 325T -2 (Genesys 2), constrained at 6.667 ns....249

1 Bridge Has Index

Generated: 2026-10-13

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

2 Bridge Micro-Architecture Specification Index

Component: Bridge (Multi-Protocol Crossbar Generator) **Version:** 2.0 **Date:** 2026-10-12 **Purpose:** Detailed micro-architecture specification for Bridge component

---

2.1 Overview

Bridge is a TOML-driven generator that produces AXI4 crossbars with automatic width conversion, protocol conversion (AXI3, AXI4, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI5-Lite, APB, APB5, Wishbone B4 — per-port, on slave or master sides; ACE coherency is NOT supported), and channel-specific masters (read-only, write-only, or full). This is the internals document — the one you open when you need to know what the generated RTL actually does, block by block, rather than what the brochure says.

2.1.1 Key Features

- **Multi-Protocol Support:** AXI4, AXI3, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI5-Lite, APB, APB5, and Wishbone B4 conversion, on slave or master ports (ACE coherency NOT supported)
- **CSV-Driven Configuration:** Human-readable port and connectivity definitions
- **Channel-Specific Masters:** Write-only (wr), read-only (rd), or full (rw) support
- **Automatic Width Conversion:** Upsize/downsize for data width mismatches
- **Out-of-Order Support:** per slave. A multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slave (or any `enable_ooo` slave) is tracked by `bridge_cam` keyed on the fabric ID `{BRIDGE_ID, id}` and may complete IDs in any order; single-master bridges and shim slaves use an in-order bridge_id FIFO and must answer in request order (bridge BUG-008, was BRIDGE-010)
- **Custom Signal Prefixes:** Unique prefixes per port for clean integration

That out-of-order bullet is the one people skim past and regret. The bridge never sorts responses back into order: a CAM-tracked slave is routed by ID, but a FIFO-tracked slave is routed by position, so there the trust has to be mutual.

2.1.2 Protocol Conversion Matrix

What happens to a transaction depends on the master/slave protocol pairing:

Master Protocol	Slave Protocol	Conversion
AXI4	AXI4	Direct or width convert
AXI4	AXI3	`axi4_to_axi3` protocol convert; same data width
AXI3	AXI4	`axi3_to_axi4`

Master Protocol	Slave Protocol	Conversion
		protocol convert; same data width
AXI4	AXI4-Lite	Protocol downgrade
AXI4	APB	Full protocol conversion

2.1.3 Design Philosophy

Efficient Multi-Width Routing: - Direct connections where widths match (zero conversion overhead) - Width converters only where needed - No fixed internal crossbar width

Resource Optimization: - Channel-specific masters reduce port count by 40-60% - Per-path width converters instead of global conversion - Minimal logic for matching-width connections

2.2 Design Notes

2.2.1 Version History

Version 1.2 (2026-09-07): qc round_1/round_2 correctness pass. Retired the ID-extension architecture from every page that claimed it (IDs are pass-through; responses route by an in-order `bridge_id` FIFO – see bridge BUG-008 (was BRIDGE-010) for the ordering requirement that creates). Corrected the out-of-range responder against `axi4_subtractive_slave` (RLAST on the final beat only, DECERR, 0xDEADBEEF), the monbus group instantiation, the transaction timeout that does not exist, and the strobe-mapping example. Documented the subtractive catch-all and its status/IRQ path.

2026-10-13: the ID-extension retirement above was itself overtaken by bridge TASK-005: IDs ARE widened to `{BRIDGE_ID, id}` with more than one master, and multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slaves track responses in `bridge_cam`. Chapters 2.1, 2.2, 2.5, 2.8, 2.9, 3.2, 4 and 6.1 were corrected to the generated RTL; figure numbers were made unique.

Version 1.1 (2026-06-04): content sync to RTL state at that date.

Version 1.0 (2026-01-03): - Initial specification release - Restructured from single spec to HAS/MAS format - Complete block-level documentation - FSM and ID management details

2.3 References

2.3.1 Visual Assets

Diagram sources and their renders live in two directories:

- **Source Files:**
  - `assets/graphviz/*.dot` - Graphviz source diagrams
  - `assets/puml/*.puml` - PlantUML FSM diagrams
- **Rendered Files:**
  - `assets/graphviz/*.png` - Rendered block diagrams
  - `assets/puml/*.png` - Rendered FSM diagrams

2.3.1.1 Architecture Diagrams

1. **Master Adapter** - assets/graphviz/master_adapter.png
2. **Slave Router** - assets/graphviz/slave_router.png
3. **Crossbar Core** - assets/graphviz/crossbar_core.png
4. **ID Management** - assets/graphviz/id_management.png
5. **Width Conversion** - assets/graphviz/width_conversion.png
6. **Protocol Conversion** - assets/graphviz/protocol_conversion_apb.png
7. **Response Routing** - assets/graphviz/response_routing.png
8. **Error Handling** - assets/graphviz/error_handling.png

2.3.1.2 FSM Diagrams

1. **AW Arbiter FSM** - assets/puml/aw_arbiter_fsm.png
2. **AR Arbiter FSM** - assets/puml/ar_arbiter_fsm.png

2.3.2 Companion Specifications

- **Bridge HAS** - Hardware Architecture Specification (high-level)

2.3.3 Project-Level

- **PRD.md:** ../../PRD.md - Complete product requirements document
- **CLAUDE.md:** ../../CLAUDE.md - AI assistant integration guide

2.3.4 Generator

- **Generator:** `../../bin/bridge_generator.py` - CSV/TOML-based generator script (with `../../bin/bridge_pkg/`)

- **Test Configs:** `../../bin/test_configs/` - Example TOML/CSV configurations

2.4 Navigation

2.4.1 Document Organization

Each chapter below is one source file.

2.4.1.1 Front Matter

- Document Information

2.4.1.2 Chapter 1: Introduction

- Overview

2.4.1.3 Chapter 2: Block Descriptions

- Master Adapter
- Slave Router
- Crossbar Core
- Arbitration
- ID Management
- Width Conversion
- Protocol Conversion
- Response Routing
- Error Handling
- AMBA5 Boundary and Native Sideband

2.4.1.4 Chapter 3: FSM Design

- Arbiter FSMs
- Transaction Tracking

2.4.1.5 Chapter 4: ID Management

- CAM Architecture – `bridge_cam` as instantiated in multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slave adapters; the sections marked historical were never built
- ID Tracking Tables

2.4.1.6 Chapter 5: Converters

- Width Converters
- APB Converters

2.4.1.7 Chapter 6: Generated RTL

- Module Structure

- Signal Naming

2.4.1.8 Chapter 7: Verification

- Test Strategy
- Debug Guide

2.4.2 Quick Navigation

2.4.2.1 For New Users

1. Start with Overview for a tour of what Bridge can do
2. Read Block Diagram for the architecture
3. Study Arbitration for operational details
4. Reference Module Structure for generated RTL

2.4.2.2 For Integration

- **Protocol support:** See Protocol Conversion for AXI4/AXI3/APB/AXI-Lite
- **Width handling:** See Width Conversion for data width mismatches
- **ID management:** See ID Management for transaction tracking
- **Error handling:** See Error Handling for OOR and timeout

Last Updated: 2026-10-11 **Maintained By:** RTL Design Sherpa Project

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

3 Bridge: AXI4 Full Crossbar Generator - Product Requirements Document

Project: Bridge **Version:** 2.2 **Status:** Phase 2 Complete - Simplified Architecture with Hard Limits
Created: 2025-10-18 **Last Updated:** 2026-09-13

3.1 Executive Summary

Bridge is a Python-based AXI4 crossbar generator that produces simple, performant SystemVerilog RTL for connecting multiple AXI4 masters to multiple AXI4 slaves. The name follows the infrastructure theme - bridges connect different regions, enabling communication across divides, just like crossbars connect masters and slaves.

Design Philosophy: A simple AMBA fabric that is performant, but makes no attempt to support all features. ID and address widths are PER PORT, set in the TOML (`id_width`, `addr_width`) – see §5.3, “Configuration Is Generation-Time, Not Parameters”. An earlier revision of this line claimed hard 8-bit/64-bit limits; the generator has never enforced them, and the shipped configs use 2-, 4- and 8-bit IDs.

Key Differentiator from Delta: - **Delta:** AXI-Stream crossbar (streaming data, single channel, simple routing) - **Bridge:** AXI4 full crossbar (memory-mapped, 5 channels, burst support, `bridge_id` sideband routing)

Key Differentiator from Commercial IP: - **Commercial AXI4 Crossbars:** Feature-complete, support every AXI4 edge case, complex configurability - **Bridge:** Simple and performant, supports common use cases, hard limits for simplicity

Target Use Case: High-performance memory-mapped interconnects for multi-core processors, accelerators, and memory controllers where simplicity and performance matter more than spec compliance.

3.2 Design Philosophy

Vision: A simple AMBA fabric that is performant, but makes no attempt to support all features.

3.2.1 Core Principles

1. Simplicity Over Completeness - Focus on common use cases, not edge cases - Implement what's needed for real hardware, not AXI4 spec compliance theater - Prefer straightforward implementations over complex feature sets

2. Performance First - Direct connections where possible (matching widths = zero overhead) - Minimal conversion logic in critical paths - Optimize for throughput and latency, not feature count

3. Hard Limits for Simplicity

We enforce uniform widths on certain parameters to eliminate complexity:

Parameter	Hard Limit	Rationale
ID Width	Per port, set at generation	NOT fixed at 8. The TOML sets `id_width` per port and the generated bridge bakes it in – `bridge_2x2_rw` has 4-bit IDs. This row previously said "8 bits (fixed)", which the generator has never enforced.
Address Width	Per port, set at generation	NOT fixed at 64. `bridge_2x2_rw` is a 32-bit-address bridge. Same correction as the row above.
Data Width	Variable (32b-512b)	Width converters ONLY for data. Commonly needed for bandwidth optimization.

Why This Works: - ID width conversion adds complexity with minimal benefit (nobody needs >256 outstanding transactions per master) - Address width conversion is rarely needed (peripheral addresses fit in 32-bit, but using 64-bit everywhere is simpler) - Data width conversion is the ONLY width conversion that provides real value (bandwidth matching)

4. What We DON'T Support (By Design)

Features intentionally excluded for simplicity: - (Both of these WERE excluded once and no longer are: ID width and address width are per-port generation inputs. Left here as history because the "design differentiator" argument above still cites them.) - ~~No AXI4-Lite protocol variant~~ – `axil` and `axil5` ARE supported, as slave protocols (converted at the boundary by `axi4_to_axil4_{rd,wr}` / `axi4_to_axil5_{rd,wr}`) and, since bridge TASK-004 (was BRIDGE-014), as master protocols (tied-off promotion plus the AXI5-Lite sideband surface). `apb` / `apb5` likewise work on both sides (`axi4_to_apb{4,5}_shim` at a slave, `apb{4,5}_to_axi4` at a master), Wishbone B4 since bridge TASK-008 (was BRIDGE-019) (`axi4_to_wb4` / `wb4_to_axi4`), and AXI3 (`axi4_to_axi3` at a slave, `axi3_to_axi4` at a master). - No ACE protocol extensions (cache coherency) - ~~No AXI5 features~~ – interop-mode AXI5 sideband, native sideband through the structs, atomics of every class and APB5/AXI5-Lite ports were delivered by bridge TASK-002 (was BRIDGE-002); what is NOT built is a fabric that is itself AXI5 (bridge TASK-007, was BRIDGE-018) - QoS, Region and REQUEST-side User (AWUSER/ARUSER/WUSER) are routed since `c2955863`/`2b229516`. RESPONSE-side User is not: `BUSER`/`RUSER` exist as ports but the master adapters tie them to zero (`.fub_axi_buser(1'b0)`, `.fub_axi_ruser(1'b0)`), so a slave's response User never reaches its master. An earlier correction of this line said "end to end", which was true only of the request side.

5. What We DO Support

Core AXI4 features that matter: - Full 5-channel AXI4 protocol (AW, W, B, AR, R) - Burst transactions (INCR, WRAP, FIXED) - In-order completion. Responses are routed by a per-master `bridge_id` sideband and an in-order FIFO, NOT by matching AXI IDs – see FR-2. - Multiple outstanding transactions per master, **to one slave at a time**. The generated master adapters carry a single-outstanding-target gate (`aw_gate_ok` / `ar_gate_ok`): a new AW/AR to a DIFFERENT slave is held off until the outstanding ones drain. - Channel-specific masters (write-only, read-only, read-write) - Data width conversion (32b ↔️ 64b ↔️ 128b ↔️ 256b ↔️ 512b) - Configurable M×N topology (1-32 masters, 1-256 slaves) - Fair round-robin arbitration per slave

3.2.2 Architecture Philosophy

Delivered: Intelligent width-aware routing, not a fixed-width crossbar. The generated adapters carry per-width paths and convert only at a mismatch.

OLD Approach (What We're Moving Away From):

```
Master (64b) → Upsize(64→256) → Fixed 256b Crossbar → Downsize(256→64)
→ Slave (64b)
```

- Two conversions for same-width connections (wasteful!)
- Artificial bandwidth bottleneck
- Unnecessary logic and latency

NEW Approach (Target Architecture):

```
Master (64b) → Direct Connection → Slave (64b)    [0 conversions!]
Master (512b) → Conv(512→64) → Slave (64b)         [1 conversion]
```

- Per-master paths to each unique slave width it connects to
- Direct paths where widths match (zero overhead)
- Converters only where actually needed
- Router selects appropriate path based on address decode

Result: Minimal conversion logic, maximum performance, pragmatic simplicity.

3.3 CRITICAL: RTL Regeneration Requirements

ALL generated RTL files MUST be deleted and regenerated together whenever ANY generator code changes.

Why This Matters: - Generated RTL files may have interdependencies (bridges, wrappers, integrators) - Generator code changes can create version mismatches between files - Partial regeneration creates subtle incompatibilities that cause test failures - Even “small innocuous” generator changes can have cascading effects

The Rule:

```
# WRONG - Partial regeneration
./bridge_generator.py --masters 5 --slaves 3 --output ../rtl/
# Only regenerates bridge_axi4_flat_5x3.sv
# Other files (wrappers, integrators) now mismatched!

# CORRECT - Full regeneration
cd bin
make clean                                  # Delete ALL generated
bridges (rtl/generated/)
make all                                    # Regenerate everything from
bridge_batch.csv
```

Generator Files That Trigger Full Regeneration: - `bin/bridge_generator.py` - Main bridge generator (CSV/TOML driven) - Any Python file in `bin/bridge_pkg/` (components/, generators/, config, csv_parser, ...) - Any Jinja template in `bin/bridge_pkg/jinja_templates/` - `bridge_wrapper_generator.py` - Wrapper generation - **Any** Python file in `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin/`

Symptoms of Version Mismatch: - Tests that previously passed now fail - Simulation errors about missing signals - Mismatched port widths or counts - Address decode routing to wrong slaves

Think of Generated RTL Like Compiled Code: When you update a compiler, you don’t selectively recompile - you rebuild everything. When you update a generator, you don’t selectively regenerate - you regenerate everything.

3.4 1. Product Overview

3.4.1 1.1 Purpose

Bridge automates generation of AXI4 crossbar infrastructure: - **Python code generation** - Parameterized RTL generation (similar to APB/Delta) - **Performance modeling** - Analytical + simulation validation - **Flat topology** - Full M×N interconnect matrix - **`bridge_id` sideband routing** - in-order response return (see FR-2) - **Burst optimization** - Pipelined burst transfers

3.4.2 1.2 Target Audience

Primary Users: - RTL designers building SoC interconnect - System architects evaluating interconnect topologies - Verification engineers needing crossbar testbenches - Students learning AXI4 protocol and interconnects

Educational Focus: - Demonstrates AXI4 protocol complexity - Shows arbitration strategies for memory-mapped busses - Teaches ID-based transaction tracking - Illustrates burst optimization techniques

3.4.3 1.3 Success Criteria

Functional: - [x] Generates working AXI4 crossbar RTL (bridge_generator.py) - [x] Generates CSV/TOML-configured bridges (bridge_generator.py + bridge_pkg/; the earlier separate bridge_csv_generator.py was merged in) - [x] Passes Verilator lint - [x] Supports 1-32 masters, 1-256 slaves - [ ] Handles out-of-order completion via IDs. NOT IMPLEMENTED: `bridge_cam.sv` exists but is instantiated by no generated module. The slave adapters run "Bridge ID Tracking - FIFO Mode (In-Order)" and 93 generated files still declare `cam_wr_allocate`/`cam_rd_allocate` without driving them. - [x] Supports burst lengths 1-256 beats - [x] Channel-specific masters (wr/rd/rw) for resource optimization (Phase 2) - [x] APB converter integration – DELIVERED. `axi4_to_apb4_shim` is instantiated by `apb_periph_adapter.sv` in every mixed config, and `bridge_1x2_rw_apb5`, `bridge_1x2_rw_apb5_mon` and the four `mix_*` bridges ship with APB slaves. - [x] AXI3 converter integration – DELIVERED. `axi4_to_axi3` and `axi3_to_axi4` boundary converters are emitted for `protocol = "axi3"` slave and master ports; `bridge_1x2_axi3`, `bridge_2x2_axi3_masters`, `bridge_2x2_axi3_slaves` and `bridge_mix_e` ship as validation fixtures.

Performance: - [ ] Latency ≤ 3 cycles for single-beat transactions. **Unverified for the generated bridge.** The generated path crosses four skid buffers on the round trip (adapter timing wrappers on both sides), and gaxi_skid_buffer registers its output side, so an ideal zero-wait slave still costs >=4 cycles of bridge-added latency before arbitration. The 2-3 cycle figure in 6.1 describes the wrapperless flat crossbar, not what the generator emits. - [ ] Throughput: M×N paths do NOT all transfer concurrently. Each master is held to ONE target slave at a time (`aw_gate_ok`/`ar_gate_ok`, "single-outstanding-target"), a deadlock fix, not an oversight. Concurrency is across MASTERS, not across a master's targets. - [x] Performance models implemented (bridge_model.py - V1 Flat) - [ ] Fmax ≥ 300 MHz on UltraScale+ FPGAs (pending synthesis validation)

Quality: - [x] Complete specifications (PRD) before code - [x] Performance models validate requirements (bridge_model.py) - [x] All generated RTL Verilator verified - [x] Integration examples provided (CSV examples) - [x] Comprehensive documentation (bin/GENERATOR_ARCHITECTURE.md, docs/bridge_has/, docs/bridge_mas/)

3.4.4 1.4 Implementation Status and Phases

Unified Generator (bridge_generator.py):

The bridge generator now supports both TOML/CSV configuration and legacy array-indexed modes:

Configuration Modes: 1. **TOML/CSV Mode (Preferred)** - TOML port configuration (`bridge_name.toml`) - CSV connectivity matrix (`bridge_name_connectivity.csv`) - Custom port prefixes (`rapids_m_axi_`, `cpu_m_axi_`, etc.) - Interface wrapper integration (timing isolation) - Mixed protocols (AXI4 + AXI3 + APB + AXI4-Lite slaves) - Channel-specific masters (wr/rd/rw) - Status: Phase 2 complete, Phase 3 pending

2. **Legacy CSV Mode (Backwards Compatible)**
   - Separate `ports.csv` and `connectivity.csv` files
   - Migration path to TOML format
   - See `bin/test_configs/README.md` for conversion guide

Phase Status:

Phase 1: CSV Configuration COMPLETE - CSV parser (ports.csv, connectivity.csv) - Port generation with custom prefixes - Converter identification logic - Basic crossbar instantiation

Phase 2: Channel-Specific Masters COMPLETE (2025-10-26) - Added `channels` field to PortSpec (rw/wr/rd) - Conditional port generation based on channels - **Resource Optimization:** - wr (write-only): AW, W, B channels only → 39% port reduction - rd (read-only): AR, R channels only → 61% port reduction - rw (full): All 5 channels - Width converter awareness (only generate needed converters) - Example: 4-master bridge saves 35% signals with optimized channels

Phase 3: APB Converter Integration – DELIVERED - AXI2APB converter module: `axi4_to_apb4_shim`, emitted by `axi4_to_apb4_shim_component.py` - APB signal packing/unpacking: in the shim - APB converter instantiation in generated bridges: `apb_periph_adapter.sv` and the `periph5_adapter.sv` variants - Width converter + APB converter chaining: the `*_mon` builds chain the AXI4 timing wrapper into the shim - End-to-end testing with APB slaves: `test_bridge_1x2_rw_apb5*` and the `mix_*` suites, all in the 72-test FULL regression - The “placeholders with TODO comments” status was stale. This block said PENDING while the shim it describes was shipping in six configurations.

Additional Resources: - `models/bridge_model/bridge_model.py` - Performance modeling (V1 Flat implemented) - `rtl/bridge_cam.sv` - CAM for ID tracking. **Not instantiated by any generated module**; kept for the OOO work FR-2 describes as not implemented. - See `bin/GENERATOR_ARCHITECTURE.md` for the generator/build mechanics - See `docs/bridge_has/`

and `docs/bridge_mas/` for architecture diagrams and specs (the older BRIDGE_CURRENT_STATE.md / BRIDGE_ARCHITECTURE_DIAGRAMS.md were superseded)

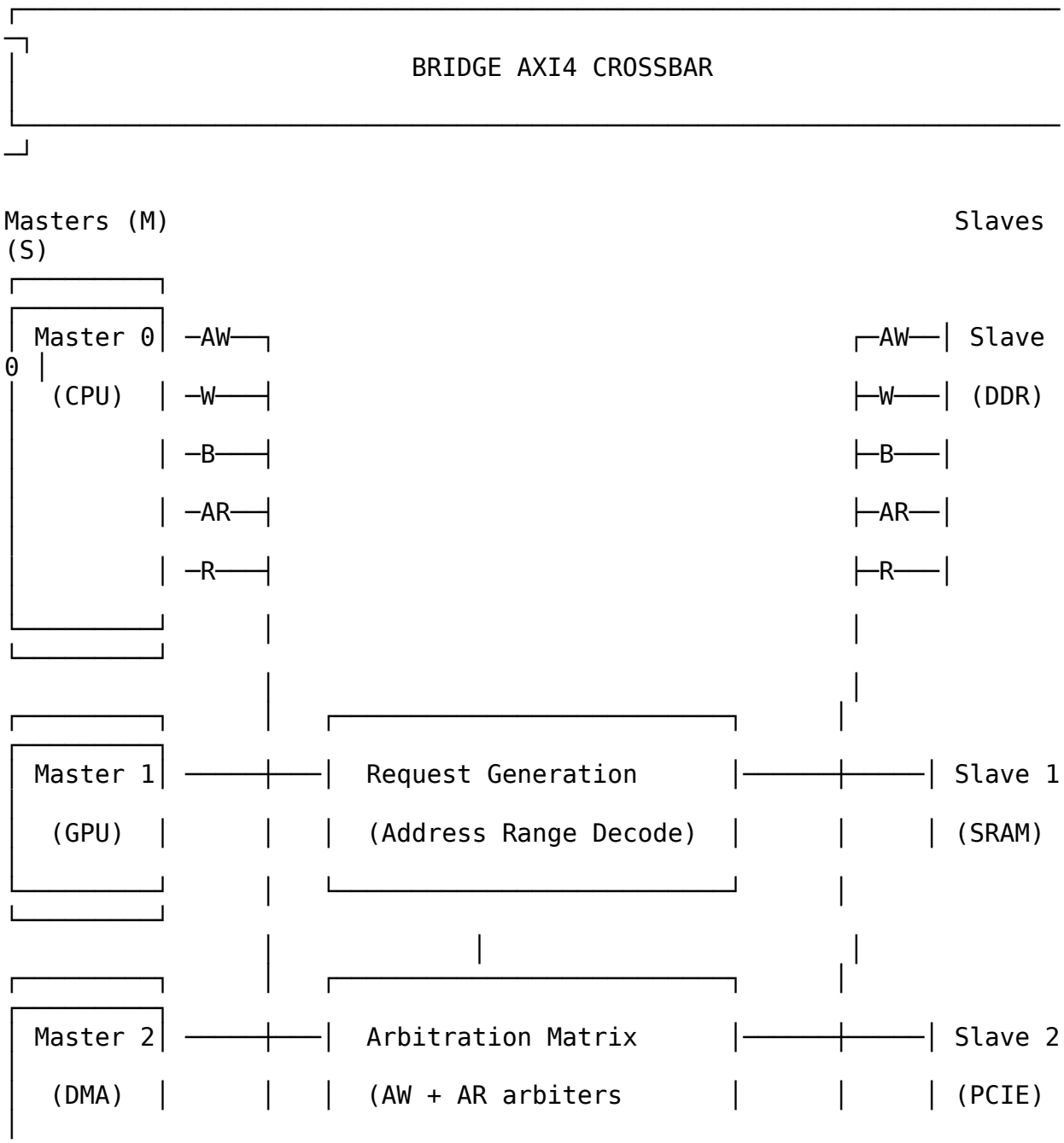
3.5 2. Architecture Overview

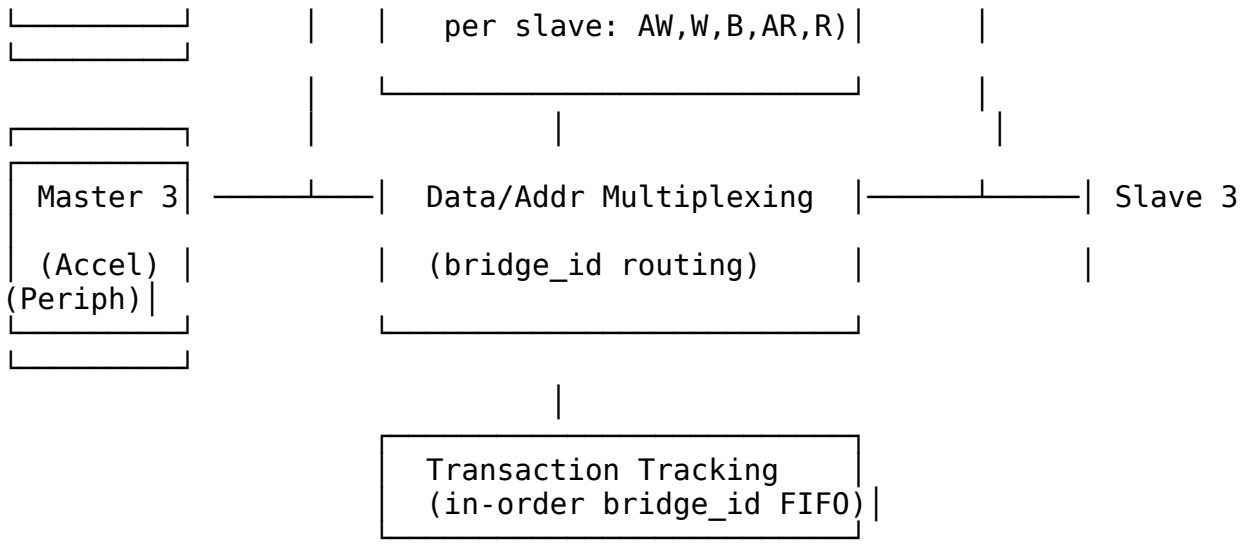
3.5.1 2.1 AXI4 vs AXIS vs APB

Feature	APB	AXI-Stream (Delta)	AXI4 (Bridge)
Protocol Type	Simple register bus	Streaming data	Memory-mapped burst
Channels	1 (address + data)	1 (data stream)	5 (AW, W, B, AR, R)
Request Generation	Address range decode	TDEST decode	Address range decode
Arbitration	Per-slave, per-cycle	Per-slave, packet-locked	Per-slave, per-address-phase
Out-of-Order	No (sequential)	No (streaming order)	No (in-order, `bridge_id` routed)
Burst Support	No	Packet (via TLAST)	Yes (AWLEN/ARLEN)
Complexity	Low	Medium	**High**
Latency	1-2 cycles	2 cycles	2 cycles each way (measured; HAS Table 5.7)
Use Case	Control registers	Data streaming	Memory-mapped I/O

Bridge Complexity Sources: 1. **5 independent channels**, of which TWO are arbitrated. The crossbar instantiates a round-robin arbiter per slave for AW and AR only; W, R and B follow the selection recorded at the address handshake, so they are routed, not arbitrated. 2. **`bridge_id` sideband routing**, in-order (the AXI ID is not used for routing) 3. **Burst handling** with interleaving constraints 4. **Write response tracking** (match AW with B channel) 5. **Address decode** + **ID muxing** for response routing

3.5.2 2.2 Block Diagram





3.5.3 2.3 Key Components

1. Request Generation - Address range decode for each slave - Generates M×S request matrix per channel (AW, AR) - Similar to APB but more complex (2 address channels)

2. Per-Slave Arbitration - **2 arbiters per slave**, not five: - AW channel arbiter (write address) - AR channel arbiter (read address) - W has no arbiter – a W-owner FIFO gives the channel to whichever master's AW the slave accepted first. - B and R have no arbiter – they are muxed combinationally on the `bridge_id` carried alongside the response. - Round-robin, grant held to the ADDRESS handshake – NOT to xlast. The generated arbiters read `lock until handshake`. - Separate read/write paths (no head-of-line blocking)

3. Data Multiplexing - Mux master signals to selected slave - ID-based response routing (B, R channels) - Burst tracking (grant held to the ADDRESS handshake, not to xlast – the generated arbiters read `lock until handshake`; see FR-6)

4. Transaction Tracking - In-order `bridge_id` FIFO per slave adapter (`Bridge ID Tracking - FIFO Mode (In-Order)`), popped in AW/AR order - Track the originating master in a per-slave in-order FIFO, popped on the response. There is no {Master ID, Transaction ID} map – routing is by FIFO POSITION and the AXI ID is not consulted. - Required for routing B/R channels back to correct master - ID tables for OUT-OF-ORDER support are not implemented: `bridge_cam.sv` exists but is instantiated in zero generated bridges

5. ~~Optional Performance Counters~~ – NOT implemented, and no config key enables them - Transaction counts per master/slave - Arbitration conflict counts - Latency histograms

---

3.6 3. Functional Requirements

3.6.1 3.1 AXI4 Protocol Compliance

FR-1: Full AXI4 Protocol Support - Support all 5 AXI4 channels: AW, W, B, AR, R - Comply with AMBA AXI4 specification (ARM IHI 0022) - Support burst lengths: 1-256 beats (AWLEN/ARLEN = 0-255) - Support burst types: INCR, WRAP, FIXED - Support burst sizes: 1-128 bytes (AWSIZE/ARSIZE = 0-7)

FR-2: Response Routing (in-order) - Responses are routed by the `bridge_id` sideband, a static per-master tag, popped from an in-order FIFO. The AXI ID plays no part in routing. - Master IDs pass through unchanged – there is no ID extension. `cpu_adapter` drives `cpu_32b_aw.id = fub_axi_awid`, 4 bits in, 4 bits out. - **Constraint this imposes:** the slave must return responses in the order its requests were accepted. A reordering slave misroutes – the FIFO head names the wrong master, so one master receives another's beats and the second starves. Nothing detects this. - Two masters never alias an ID at a slave: inside the fabric every ID is `{master index, master id}` (bridge TASK-005, was BRIDGE-016), so a slave port carries the widest master's id_width plus `$clog2(NUM_MASTERS)` bits – 8-bit masters behind a 16-master bridge give 12-bit IDs at the slaves. The `bridge_id` sideband still routes responses; the prefix is what makes per-ID tracking sound across masters, and every real AXI slave of a multi-master bridge is tracked by ID in `bridge_cam` (bridge BUG-012, was BRIDGE-015). Single-master bridges add no prefix and keep the in-order FIFO.

FR-3: Atomic Operations (the bridge does NOT implement a monitor – see below) - Pass AWLOCK/ARLOCK through to the slave. **The bridge implements no exclusive monitor**: there is no per-slave exclusive tracking and no EXOKAY generation anywhere in the generated RTL – `awlock` is muxed to the granted slave and nothing more. Exclusives work only if the attached slave implements the monitor itself. 13.1 correctly lists the monitor as future work; this requirement previously read as though the bridge provided it. - ~~Track exclusive monitor per slave~~ – NOT implemented; see the corrected bullet above - ~~Generate BRESP/RRESP errors for failed exclusives~~ – NOT implemented

3.6.2 3.2 Address Decoding

FR-4: Configurable Address Map - Support M masters × S slaves - Each slave has base address and size - Non-overlapping address ranges (verified at generation) - Default slave for unmapped addresses (optional)

FR-5: Address Range Configuration

```
# Example address map
address_map = {
    0: {'base': 0x00000000, 'size': 0x40000000, 'name': 'DDR'},      #
1GB
    1: {'base': 0x40000000, 'size': 0x00100000, 'name': 'SRAM'},     #
1MB
    2: {'base': 0x50000000, 'size': 0x01000000, 'name': 'PCIE'},     #
16MB
```

```
    3: {'base': 0x60000000, 'size': 0x00010000, 'name': 'Peripherals'}
# 64KB
}
```

3.6.3 3.3 Arbitration Strategy

FR-6: Round-Robin Arbitration - Fair bandwidth allocation (no starvation) - Separate arbiters for AW and AR channels - Grant is locked only until the ADDRESS handshake (`awvalid && awready`), not until xlast. The RTL comment reads “lock until handshake”. Back-to-back AWs from different masters can therefore be accepted and their W bursts sequenced by the W-owner FIFO. - Round-robin arbitration, HARD-CODED. There is no TOML key and no parameter to change it; “configurable” was aspirational.

FR-7: Read/Write Independence - Separate read and write paths - No head-of-line blocking between read/write - Concurrent read and write to same slave (if slave supports)

3.6.4 3.4 Burst Handling

FR-8: Burst Optimization - Pipelined burst transfers (overlap address and data) - No artificial burst splitting - Full AXI4 burst protocol support

FR-9: Interleaving Constraints - W channel follows the AW owner via a per-slave W-owner FIFO (not a held grant) - R channel routed by in-order `bridge_id` FIFO position, NOT by transaction ID. IDs are pass-through: the slave port is the same width as the master port. `bridge_cam.sv` exists but is instantiated in zero generated bridges. - ID-based interleaving is NOT supported. Each slave port must return B/R in request order across ALL IDs – see bridge BUG-008 (was BRIDGE-010).

3.7 4. Non-Functional Requirements

3.7.1 4.1 Performance

NFR-1: Latency - **Single-beat read:** ≤ 3 cycles (address decode + arbitration + mux) - **Single-beat write:** ≤ 3 cycles (address decode + arbitration + mux) - **Burst transfer:** No additional latency per beat (pipelined)

NFR-2: Throughput - **Concurrent transfers:** different masters to different slaves, yes; ONE master to several slaves, no – see 1.3 - **Burst efficiency:** Line-rate data transfer after address phase - **No artificial stalls:** Crossbar adds no wait states beyond arbitration

NFR-3: Fmax - **Target:** 300-400 MHz on Xilinx UltraScale+ - **Registered outputs:** All slave outputs registered for timing closure - **Pipelineable:** Optional pipeline stages for >400 MHz

3.7.2 4.2 Resource Usage (Measured)

Post-route, out of context, Vivado 2025.1 (HAS 6.4 flow; full tables in HAS 5.3):

Bridge	Part	LUTs	FFs	BRAM / DSP	Timing
`bridge_2x2_rw` (2 x 2, 32-bit AXI4)	Artix-7 100T -1 @ 10 ns	4,615	3,253	0 / 0	met, +0.12 ns
`bridge_2x2_rw_pipe` (registered crossbar)	Artix-7 100T -1 @ 10 ns	5,646	4,227	0 / 0	met, +1.27 ns
`bridge_2x2_axi5_native` (128-bit, MTE + chunking)	Artix-7 100T -1 @ 10 ns	8,007	6,213	0 / 0	met, +0.04 ns
`bridge_4x4_rw` (4 x 4, 32..256-bit)	Kintex-7 325T -2 @ 6.667 ns	29,719	29,508	0 / 0	met, +0.28 ns

No configuration uses block RAM or DSPs: the per-slave bridge_id FIFOs and the CAM are LUT arrays. Data width sets the cost – the 4 x 4 with width converters is six times the 2 x 2 – and on the Artix-7 at 100 MHz any configuration beyond a plain 2 x 2 needs `xbar_pipeline = true` to close.

3.7.3 4.3 Quality Requirements

NFR-4: Code Generation Quality - Lint-clean SystemVerilog (Verilator) - Synthesizable (Vivado, Yosys, Design Compiler) - No vendor-specific primitives (technology-agnostic) - Clear structure (commented, readable)

NFR-5: Verification - CocoTB testbench framework - Transaction-level verification - ~~Out-of-order test scenarios~~ – not applicable; ordering is structural (see FR-9) - Burst interleaving tests - >95% functional coverage

---

3.8 5. Interface Specifications

3.8.1 5.1 AXI4 Master Interfaces (M × 5 channels)

Write Address Channel (AW):

```
input  logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_awaddr  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]     s_axi_awid    [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [7:0]              s_axi_awlen   [NUM_MASTERS];  // Burst
length-1
input  logic [2:0]              s_axi_awsize  [NUM_MASTERS];  // Burst
size
input  logic [1:0]              s_axi_awburst [NUM_MASTERS];  //
INCR/WRAP/FIXED
input  logic                    s_axi_awlock  [NUM_MASTERS];  //
Exclusive access
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_awcache [NUM_MASTERS];  // Cache
attributes
input  logic [2:0]              s_axi_awprot  [NUM_MASTERS];  //
Protection type
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_awqos   [NUM_MASTERS];  // QoS
-- routed, not arbitrated on
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_awregion[NUM_MASTERS];  //
Region -- passed through
input  logic [UW-1:0]           s_axi_awuser  [NUM_MASTERS];  // USER
-- passed through
input  logic                    s_axi_awvalid [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic                    s_axi_awready [NUM_MASTERS];
```

Write Data Channel (W):

```
input  logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_wdata  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [DATA_WIDTH/8-1:0] s_axi_wstrb  [NUM_MASTERS];  // Byte
strobes
input  logic                    s_axi_wlast  [NUM_MASTERS];  // Last
beat
input  logic [UW-1:0]           s_axi_wuser  [NUM_MASTERS];  // USER
-- passed through
input  logic                    s_axi_wvalid [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic                    s_axi_wready [NUM_MASTERS];
```

Write Response Channel (B):

```
output logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]     s_axi_bid    [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic [1:0]              s_axi_bresp  [NUM_MASTERS];  //
OKAY/SLVERR/DECERR (EXOKAY never generated -- no exclusive monitor)
output logic [UW-1:0]           s_axi_buser  [NUM_MASTERS];  // USER
-- returned to the master
```

```
output logic                    s_axi_bvalid [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic                    s_axi_bready [NUM_MASTERS];
```

Read Address Channel (AR):

```
input  logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_araddr  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]     s_axi_arid    [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [7:0]              s_axi_arlen   [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [2:0]              s_axi_arsize  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [1:0]              s_axi_arburst [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic                    s_axi_arlock  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_arcache [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [2:0]              s_axi_arprot  [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_arqos   [NUM_MASTERS];  // QoS
-- routed, not arbitrated on
input  logic [3:0]              s_axi_arregion[NUM_MASTERS];  //
Region -- passed through
input  logic [UW-1:0]           s_axi_aruser  [NUM_MASTERS];  // USER
-- passed through
input  logic                    s_axi_arvalid [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic                    s_axi_arready [NUM_MASTERS];
```

Read Data Channel (R):

```
output logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0]   s_axi_rdata  [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]     s_axi_rid    [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic [1:0]              s_axi_rresp  [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic                    s_axi_rlast  [NUM_MASTERS];
output logic [UW-1:0]           s_axi_ruser  [NUM_MASTERS];  // USER
-- returned to the master
output logic                    s_axi_rvalid [NUM_MASTERS];
input  logic                    s_axi_rready [NUM_MASTERS];
```

3.8.2 5.2 AXI4 Slave Interfaces (S × 5 channels)

Mirror of master interfaces, with M → S direction reversed.

3.8.3 5.3 Configuration Is Generation-Time, Not Parameters

The generated bridge exposes no parameters. Everything below is fixed when the generator runs and reaches the module through its package:

```
module bridge_2x2_rw
    import bridge_2x2_rw_pkg::*;
(
    input logic aclk, ...
```

Geometry and widths come from the TOML, per port, and appear inside the generated modules as localparams (`localparam ADDR_WIDTH = 32;`, `localparam ID_WIDTH = 4;` in `cpu_adapter`). To change any of them, regenerate – there is nothing to override at elaboration.

An earlier revision of this section listed a parameter block including `MAX_BURST_LEN`, `PIPELINE_OUTPUTS` and `ENABLE_COUNTERS`. **None of those three exist in any generated module**, and neither do the performance counters that `ENABLE_COUNTERS` implied – there is no counter logic anywhere in the generated set.

3.9 6. Performance Modeling

3.9.1 6.1 Analytical Model

Latency Components (Flat Crossbar):

```
Single-Beat Read Latency:
  1. Address Decode:      0 cycles (combinatorial)
  2. Arbitration:         1 cycle  (AR arbiter decision)
  3. Address Mux:         0 cycles (combinatorial)
  4. Slave Access:        (slave-dependent, not crossbar)
  5. Response Mux:        1 cycle  (R channel ID lookup + mux)
  6. Output Register:     1 cycle  (optional, for timing closure)

  Total (no pipeline):    2 cycles
  Total (pipelined):      3 cycles
```

Burst Transfer Throughput:

```
After address phase completes, data transfer is line-rate:
  - W channel: 1 beat/cycle (routed by the W-owner FIFO)
  - R channel: 1 beat/cycle (ID-routed from slave)

Example: 256-beat burst
  Address phase:  2 cycles (measured, one-time)
  Data phase:     256 cycles (line-rate)
  Total:          258-259 cycles
  Efficiency:     98.8%
```

Concurrent Throughput:

```
Maximum concurrent transfers (4×4 crossbar):
  - Read:  4 concurrent (one per master-slave pair)
  - Write: 4 concurrent (one per master-slave pair)
  - Total: 8 concurrent read+write (separate paths)

Throughput @ 100 MHz, 512-bit data:
  Per path:   100 MHz × 512 bits = 51.2 Gbps
  Total:      8 paths × 51.2 Gbps = 409.6 Gbps theoretical
```

3.9.2 6.2 Resource Scaling

LUT Usage Formula (empirical):

```
LUTs ≈ 500 (base) + 150 × M × S + 20 × FIFO_DEPTH × BRIDGE_ID_WIDTH
```

Example (4×4 crossbar, ID_WIDTH=4, bridge_id FIFO depth 16 per slave):

```
LUTs ≈ 500 + 150 × 16 + 20 × 16 × 4
     ≈ 500 + 2,400 + 1,280
     ≈ 4,180 LUTs
```

3.9.3 6.3 Comparison with Other Crossbars

Crossbar Type	Latency	Throughput	Complexity	Use Case
APB	1-2 cycles	Low (serialized)	Low	Control registers
AXI-Stream (Delta)	2 cycles	High (streaming)	Medium	Data streaming
AXI4 (Bridge)	2 cycles each way	High (burst)	**High**	Memory-mapped I/O
AXI4 + Slices	4-6 cycles	High (burst)	Very High	>400 MHz designs

Bridge Sweet Spot: memory-mapped interconnects that need burst efficiency and mixed protocols. NOT a fit where out-of-order completion matters – the fabric is in-order by construction (FR-9, bridge BUG-008 (was BRIDGE-010)).

3.10 7. Generator Architecture

3.10.1 7.1 Python Generator Structure

```
class BridgeGenerator:
    """AXI4 crossbar RTL generator"""

    def __init__(self, config):
        self.num_masters = config.num_masters
        self.num_slaves = config.num_slaves
        self.data_width = config.data_width
        self.addr_width = config.addr_width
        self.id_width = config.id_width
        self.address_map = config.address_map

    def generate_address_decode(self) -> str:
        """Generate address range decode logic"""
        # For each master × slave, check if address in range
        # More complex than AXIS (uses address), simpler than full
decode

    def generate_aw_arbiter(self, slave_idx) -> str:
        """Generate write address channel arbiter for one slave"""
        # Round-robin arbiter
        # Grant held to the ADDRESS handshake, not to the B response.
        # (This pseudocode described an abandoned lock-until-response
design.)

    def generate_ar_arbiter(self, slave_idx) -> str:
        """Generate read address channel arbiter for one slave"""
        # Round-robin arbiter
        # Grant held to the ADDRESS handshake, not to RLAST.

    def generate_w_channel_mux(self, slave_idx) -> str:
        """Generate write data channel multiplexer"""
        # W channel follows the AW owner recorded in the per-slave W-
owner
        # FIFO. The arbiter grant itself released at the ADDRESS
handshake.

    def generate_b_channel_demux(self, slave_idx) -> str:
        """Generate write response channel demultiplexer"""
        # Route by FIFO POSITION: pop the per-slave bridge_id FIFO.
        # The returned BID is NOT consulted (see 4.2).

    def generate_r_channel_demux(self, slave_idx) -> str:
```

```
        """Generate read data channel demultiplexer"""
        # Route by FIFO POSITION: pop the per-slave bridge_id FIFO on
RLAST.
        # The returned RID is NOT consulted (see 4.2).

    def generate_bridge_id_fifo(self, slave_idx) -> str:
        """Generate transaction ID tracking table"""
        # Maps {slave, transaction_id} → master_id
        # Indexed on AW/AR grant, looked up on B/R response

    def generate_crossbar(self) -> str:
        """Generate complete crossbar module"""
        # Instantiate all arbiters, muxes, demuxes and the per-slave
        # bridge_id FIFOs (there are no ID tables)
```

3.10.2 7.2 Address Map Configuration

Python Configuration:

```
bridge_config = {
    'num_masters': 4,
    'num_slaves': 4,
    'data_width': 512,
    'addr_width': 64,
    'id_width': 4,
    'address_map': {
        0: {'base': 0x00000000, 'size': 0x40000000, 'name': 'DDR'},
        1: {'base': 0x40000000, 'size': 0x00100000, 'name': 'SRAM'},
        2: {'base': 0x50000000, 'size': 0x01000000, 'name': 'PCIE'},
        3: {'base': 0x60000000, 'size': 0x00010000, 'name':
'Peripherals'}
    },
    # NOTE: 'pipeline_outputs' and 'enable_counters' are NOT real
config
    # keys -- config_validator rejects unknown keys, and 5.3 says the
    # counters do not exist. Removed from this example rather than
left
    # for someone to copy.
}
```

Generated Address Decode:

```
// Address decode for each master
always_comb begin
    for (int s = 0; s < NUM_SLAVES; s++)
        aw_request_matrix[s] = '0;

    for (int m = 0; m < NUM_MASTERS; m++) begin
```

```
        if (s_axi_awvalid[m]) begin
            // Slave 0: DDR (0x00000000 - 0x3FFFFFFF)
            if (s_axi_awaddr[m] >= 64'h00000000 &&
                s_axi_awaddr[m] < 64'h40000000)
                aw_request_matrix[0][m] = 1'b1;

            // Slave 1: SRAM (0x40000000 - 0x400FFFFF)
            if (s_axi_awaddr[m] >= 64'h40000000 &&
                s_axi_awaddr[m] < 64'h40100000)
                aw_request_matrix[1][m] = 1'b1;

            // ... slaves 2-3 ...
        end
    end
end
```

3.11 8. Comparison with APB and Delta

3.11.1 8.1 Code Reuse from APB Generator

Similar Components (~70% reuse): - Address range decode logic (same pattern, different signals) - Round-robin arbiter (same algorithm) - Data multiplexing pattern (same approach) - Backpressure handling (similar to PREADY)

New Components for Bridge: - **2 arbiters per slave** (AW and AR). W is owned via a FIFO, B and R are muxed combinationally – no arbiter on any of the three. - **`bridge_id` sideband routing** (B and R channel demuxing) - **In-order transaction tracking** (a FIFO per direction, not an ID table) - **Burst handling** (grant locked to the ADDRESS handshake, not xlast)

Migration Effort from APB: - ~120 minutes (vs ~75 min for AXIS, due to higher complexity) - Most time: response demuxing and the bridge_id FIFOs

3.11.2 8.2 Code Reuse from Delta Generator

Similar Components (~60% reuse): - Python generation framework - Command-line interface - Performance modeling structure - Arbitration pattern (round-robin with locking)

Key Differences: - **5 channels** vs 1 channel (Delta only has TDATA/TVALID/TREADY/TLAST) - **`bridge_id` sideband routing** vs TDEST-based routing - **Address decode** vs TDEST decode (Bridge more complex) - **Transaction tracking** vs packet atomicity (different mechanisms)

3.11.3 8.3 Complexity Comparison

Metric	APB Crossbar	Delta (AXIS)	Bridge (AXI4)
Channels to arbitrate	1	1	5
Request generation	Address ranges	TDEST decode	Address ranges
Response routing	Grant-based	Grant-based	ID-based
Burst support	No	Packet (TLAST)	Yes (AWLEN/ARLEN)
Out-of-order	No	No	No – in-order `bridge_id` FIFO (`bridge_cam` unused)
Transaction	No	No	Yes

Metric	APB Crossbar	Delta (AXIS)	Bridge (AXI4)
tracking			
Lines of Python	~500	~697	**~900** (est.)
Lines of generated SV	~200 (4×4)	~250 (4×4)	**~400** (4×4) (est.)

= Additional complexity in Bridge

3.12 9. Use Cases

3.12.1 9.1 Multi-Core Processor Interconnect

Scenario: 4 CPU cores + GPU accessing DDR + SRAM + Peripherals

```
Configuration:
  Masters:  5 (4 CPUs, 1 GPU)
  Slaves:   3 (DDR, SRAM, Peripherals)
  Data:     512-bit (cache line width)
  Address:  64-bit (large memory space)
  ID:       4-bit (up to 16 outstanding per master)
```

Benefits: - Concurrent access to all slaves - in-order completion (see FR-9 – out-of-order is NOT implemented) - Burst transfers for cache line fills - Separate read/write paths (no head-of-line blocking)

3.12.2 9.2 DMA + Accelerator System

Scenario: DMA engine + 4 accelerators accessing shared memory

```
Configuration:
  Masters:  5 (1 DMA, 4 accelerators)
  Slaves:   2 (DDR, Control registers)
  Data:     512-bit (high-bandwidth DMA)
  Address:  32-bit (limited address space)
  ID:       2-bit (simple ID space)
```

Benefits: - High-bandwidth memory access for DMA - Fair arbitration prevents accelerator starvation - Control register access doesn't block data transfers

3.12.3 9.3 FPGA System Integration

Scenario: MicroBlaze CPU + custom accelerators + memory controllers

```
Configuration:
  Masters:  8 (1 CPU, 7 accelerators)
  Slaves:   4 (DDR, BRAM, AXI GPIO, AXI DMA)
  Data:     128-bit (AXI4 standard width)
  Address:  32-bit (standard FPGA address space)
  ID:       4-bit (moderate outstanding transactions)
```

Benefits: - Standard AXI4 interfaces (Xilinx IP compatibility) - Scalable to many masters/slaves - Performance counters for profiling. **NOT IMPLEMENTED** – no counter logic exists in any generated module.

3.13 10. Testing Strategy

3.13.1 10.1 FUB (Functional Unit Block) Tests

Address Decode Tests: - Verify all address ranges correctly decoded - Test boundary conditions (base, base+size-1) - Test unmapped addresses (error response)

Arbiter Tests: - Round-robin fairness (all masters get turns) - Grant locking to the ADDRESS handshake (not xlast – see FR-6) - Starvation prevention

bridge_id FIFO Tests: - Correct ID → master mapping - ~~Out-of-order transaction handling~~ – not implemented; see FR-9 - Table full condition

Mux/Demux Tests: - Data integrity through crossbar - Response routing to correct master - Concurrent transfers don't interfere

3.13.2 10.2 Integration Tests

Single-Master, Single-Slave: - Basic read/write transactions - Burst transfers (various lengths) - ~~Out-of-order completions~~ – not applicable (in-order fabric)

Multi-Master, Single-Slave: - Arbitration correctness - Fairness verification - Burst interleaving (if supported)

Multi-Master, Multi-Slave: - Concurrent transfers - No crosstalk between paths - Full M×S matrix coverage

Stress Tests: - All masters active simultaneously - Maximum burst lengths - Full ID space utilization - Back-to-back bursts

3.13.3 10.3 Performance Validation

Latency Measurement: - Single-beat read: measure actual vs analytical - Single-beat write: measure actual vs analytical - Compare with specification (≤3 cycles)

Throughput Measurement: - Burst transfer efficiency (should be ~98%) - Concurrent path throughput (should be line-rate × M×S) - Compare with theoretical maximum

Resource Validation: - Synthesize for Xilinx UltraScale+ - Compare LUT/FF usage with estimates - Verify Fmax ≥ 300 MHz

---

3.14 11. Documentation Plan

3.14.1 11.1 Specifications (Before Code)

- ☒ **PRD.md** - This document (complete requirements)
- ☐ **README.md** - User guide with quick start
- ☐ **BRIDGE_VS_APB_GENERATOR.md** - Migration guide from APB
- ☐ **BRIDGE_VS_DELTA_GENERATOR.md** - Comparison with Delta
- ☐ **AXI4_PROTOCOL_GUIDE.md** - AXI4 primer for students

3.14.2 11.2 Performance Analysis (Before Implementation)

- ☒ **models/bridge_model/bridge_model.py** - Analytical model (V1 Flat implemented)
  - Latency calculations (single-beat, burst)
  - Throughput estimates (concurrent paths)
  - Resource estimates (LUT/FF scaling)
- ☐ **bridge simulator** - Discrete event simulation (optional, not implemented)
  - Cycle-accurate modeling
  - Traffic pattern support
  - Validation against RTL

3.14.3 11.3 Code Generation

- ☐ **bin/bridge_generator.py** - Main RTL generator
  - Command-line interface
  - Address map configuration
  - Generated RTL output

3.14.4 11.4 Verification

- ☐ **dv/tests/** - CocoTB testbenches
  - FUB tests (individual blocks)
  - Integration tests (multi-block)
  - Stress tests (corner cases)

3.15 12. Success Metrics

3.15.1 12.1 Functional Completeness

- ☐ Generates working AXI4 crossbar RTL
- ☐ Passes all CocoTB tests
- ☐ Verilator lint clean
- ☐ Xilinx Vivado synthesis clean

3.15.2 12.2 Performance Targets

- ☐ Latency ≤ 3 cycles (measured in simulation)
- ☐ Throughput = line-rate × M×S paths (measured)
- ☐ Fmax ≥ 300 MHz (post-synthesis)

3.15.3 12.3 Educational Value

- ☐ Complete specifications demonstrating rigor
- ☐ Performance models validate requirements
- ☐ Clear code structure (readable generated RTL)
- ☐ Integration examples provided

3.15.4 12.4 Reusability

- ☐ ~70% code reuse from APB generator (measured by LOC)
- ☐ Similar patterns to Delta generator
- ☐ Can be extended (weighted arbitration, QoS, etc.)

3.16 12.2 PDF Generation Location

IMPORTANT: PDF files should be generated in the docs directory:

`projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs/`

Quick Commands: Use the provided shell scripts:

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs
./generate_has_pdf.sh   # Bridge_HAS_v<rev>.docx/.pdf
./generate_mas_pdf.sh   # Bridge_MAS_v<rev>.docx/.pdf
```

The shell scripts will automatically: 1. Use the md_to_docx.py tool from bin/ 2. Process the bridge_has/bridge_mas index files 3. Generate both DOCX and PDF files in the docs/ directory 4. Create table of contents and title page

See: `bin/md_to_docx.py` for complete implementation details

3.17 13. Future Enhancements

3.17.1 13.1 Short-Term (Post-Initial Release)

- ☐ **Optional pipeline stages** - For Fmax >400 MHz
- ☐ **Weighted arbitration** - QoS support
- ☒ **Default slave** - unmapped address handling. Built 2026-09-07: a subtractive catch-all answers DECERR + 0xDEADBEEF, with a sticky status/IRQ cleared by the `unmapped_clear` INPUT PIN. There is no APB access to it – the pin is the whole interface, and wiring it to a register is the integrator's job. See HAS 4.5 and bridge BUG-007 (was BRIDGE-009).
- ☐ **Exclusive monitor** - Full atomic operation support

3.17.2 13.2 Long-Term

- ☐ **Tree topology** - Hierarchical crossbar (like Delta)
- ☐ **AXI4-Lite variant** - Simplified for control registers
- ☐ **ACE support** - Coherent cache interconnect
- ☐ **GUI configurator** - Visual address map setup

3.18 14. Risk Assessment

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
~~ID table complexity~~	–	–	Moot: no ID tables were built. The realised risk was the opposite – the DOCS described tables for months while the RTL used an in-order FIFO.
Response-ordering assumption	High	High	The fabric REQUIRES each slave to return B/R in request order across IDs and does not check it. Assert on a returned BID/RID that does not match the FIFO head – see bridge BUG-008 (was BRIDGE-010).
Fmax below target	Low	Medium	Optional pipeline stages for timing closure
Resource usage exceeds	Low	Low	Empirical formulas guide expectations
Burst interleaving bugs	Medium	High	Separate test suite for burst scenarios

3.19 15. Project Timeline (Estimated)

Week 1: Specifications and Models - [x] Day 1-2: PRD.md (complete) - [ ] Day 3-4: Performance modeling (analytical) - [ ] Day 5-7: README.md, migration guides

Week 2-3: Core Implementation - [ ] Day 1-3: Address decode + arbiter generation - [ ] Day 4-5: Data mux/demux generation - [x] Day 6-8: response tracking (delivered as a per-slave in-order bridge_id FIFO, not ID tables) - [ ] Day 9-10: Integration and testing

Week 4: Verification and Examples - [ ] Day 1-5: CocoTB testbenches - [ ] Day 6-7: Integration examples

---

3.20 16. Glossary

- **AXI4:** Advanced eXtensible Interface version 4 (AMBA standard)
- **Burst:** Multi-beat transaction (AWLEN/ARLEN > 0)
- **Crossbar:** Full M×N interconnect matrix
- **ID:** AXI transaction identifier. Passed through this bridge unchanged; it is NOT used for response routing here.
- **Out-of-order:** responses returning in a different order than requested. AXI4 permits it between IDs; **this bridge does not support it** and does not detect a slave that does (bridge BUG-008, was BRIDGE-010).
- **xlast:** WLAST (write) or RLAST (read) - last beat indicator

---

Version: 2.1 **Status:** Specification Complete - Ready for Implementation **Next Steps:** Create performance models, then implement generator

Project Bridge - Connecting masters and slaves across the divide

---

3.21 References

- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — backs the design philosophy (simple-performant, hard limits; class cost discussions and the observation that a full crossbar with buffering is costly), per-slave/channel arbitration as a degenerate separable allocator (ch18 §19.3), round-robin as a starvation-free baseline (ch17 §18.4.2), skid buffers as buffered flow control (ch12), and weighted-arbiter starvation bounds (ch17). (Reference archive)
- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — backs independent read/write paths that avoid head-of-line blocking (ch4), deterministic single-stage crossbar deadlock-freedom (ch3), and the need for explicit ID-keyed tables/CAMs to route out-of-order responses correctly (ch3/4 ordering material). (Reference archive)
- Jantsch & Tenhunen (eds.), *Networks on Chip*, Kluwer 2003 — backs the QoS-plus-aging arbitration policy and its bounded starvation argument (ch13). (Reference archive)
- Maaref, *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt 2022 — backs the AMBA-suite context for read/write channel independence and the AXI ID ordering rules that Bridge's in-order FIFO simplifies (ch3 §4.2). (Reference archive)
- Roy, *Advanced Digital System Design*, Springer 2023 — backs AXI's independent read/write channels (§18.2.2.1) and the decoupling of W from AW with B correlated through the stored transaction ID (§18.2.3). (Reference archive)
- Eschemann, *The FPGA Programming Handbook*, Packt 2023 — backs the secondary, educational framing of AXI4 channel structure and the cost warning that a full crossbar with buffering can become expensive (ch8). (Reference archive)
- ARM, *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022E — the AXI4 protocol authority; backs the ordering rules that permit out-of-order completion across IDs and therefore motivate the CAM-style tracking Bridge documents as future work. (Reference archive)

4 Claude Code Guide: Bridge Subsystem

Version: 2.3 **Last Updated:** 2026-09-13 **Purpose:** AI-specific guidance for working with Bridge subsystem

---

4.1 CRITICAL: Read Architecture Documents First

Before making ANY changes to bridge generator or understanding signal flow:

READ: `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin/GENERATOR_ARCHITECTURE.md` (generator build mechanics, reconciled against the code 2026-09-29) and `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs/bridge_mas/` (micro-architecture spec; rendered as `docs/Bridge_MAS_v1.7.pdf`)

These documents contain the **definitive bridge architecture** including: - Correct signal flow (wrappers → decoder → converters → crossbar → slaves) - Component purposes and placement - Common misconceptions that previous agents made - Why there's NO fixed crossbar width

If you skip these documents, you WILL make incorrect assumptions.

4.2 Quick Context

What: Bridge - one AXI4/AXI5 crossbar generator, `bin/bridge_generator.py`, taking TOML or CSV configuration. There is no second generator: the separate `bridge_csv_generator.py` was merged into it and no longer exists. **Status:** Phase 2 Complete - CSV generator with channel-specific masters (wr/rd/rw) **Your Role:** Help users configure CSV files, generate bridges, understand architecture, and create tests

Complete Documentation (Read in This Order): 1. `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin/GENERATOR_ARCHITECTURE.md` ← **START HERE** (generator build mechanics; the design lives in the MAS below) 2. `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/PRD.md` ← Product requirements 3. `vault/Tasks/bridge/INDEX.md` ← Task tracking (open / closed / dropped; the old TASKS.md was folded in 2026-09-10) 4. `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs/bridge_has/bridge_has_index.md` ← Hardware Architecture Spec (rendered: `docs/Bridge_HAS_v1.7.pdf`) 5. `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs/bridge_mas/bridge_mas_index.md` ← Micro-Architecture Spec (rendered: `docs/Bridge_MAS_v1.7.pdf`)

(The older BRIDGE_ARCHITECTURE.md, BRIDGE_CURRENT_STATE.md, BRIDGE_ARCHITECTURE_DIAGRAMS.md, CSV_BRIDGE_STATUS.md, and docs/bridge_spec/ documents were superseded by the HAS/MAS above.)

4.3 Target Architecture: Intelligent Width-Aware Routing

Core Principle: Direct connections where possible, converters only where needed, no fixed crossbar width.

4.3.1 Efficient Multi-Width Design

```
Master_A (64b)
  ├─ Direct → Slave_0 (64b)           [0 conversions, minimal latency]
  ├─ Conv(64→128) → Slave_1 (128b)    [1 conversion]
  └─ Conv(64→512) → Slave_2 (512b)    [1 conversion]

Master_B (512b)
  ├─ Conv(512→64) → Slave_0 (64b)     [1 conversion]
  ├─ Conv(512→128) → Slave_1 (128b)   [1 conversion]
  └─ Direct → Slave_2 (512b)          [0 conversions, full bandwidth]
```

Router Logic: Address decoder determines target slave, selects correctly-sized path for that master-slave pair.

4.3.2 Why This Architecture

Naive Fixed-Width Approach (Don't Do This):

```
Master (64b) → Upsize(64→256) → Fixed 256b Crossbar → Downsize(256→64)
→ Slave (64b)
```

- TWO conversions for same-width connections (wasteful!)
- Reduced bandwidth on narrow paths
- Unnecessary logic and area
- Higher latency

Intelligent Routing (Target):

```
Master (64b) → Router → Direct Connection → Slave (64b)
```

- ZERO conversions for matching widths
- Full native bandwidth
- Minimal logic
- Lowest latency

4.3.3 Per-Master Output Paths

Each master has N output paths (one per unique slave width it connects to):

```
// Master_A connects to slaves at 64b, 128b, 512b
// Generate 3 output paths:
```

```
logic [63:0]  master_a_64b_wdata;   // For 64b slaves (direct)
logic [127:0] master_a_128b_wdata;  // For 128b slaves (via converter)
logic [511:0] master_a_512b_wdata;  // For 512b slaves (via converter)

// Router selects based on address decode:
always_comb begin
    case (decoded_slave_id)
        SLAVE_0: select master_a_64b_wdata;   // Slave_0 is 64b
        SLAVE_1: select master_a_128b_wdata;  // Slave_1 is 128b
        SLAVE_2: select master_a_512b_wdata;  // Slave_2 is 512b
    endcase
end
```

4.3.4 Benefits

1. **Resource Efficient** - Only instantiate converters actually needed
2. **Maximum Performance** - Direct paths have zero conversion overhead
3. **Optimal Bandwidth** - No artificial width bottlenecks
4. **Lower Latency** - Minimal logic in critical path for matching widths
5. **Scalable** - Works for any combination of master/slave widths

4.3.5 Implementation Status

Current State: Intelligent per-master multi-width routing – DELIVERED. `cpu_master_adapter.sv` in `bridge_4x4_rw` carries separate 32b, 64b, 128b and 256b paths and converts only where a master and its slave disagree. There is no fixed internal crossbar width.

This block described the Phase-1 fixed-width crossbar as current and the per-width routing as a future migration “requiring generator architecture rework”. That rework has happened; the block outlived it.

4.4 CRITICAL RULE #0: RTL Regeneration Requirements

Change any generator, delete every generated bridge, regenerate all of them. The rule itself, why partial regeneration fails silently, and the symptom list are the root `/CLAUDE.md` Rule #0 and `vault/handbook/design/generated-rtl-discipline.md`. What is bridge-specific:

Generators whose change forces a full regeneration - `bin/bridge_generator.py` - **any** Python file under `bin/bridge_pkg/` (components/, generators/, config, csv_parser, signal_naming, ...) - any Jinja template in `bin/bridge_pkg/jinja_templates/`

The workflow

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin
make clean          # removes rtl/generated/
make all            # regenerates from bridge_batch.csv

cd ../dv/tests
make clean-all && make run-all-func    # ALL tests; bridge runs
serial, ~1GB each
```

`clean-all` is not optional here. You have just regenerated every `.sv`, so a stale build directory reports green for the old design – precisely the failure this workflow exists to prevent (`vault/handbook/dv/running-regressions.md`).

Never regenerated: `rtl/bridge_cam.sv` (hand-written; instantiated by the slave adapter of every AXI4/AXI5 slave in a multi-master bridge, and of any slave with `enable_ooo`) and anything in `rtl/` outside `rtl/generated/`.

Identifying a generated file takes five strings, not one. Each generator class stamps its own header, and `bridge_generator.py` appears in none of them:

File	Header
`<name>.sv`	`// Generated by: BridgeModuleGenerator`
`<name>_pkg.sv`	`// Generated by: PackageGenerator`
`<name>_xbar.sv`	`// Generated by: CrossbarGenerator`
`<master>_adapter.sv`	`// Generated by: AdapterGenerator`
`<slave>_adapter.sv`	`// Generated by: SlaveAdapterGenerator`

Grepping for `bridge_generator.py` finds nothing; grepping only for `BridgeModuleGenerator` finds one file in five.

4.5 Critical Pitfalls: slave_select_* Reversion After Handshake

4.5.1 The Problem: Combinational Address Decode

The master adapter's R/B response MUX and the crossbar's AR/AW gating both relied on `<master>_slave_select_{ar,aw}` — a combinational decode of `fub_axi_{ar,aw}addr`. This signal reverts immediately when the address port is freed:

1. AR/AW handshake completes (arvalid && arready, awvalid && awready)
2. Wrapper pops skid buffer and releases the address port
3. fub_axi_araddr / fub_axi_awaddr reverts to next transaction or zero
4. Decode flips to different slave
5. Response MUX is now gated on WRONG slave
6. Response path closes, transaction hangs

This happens BEFORE the converter even finishes pushing to the crossbar, and ALWAYS before response arrives.

4.5.2 Visible Symptoms

- Fails: Multi-slave multi-master bridges hang (timeout)
- Fails: Multi-width masters fail basic connectivity
- Fails: APB/AXIL slaves consistently timeout (longer converter latency = more decode changes)
- Works: Single-slave or single-master systems (no decode change)

4.5.3 The Solution (MANDATORY in All Generators)

For Crossbar AR/AW Gating: - Replace `<master>_slave_select_ar/aw` gates with **inline address re-decode** on stable m_axi buses - Address on m_axi is held stable across the entire AXI handshake

For Master Adapter Response MUX: - Add **per-channel response-tracking FIFOs** that capture slave index at request time - Use FIFO head for response MUX instead of live combinational decode

Crossbar Code Pattern:

```
// WRONG (old implementation):
assign gate_ar_s0 = m0_slave_select_ar && m0_arvalid;
//                  ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^ Reverts after handshake!

// CORRECT (new implementation):
assign gate_ar_s0 = ((m0_m_axi_araddr >= S0_BASE) &&
                     (m0_m_axi_araddr < S0_END) &&
```

```
                        m0_arvalid);  // Re-decode on stable m_axi
address
```

Master Adapter Code Pattern:

```
// WRONG (old implementation):
assign r_slave_select = comb_slave_select_ar;  // Stale after pop!

// CORRECT (new implementation):
// Capture at request time
always_ff @(posedge aclk) begin
    if (fub_axi_arvalid && fub_axi_arready) begin
        ar_trk_fifo <= comb_slave_select_ar;
    end
end

// Use stable value for response MUX
assign r_slave_select = ar_trk_fifo_out;
```

4.5.4 When This Bug Appears

- Works: Single-master, single-slave systems (no address re-evaluation)
- Fails: Multi-master to same slave (multiple addresses decode differently)
- Fails: Multi-slave same master (address decode changes per transaction)
- Fails: Multi-width paths (W beats re-evaluate AW decode mid-burst)

4.6 MANDATORY: Project Organization Pattern

THIS SUBSYSTEM MUST FOLLOW THE RAPIDS/AMBA ORGANIZATIONAL PATTERN - NO EXCEPTIONS

4.6.1 Required Directory Structure

```
projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/
├── bin/                            # Bridge-specific tools
(generators, scripts)
│   ├── bridge_generator.py        # AXI4 crossbar generator (CSV/TOML
driven)
│   ├── bridge_pkg/                 # Generator implementation package
│   ├── test_configs/               # TOML port configs + CSV
connectivity
│   └── Makefile                    # make all / make single / make
clean
├── docs/                           # Design documentation
(bridge_has/, bridge_mas/, PDFs)
├── dv/                             # Design Verification (MANDATORY
structure)
│   ├── tbclasses/                  # Testbench classes (MANDATORY - TB
classes here!)
│   │   ├── __init__.py
│   │   └── bridge2x2_rw_tb.py      # Per-config generated TB classes
│   ├── components/                 # Bridge-specific BFMs (if needed)
│   ├── scoreboards/                # Bridge-specific scoreboards (if
needed)
│   ├── testplans/                  # Test plans
│   └── tests/                      # All test files (test runners
only, flat)
│       ├── conftest.py             # Pytest configuration (MANDATORY)
│       └── test_bridge_*.py        # Per-config tests
(test_bridge_2x2_rw.py, ...)
├── rtl/                            # RTL source files
│   ├── bridge_cam.sv               # Hand-written CAM (multi-master
AXI4/AXI5 slave adapters)
│   ├── filelists/                  # Generated filelists
│   └── generated/                  # Generated bridges (one subdir per
config)
├── CLAUDE.md                       # This file
├── PRD.md                          # Product requirements
└── TASKS.md                        # Task history and status
```

4.6.2 Testbench Class Location (MANDATORY)

TB classes live in `dv/tbclasses/`, never inside a test runner. The rule and the reasoning are in `vault/handbook/dv/tb-structure.md` and `/GLOBAL_REQUIREMENTS.md` 2.1. The bridge layout that satisfies it is the tree under Rule #0.1 below.

4.6.3 Test File Pattern (MANDATORY)

Pattern B – `cocotb_test_*` functions with pytest wrappers at the bottom, each naming its `testcase=` – is the `test-patterns` skill and `/GLOBAL_REQUIREMENTS.md` 3.2. Read the real thing rather than a template: `dv/tests/test_bridge_2x2_rw.py`. Tests and TB classes are generated per bridge configuration alongside the RTL, so the generated file is the pattern.

4.7 Critical Rules for This Subsystem

4.7.1 Rule #0.1: Testbench Architecture - MANDATORY SEPARATION

TB classes live in `dv/tbclasses/`, one per config (`bridge2x2_rw_tb.py`); runners stay flat in `dv/tests/`. That layout is the tree above – it is not repeated here. Why the separation matters for bridge specifically is that one TB is shared by the per-config test, the `*_mon_monitor.py` stress test and external imports: `vault/handbook/dv/tb-structure.md`.

4.7.2 Rule #1: TBBase and the three mandatory methods

(Former Rule #2 is folded in here; #3 and #4 keep their numbers so existing references to them still resolve.)

Every TB inherits `TBBase` and implements `setup_clocks_and_reset` / `assert_reset` / `deassert_reset`. The requirement is `/GLOBAL_REQUIREMENTS.md` 2.2 and 2.3; what TBBase provides and why the three methods are mandatory is `vault/handbook/dv/tb-structure.md`.

Bridge-specific: the class is `BridgeAXI4FlatTB(TBBase)`, the clock is `aclk` and reset is `aresetn` (active-low), so `assert_reset` drives `self.dut.aresetn.value = 0`.

4.7.3 Rule #3: Use GAXI Components for Protocol Handling

Use the framework BFMs; never hand-drive AXI4 valid/ready. The map and trap list are in `vault/handbook/dv/bfm-usage.md`. Bridge wires GAXI onto the AXI4 channels with the `s0_axi4_` prefix:

```
from CocoTBFramework.components.gaxi.gaxi_master import GAXIMaster
from CocoTBFramework.components.gaxi.gaxi_slave import GAXISlave
from CocoTBFramework.components.axi4.axi4_field_configs import
AXI4FieldConfigHelper

# CORRECT: Use GAXI for AXI4 channels
self.aw_master = GAXIMaster(
    dut=dut,
    title="AW_M0",
    prefix="s0_axi4_",
    clock=clock,

field_config=AXI4FieldConfigHelper.create_aw_field_config(id_width,
addr_width, 1),
    pkt_prefix="aw",
    multi_sig=True,
```

```
    log=log
)
```

4.7.4 Rule #4: Queue-Based Verification

For simple in-order verification, use direct monitor queue access:

```
# CORRECT: Direct queue access
aw_pkt = self.aw_slave._recvQ.popleft()
w_pkt = self.w_slave._recvQ.popleft()

# Verify
assert aw_pkt.addr == expected_addr
assert w_pkt.data == expected_data

# WRONG: Memory model for simple test
memory_model = MemoryModel()  # Unnecessary complexity
```

When to Use Memory Models: - Simple in-order tests → Use queue access - Single-master systems → Use queue access - Complex out-of-order scenarios → not supported; slaves must respond in request order - Multi-master with address overlap → Memory model tracks state

---

4.8 TOML/CSV-Based Bridge Generator (Phase 2 Complete)

4.8.1 Overview

The Bridge generator creates parameterized SystemVerilog crossbars from TOML configuration files with CSV connectivity matrices, eliminating manual RTL editing for complex interconnects.

Key Benefits: - **Human-readable configuration** - TOML for ports, CSV for connectivity - **Custom signal prefixes** - Each port has unique prefix (rapids_m_axi_, apb0_, etc.) - **Channel-specific masters** - Write-only (wr), read-only (rd), or full (rw) - **Interface modules** - Timing isolation via axi4_master/slave wrappers with configurable skid depths - **Automatic converters** - Width and protocol conversion inserted automatically - **Resource efficient** - Only generates needed channels and converters

4.8.2 Quick Start

1. Create bridge_mybridge.toml:

```
[bridge]
  name = "bridge_mybridge"
  description = "Custom bridge example"

  # Default skid buffer depths (can be overridden per port)
  defaults.skid_depths = {ar = 2, r = 4, aw = 2, w = 4, b = 2}

  masters = [
    {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_m_axi", id_width = 4, addr_width =
32, data_width = 64, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master"}},
    {name = "dma", prefix = "dma_m_axi", id_width = 4, addr_width =
32, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master", skid_depths = {ar = 4, r = 8,
aw = 4, w = 8, b = 4}}}
  ]

  slaves = [
    {name = "ddr", prefix = "ddr_s_axi", id_width = 4, addr_width =
32, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     base_addr = 0x00000000, addr_range = 0x80000000, interface =
{type = "axi4_slave"}},
    {name = "sram", prefix = "sram_s_axi", id_width = 4, addr_width =
32, data_width = 256, user_width = 1,
     base_addr = 0x80000000, addr_range = 0x80000000, interface =
{type = "axi4_slave"}}
  ]
```

2. Create bridge_mybridge_connectivity.csv:

```
master\slave,ddr,sram
cpu,1,1
dma,1,1
```

3. Generate bridge:

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin
python3 bridge_generator.py --ports test_configs/bridge_mybridge.toml
# Auto-finds bridge_mybridge_connectivity.csv

# Or use bulk generation
python3 bridge_generator.py --bulk bridge_batch.csv
```

Result: Complete SystemVerilog module with: - Custom port prefixes per port - Timing isolation via interface wrappers - Only needed AXI4 channels (wr/rd/rw optimized) - Width converters for data mismatches - Internal crossbar instantiation - APB/AXI4-Lite converter integration points

4.8.3 Configuration Format Details

TOML Port Configuration:

The primary format is now **TOML** (preferred over CSV for better structure and interface configuration):

Port Specifications: - `name` - Unique identifier (cpu, dma, ddr, etc.) - `prefix` - Signal prefix (cpu_m_axi_, ddr_s_axi_, etc.) - `id_width` - AXI4 ID width in bits - `addr_width` - Address width in bits - `data_width` - Data width in bits (32, 64, 128, 256, 512) - `user_width` - AXI4 user signal width - `base_addr` - Slave base address (slaves only) - `addr_range` - Slave address range (slaves only) - `interface` - Interface wrapper configuration (optional) - `type` - “axi4_master”, “axi4_slave”, “axi4_master_mon”, “axi4_slave_mon”, or omit for direct connection - `skid_depths` - Per-channel buffer depths: {ar, r, aw, w, b}. Valid range is **2..8 inclusive, any integer** – odd depths are legal. `gaxi_skid_buffer` says so at its parameter: “Must be 2..8 inclusive”. An earlier `{2, 4, 6, 8}` here was an inference, not the contract.

CSV Connectivity Matrix:

```
master\slave,slave0,slave1,slave2
master0,1,0,1
master1,0,1,1
```

- `1` = connected, `0` = not connected
- Partial connectivity supported (not all masters to all slaves)
- Auto-detected based on TOML filename: `bridge_name.toml` → `bridge_name_connectivity.csv`

Legacy CSV Format:

For backwards compatibility, the generator still supports CSV port files: - See `bin/test_configs/README.md` for migration guide from CSV to TOML - TOML is now preferred for new bridges (better structure, interface config support)

4.8.4 Channel-Specific Masters (Phase 2 Feature)

Why Channel-Specific? Real hardware often has dedicated read or write masters. Generating all 5 AXI4 channels wastes resources:

Traditional (wasteful):

```
// Write-only master gets unused read channels
input  logic [63:0]  rapids_descr_m_axi_awaddr,  // USED
input  logic [511:0] rapids_descr_m_axi_wdata,   // USED
output logic [7:0]   rapids_descr_m_axi_bid,     // USED
input  logic [63:0]  rapids_descr_m_axi_araddr,  // UNUSED (50%
waste!)
output logic [511:0] rapids_descr_m_axi_rdata,   // UNUSED
```

Channel-Specific (optimized):

```
rapids_descr_wr,master,axi4,wr,rapids_descr_m_axi_,512,64,8,N/A,N/A
```

Generated:

```
// Write-only master - only AW, W, B channels
input  logic [63:0]  rapids_descr_m_axi_awaddr,
input  logic [511:0] rapids_descr_m_axi_wdata,
output logic [7:0]   rapids_descr_m_axi_bid,
// NO READ CHANNELS (araddr, rdata, etc.)
```

Resource Savings: - 40-60% fewer ports for dedicated masters - Only necessary width converters instantiated - Channel-aware direct connection wiring - Faster synthesis, smaller netlists

4.8.5 Example: RAPIDS-Style Configuration

RAPIDS Architecture: - Descriptor write master (wr) - Writes descriptors to memory - Sink write master (wr) - Writes incoming packets to memory - Source read master (rd) - Reads outgoing packets from memory - CPU master (rw) - Full access for configuration

TOML Configuration (bridge_rapids.toml):

```
[bridge]
  name = "bridge_rapids"
  description = "RAPIDS accelerator bridge"
  defaults.skid_depths = {ar = 2, r = 4, aw = 2, w = 4, b = 2}

  masters = [
    {name = "rapids_descr_wr", prefix = "rapids_descr_m_axi", channels
= "wr",
```

```
     id_width = 8, addr_width = 64, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master"}},
    {name = "rapids_sink_wr", prefix = "rapids_sink_m_axi", channels =
"wr",
     id_width = 8, addr_width = 64, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master"}},
    {name = "rapids_src_rd", prefix = "rapids_src_m_axi", channels =
"rd",
     id_width = 8, addr_width = 64, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master"}},
    {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_m_axi", channels = "rw",
     id_width = 4, addr_width = 32, data_width = 64, user_width = 1,
     interface = {type = "axi4_master"}}
  ]

  slaves = [
    {name = "ddr", prefix = "ddr_s_axi", protocol = "axi4",
     id_width = 8, addr_width = 64, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     base_addr = 0x80000000, addr_range = 0x80000000,
     interface = {type = "axi4_slave"}},
    {name = "apb_periph", prefix = "apb0_", protocol = "apb",
     addr_width = 32, data_width = 32,
     base_addr = 0x00000000, addr_range = 0x00010000}
  ]
```

Connectivity CSV (bridge_rapids_connectivity.csv):

```
master\slave,ddr,apb_periph
rapids_descr_wr,1,0
rapids_sink_wr,1,0
rapids_src_rd,1,0
cpu,1,1
```

Generated RTL Features: - rapids_descr_wr: write channels only - rapids_sink_wr: write channels only - rapids_src_rd: read channels only

The specific counts this list used to give (37 wr / 24 rd against 61 full, for 39% and 61% reductions) reproduce from no port structure in the tree and are not recoverable – the RAPIDS bridges they describe are not in the generated set here. For scale, counted on the shipped variants: an AXI4 `rw` master port is 44 signals, a write-only master 24, a read-only master 20. Channel trimming is real and worth doing; the old percentages were not measurements. - cpu_master: Width converters for 64b→512b upsize (both wr and rd converters) - ddr_controller: Direct 512b connection (no conversion) - apb_periph0: APB slave – `axi4_to_apb4_shim`, a real conversion

4.8.6 Common User Questions

Q: “How do I generate a bridge?”

A: Three steps:

1. Create TOML port configuration file
2. Create CSV connectivity matrix
3. Run bridge_generator.py

```
# Create bridge_mybridge.toml (port configuration)
# Create bridge_mybridge_connectivity.csv (connectivity matrix)

cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin
python3 bridge_generator.py --ports test_configs/bridge_mybridge.toml
# Auto-finds bridge_mybridge_connectivity.csv

# Or use bulk generation for multiple bridges
python3 bridge_generator.py --bulk bridge_batch.csv
```

Q: "What's the difference between wr/rd/rw channels?"

A: Number of AXI4 channels generated:

- **rw** (read/write) - All 5 channels: AW, W, B, AR, R
- **wr** (write-only) - 3 channels: AW, W, B (no read channels)
- **rd** (read-only) - 2 channels: AR, R (no write channels)

Benefits: 40-60% fewer ports for dedicated masters, less logic, faster synthesis

Q: "Can I add timing isolation to ports?"

A: Yes, use interface configuration:

```
masters = [
  {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_m_axi", ...,
   interface = {type = "axi4_master", skid_depths = {ar = 2, r = 4, aw
= 2, w = 4, b = 2}}}
]
```

Available interface types: - `"axi4_master"` - Timing isolation on master port - `"axi4_slave"` - Timing isolation on slave port - `"axi4_master_mon"` - Timing + monitoring - `"axi4_slave_mon"` - Timing + monitoring - Omit `interface` field for direct connection

Q: "Can I mix AXI4 and APB slaves?"

A: Yes, use protocol field in TOML:

```
slaves = [
  {name = "ddr", prefix = "ddr_s_axi", protocol = "axi4", ...},
  {name = "apb0", prefix = "apb0_", protocol = "apb", ...}
]
```

Generator inserts `axi4_to_apb4_shim` automatically. This is a real, complete conversion – burst decomposition, width slicing and response mapping – not a Phase-3 placeholder.

Q: “Can ports be AMBA5 (AXI5 / APB5)?”

A: Yes — per port; every wrapper feature rides the fabric natively (bridge TASK-002 (was BRIDGE-002), bridge TASK-004 (was BRIDGE-014), bridge TASK-007 (was BRIDGE-018)):

```
[[bridge.masters]]
protocol = "axi5"
axi5_features = ["trace", "atomic"]  #
nsaid/trace/mpam/mecid/unique/chunking are
                                     # droppable sideband;
poison/atomic/mte are
                                     # connectivity-gated (every
connected path
                                     # must be AXI5 + feature + width-
matched);
                                     # mte and chunking need 128-bit
ports;
                                     # wakeup = AWAKEUP (not path
sideband)

[[bridge.slaves]]
protocol = "apb5"   # APB4 rules apply (rw-only, 32-bit); adds the
APB5 pins
```

Sideband passes natively on width-matched AXI5<->AXI5 paths and terminates with a generation-time warning elsewhere. Read-return atomics forward natively on rw master ports (per-ID return tracker at the slave adapter); on write-only ports the boundary’s `axi5_atomic_filter` answers them with DECERR on B only (its owed R beats are drained inside the filter – a write-only port has no R channel; managers must not issue load-class atomics there). BIDUNQ/RIDUNQ are regenerated per ID at the master boundary, never routed. AXI5-Lite and APB5 are legal as MASTER protocols too (front-end converters). Details: `docs/bridge_has/ch04_interfaces/04_axi5_apb5_interfaces.md` and `docs/bridge_mas/ch02_blocks/10_amba5_boundary.md`.

Q: “Wishbone?” `protocol = "wb4"` on either side (bridge TASK-008 (was BRIDGE-019), HAS 4.6): `channels = "rw"`, `id_width = 0`, 8/16/32/64-bit. One Wishbone transfer is one single-beat AXI4 transaction; AXI bursts decompose to single Wishbone transfers; burst hints are carried, not formed. Best effort by decision – do not propose burst formation or a WB4 CDC port without a consumer.

Q: “What if data widths don’t match?”

A: Generator inserts width converters automatically:

```
masters = [
  {name = "cpu", data_width = 64, ...},  # 64b master
]
slaves = [
  {name = "ddr", data_width = 512, ...}  # 512b slave
```

```
]
# Generator creates width converter: 64b → 512b
```

Q: "Do all masters need to connect to all slaves?"

A: No, use partial connectivity in CSV:

```
master\slave,ddr,sram,apb
rapids_descr,1,1,0     # Connects to ddr and sram only
cpu,1,1,1              # Connects to all three
```

4.8.7 Generator Output Structure

Generated File Contains:

1. **Module Header** - NOT parameterized. The generator resolves every width and count at emission time, so the top module has no NUM_MASTERS / NUM_SLAVES parameters to override.
2. **Port Declarations** - custom prefix per port, channel-specific signals
3. **Internal Signals** - crossbar interface nets
4. **Width Converters** - master-side upsize instances (channel-aware)
5. **Crossbar Instance** - internal AXI4 crossbar
6. **Slave Adapters** - one per slave, carrying the `bridge_id` tracker: a `bridge_cam` keyed by ID for AXI4/AXI5 slaves of a multi-master bridge (or any `enable_ooo` slave), an in-order FIFO otherwise
7. **Subtractive slave** - `axi4_subtractive_slave`, ALWAYS emitted, wired to the decode `else`; answers unmapped addresses with DECERR (HAS 4.5)
8. **Protocol shims** - `axi4_to_apb4_shim` / `axi4_to_axil4_*` for apb/axil slaves. These are real conversions, not the Phase-3 TODO placeholders this list used to claim.
9. **Monitor subsystem** (monitored variants) - per-port wrappers, a `monbus_arbiter` tree and one `monbus_axil4_axil4_group`

Example Output Size: - Simple 2x2 bridge: 1,237 lines in the top file; 4,651 across all generated files for that variant (measured, not estimated). Formerly "~400" (plus per-master and per-slave adapters, a crossbar and a package). The "~400" this line used to claim predates monitors, the cfg subsystem and sideband routing. - Complex 5x3 with mixed protocols: 1,776 in the top file; 7,556 across all files. The old "~900" was smaller than the 2x2 figure beside it, which alone showed both were guesses. - Includes comprehensive comments and structure

4.8.8 Testing Generated Bridges

For Pure AXI4 Bridges (Working Now):

```
# Generate bridge (outputs to rtl/generated/<bridge_name>/)
python3 bridge_generator.py --ports test_configs/bridge_2x2_rw.toml

# Run its test (per-config TB classes live in dv/tbclasses/, e.g.
bridge2x2_rw_tb.py)
cd ../dv/tests
make clean-all && make run-bridge_2x2_rw-gate-parallel   # or -func /
-full, [-waves]
```

Tests are GENERATED too. `make regen` in `bin/` regenerates RTL only; the tests and TB classes come from `bridge_generator.py --bulk bridge_batch.csv --generate-tests`, which writes into `dv/tests` and `dv/tbclasses` per the manifest's own output columns (the `--output-*` flags do not override a bulk run). Regenerate them the same way you regenerate RTL: delete every file marked "Generated by bridge test generator", regenerate all, never hand-edit one. Hand-written tests for a generated DUT live in their own file beside it (`test_bridge_2x2_rw_tracking.py`, `test_bridge_*_sideband*.py`, `*_atomics.py`, `*_bfm5.py`).

For Mixed AXI4/APB: the APB path is complete: `axi4_to_apb4_shim` does real burst decomposition, width slicing and response mapping, and six configurations ship APB slaves with tests in the FULL regression. This line claimed placeholders long after the converter shipped.

4.9 Bridge Architecture Quick Reference

4.9.1 Generated Bridge Crossbar Structure

Illustrative shape (see `rtl/generated/bridge_2x2_rw/bridge_2x2_rw.sv` for a real example):

The generated top takes **no parameters at all** – every width is fixed at generation time and reaches the module through its package:

```
module bridge_2x2_rw
    import bridge_2x2_rw_pkg::*;
(
    input  logic aclk,
    input  logic aresetn,

    // Master-side interfaces (slave ports on bridge)
    // AW, W, B, AR, R channels for each master

    // Slave-side interfaces (master ports on bridge)
    // AW, W, B, AR, R channels for each slave
);
```

4.9.2 Key Features

1. **5-Channel Implementation:** Complete AW, W, B, AR, R routing
2. **Round-Robin Arbitration:** Per-slave arbitration with grant locking
3. **Response routing:** each slave adapter records, per direction, the `bridge_id` of the master whose request was accepted. With more than one master an AXI4/AXI5 slave uses `bridge_cam` (tag = fabric ID, data = `bridge_id`, DEPTH 16, duplicates allowed), looked up by the returned BID/RID. Single-master bridges, apb/axil/wb shim slaves and the internal subtractive slave use a small in-order FIFO instead (`enable_ooo` forces the CAM on any slave).
4. **ID widening (bridge TASK-005):** inside the fabric every ID is `{BRIDGE_ID, master id}` – the master adapter prepends `$clog2(NUM_MASTERS)` index bits and strips them on B/R. In `bridge_2x2_rw` a 4-bit master ID is 5-bit at the slave port (`XBAR_ID_WIDTH` in `<name>_pkg.sv`); a slave's declared `id_width` must be at least that or the validator rejects the config. One master adds zero bits. A FIFO-tracked slave must still complete in request order (FR-2 in the PRD).
5. **Configurable Parameters:** NxM topology, data/addr/ID widths

4.9.3 Address Map

There is no default address map and no 0x10000000 stride. Windows come from each slave's `base_addr` / `addr_range` in the TOML and are baked into the decode. `bridge_2x2_rw` splits the space in half:

- Slave 0 (ddr): 0x00000000 - 0x7FFFFFFF
- Slave 1 (sram): 0x80000000 - 0xFFFFFFFF

Probing 0x1000_0000 expecting "slave 1" hits slave 0.

4.10 Test Organization

Runners are flat in `dv/tests/`: `test_bridge_<config>.py` per configuration, `test_bridge_*_mon_monitor.py` for monitor-stress builds, plus `monitor_stress_common.py` and `conftest.py`. `make list` enumerates them.

4.10.1 Test Levels

Three real levels, both mechanisms, every test (45 of 45 under `bin/review/check_test_levels.py`): each wrapper's `generate_bridge_levels()` branches on `REG_LEVEL` (GATE 72 / FUNC 144 / FULL 216 cells) and exports `TEST_LEVEL` + `SEED` per cell; the TB reads the depth profile from `dv/tbclasses/bridge_levels.py`. Do NOT stamp `TEST_LEVEL` into `os.environ` from a conftest – cocotb_test lets the environment override `extra_env`, and that ran all 216 cells at one depth once (tooling BUG-004, was TOOL-016).

Per-Config Functional Tests (generated): basic connectivity, boundary probe, arbitration (multi-master). Every AXI5 master port carries an `AXI5ComplianceChecker`; every test asserts zero violations.

Monitor Stress Tests (`*_mon_monitor.py`) (generated): bridges built with monitor interfaces, monbus traffic / WRITE_BP / ERR_BP phases scaled by level.

Hand-written: bridge BUG-009 (was BRIDGE-011) tracking + latency on 2x2; the AMBA5 sign-off tests (sideband values, sideband through arbitration, sideband across a width converter, atomics incl. Compare, AXI5 read BFM sign-off).

4.11 Common User Questions and Responses

4.11.1 Q: "How does the Bridge work?"

A: Direct answer:

The Bridge AXI4 crossbar connects multiple AXI4 masters to multiple slaves:

1. **Address Decode (AW/AR):** Routes master requests to appropriate slave based on address
2. **Write Path:** AW → arbitration → slave, W follows locked grant
3. **Read Path:** AR → arbitration → slave, R returns via the slave adapter's `bridge_id` tracker (CAM or FIFO, see below)
4. **Arbitration:** Per-slave round-robin, AW and AR only, with the grant locked until the ADDRESS handshake – not until burst complete. W is owned via a FIFO; B and R have no arbiter.
5. **Response Routing:** each slave adapter stores the originating master's `bridge_id` on the address handshake. For AXI4/AXI5 slaves of a multi-master bridge (or any `enable_ooo` slave) that store is a `bridge_cam` looked up by the returned BID/RID, so a slave may complete out of order across IDs. Single-master bridges and shim/subtractive slaves use an in-order FIFO keyed on position. IDs are widened to `{BRIDGE_ID, id}` in the fabric (4-bit master ID -> 5-bit slave ID in `bridge_2x2_rw`) and narrowed back in the master adapter.

Key Features: - Configurable NxM topology - One fabric clock; an AXI4 slave port declared `cdc = true` runs on its own clock behind `axi4_cdc_{wr,rd}` (HAS 4.5a), and an `apb`/`apb5` slave crosses domains inside its own shim (two async FIFOs) - Crossbar options: `xbar_pipeline = true` (registered slave-side channels – needed on the Artix-7 at 100 MHz beyond a plain 2x2, HAS 6.4) and `arbitration = "qos"` with `qos_aging_shift` (HAS 6.8a) - Out-of-context synthesis of any fixture: `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/fpga/` (`make synth BRIDGE=<fixture> PART=<part> CLK_NS=<ns>`), measured tables in HAS 5.3 - Subtractive catch-all: an unmapped address gets DECERR + 0xDEADBEEF and a sticky status/IRQ instead of hanging the master (HAS 4.5)

Deliberately NOT supported – these were claimed here for months and none of them is built: - Out-of-order responses. Ordering is structural: one target slave per master at a time (`aw_gate_ok`), and each slave port must return B/R in request order across all IDs (bridge BUG-008, was BRIDGE-010). - Burst-locked arbitration. The grant releases at the address handshake, as item 4 above already said – this bullet contradicted it directly. - Configurable arbitration policy. Round-robin is hard-coded.

See: - `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/PRD.md` - Complete specification - `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin/bridge_generator.py` - Generator implementation

4.11.2 Q: "How do I generate a Bridge?"

A: Use the bridge_generator.py tool:

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/bin
python3 bridge_generator.py --ports test_configs/bridge_2x2_rw.toml
# Auto-finds test_configs/bridge_2x2_rw_connectivity.csv
# Or regenerate everything: make all  (bulk from bridge_batch.csv)
```

Generated files: - RTL: `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/rtl/generated/<bridge_name>/` (top module, crossbar, adapters, package) - Contains complete 5-channel crossbar with ID tracking

4.11.3 Q: "How do I test a Bridge?"

Import the generated TB for that configuration; the runner is generated beside it.

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/dv/tests
make clean-all && make run-bridge_2x2_rw-gate   # serial by design,
~1GB per test
```

`dv/tests/test_bridge_2x2_rw.py` is the full shape.

4.12 PDF Generation Location

Both books build into `docs/` through the wrapper scripts, which apply the house style:

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/docs
./generate_has_pdf.sh    # Bridge_HAS_v<rev> from bridge_has/
./generate_mas_pdf.sh    # Bridge_MAS_v<rev> from bridge_mas/
```

They call `bin/md_to_docx.py`, which follows the index links, demotes headings and builds the ToC. Pipeline detail: `vault/handbook/authoring/doc-pipeline.md`.

Maintained By: RTL Design Sherpa Project

(The version and date for this file are in the header at the top. A second stamp here said 1.0 / 2025-10-18 while the header said 2.1 / 2025-11-03 – two stamps in one file guarantee one of them is wrong.)

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

5 Document Information

5.1 Bridge Hardware Architecture Specification

Property	Value
Document Title	Bridge Hardware Architecture Specification
Version	2.0
Date	September 8, 2026
Status	Released
Classification	Open Source - MIT License

5.2 Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Description
1.0	2026-01-03	RTL Design Sherpa	Initial release - restructured from single spec
1.1	2026-06-04	RTL Design Sherpa	Content sync to RTL state at 2026-06-04. Documents (1) the 64→128-bit monbus packet migration with new 64-bit side-band timestamp wire — referenced via `docs/markdown/rtl-amba/includes/ocelus_package_spec.md`; (2) per-port + global SV-parameter monitor methodology with mandatory `use_monitor` TOML field and `variants = ["no","mon"]` generator selector; (3) generator-emitted AXI4↔AXIL conversion at the slave boundary (was external); (4) new AXIL→wider-slave master-side alignment converters (`axil_to_axi4_wide_align_{rd,wr}`); (5) verification-strategy rewrite to protocol-BFM-only TBs with memory-backed slaves, serial-only execution, per-module cocotb function names, boundary_probe (renamed from address_decode) tests;

Version	Date	Author	Description
			(6) note of the independent W-tracker FIFO + split AW/W-ready MUX fix (commit `d24bd617`) that closed an interleaved-master deadlock.
1.2	2026-09-08	RTL Design Sherpa	Correctness and voice pass. Four external qc rounds (65/54/53/57 findings, all triaged against rtl/generated and the generator) removed the planned-but-never-built ID-table/CAM out-of-order scheme, the fixed 64-bit internal path, response arbitration/FIFOs and the AXI4-Lite-as-future-work status from the text; annotated the TOML keys the loader has never known and its three-tier unknown-key behaviour; replaced asserted latency figures with measured ones. Four RTL defects found by the rounds are fixed and mutation-checked (bridge BUG-009 (was BRIDGE-011) response-FIFO overrun, axi4_subtractive_slave simultaneous AW+AR fault loss, axi5_atomic_filter duplicate B and B-before-WLAST). Prose then voice-

Version	Date	Author	Description
			passed with all correctness annotations preserved.
1.3	2026-09-11	RTL Design Sherpa	bridge TASK-004 (was BRIDGE-014): AXI5-Lite and APB/APB5 as master protocols (front-end converters); bridge TASK-005 (was BRIDGE-016) slave ID widening
1.4	2026-09-11	RTL Design Sherpa	bridge TASK-008 (was BRIDGE-019): Wishbone B4 on both sides of the fabric
1.5	2026-09-11	RTL Design Sherpa	bridge TASK-006 (was BRIDGE-017): measured throughput and latency, registered crossbar, QoS arbitration, CDC slave ports, out-of-context synthesis flow and measured resources, CAM ordering-count fix
1.6	2026-09-13	RTL Design Sherpa	bridge TASK-007 (was BRIDGE-018): native AXI5 fabric – Memory Tagging and read-data chunking through the structs
1.7	2026-09-13	RTL Design Sherpa	Document sync: one fabric clock plus CDC ports throughout, Wishbone best-effort stance, out-of-order chunk proof
2.0	2026-10-12	RTL Design Sherpa	Protocol-set correction: overview/summary bullets now state the full eight-protocol support

Version	Date	Author	Description
			(axi3/axi4/axi5/axil/axil5/apb/apb5/wb4 — per-port, slave or master side) verified against `bin/bridge_pkg/config_validator.py`; explicit “ACE coherency NOT supported” section added to ch03. Version strings aligned across index/front-matter/renders.

5.3 Document Purpose

This Hardware Architecture Specification (HAS) is the high-level view of the Bridge component — the map you read before you integrate, not the schematic. It covers:

- System-level architecture and data flow
- Protocol support (AXI3, AXI4, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI5-Lite, APB, APB5, Wishbone B4 — per-port, slave or master side; ACE coherency NOT supported)
- Interface definitions and requirements
- Performance characteristics
- Integration guidelines

For micro-architecture, FSM designs, and signal-level detail, see the companion **Bridge Micro-Architecture Specification (MAS)**.

5.4 Intended Audience

- System architects defining interconnect topology
- Hardware engineers integrating Bridge into SoC designs
- Verification engineers planning test strategies
- Technical managers evaluating Bridge capabilities

5.5 Related Documents

- **Bridge MAS** - Micro-Architecture Specification (detailed block-level)
- **PRD.md** - Product requirements and overview
- **CLAUDE.md** - AI development guide

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

6 Purpose and Scope

6.1 What is Bridge?

Bridge is a Python-based multi-protocol crossbar generator. You describe the interconnect in human-readable configuration files; it hands you back parameterized SystemVerilog RTL. The generated AXI4 crossbars come with automatic support for:

- **Protocol conversion** - AXI3, AXI4, AXI5, AXI4-Lite, AXI5-Lite, APB, APB5, and Wishbone B4 interfaces, on slave or master ports (selected per port in the TOML; ACE coherency is NOT supported)
- **Width conversion** - Automatic upsize/downsize for data width mismatches
- **Channel-specific masters** - Write-only, read-only, or full AXI4 masters

6.2 The Problem Bridge Solves

A hand-written AXI4 crossbar is error-prone. Building one means:

1. Writing 5 separate channel multiplexers (AW, W, B, AR, R)
2. Implementing per-slave arbitration for each channel
3. Routing responses back to the issuing master, including slaves that complete different IDs out of order
4. Handling burst locking and interleaving constraints
5. Inserting width converters for data width mismatches
6. Inserting protocol converters for mixed systems — APB/APB5, AXI4-Lite/AXI5-Lite, AXI3, or Wishbone B4 peripherals behind an AXI4 fabric (and vice versa)
7. Wiring hundreds of signals with consistent naming

Every item on that list is a place a bug can sit quietly until integration. I've chased most of them at least once.

Bridge automates all of it:

- Define ports and connectivity in configuration files
- Run the generator script
- Get production-ready SystemVerilog RTL

6.3 Scope

This specification covers:

- High-level architecture and block organization
- Supported protocols and conversion capabilities
- Interface requirements and signal conventions
- Performance characteristics and resource estimates
- Integration guidelines and verification strategy

6.4 Out of Scope

These live in the companion MAS:

- Detailed FSM state diagrams and transitions
- Signal-level timing diagrams
- Internal pipeline structures
- RTL implementation details

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

7 Document Conventions

7.1 Terminology

Table 1.1: Common Terminology

Term	Definition
Master	AXI4 initiator that issues transactions
Slave	AXI4 target that responds to transactions
Crossbar	NxM interconnect connecting masters to slaves
Channel	AXI4 communication path (AW, W, B, AR, R)
Converter	Logic that transforms width or protocol

7.2 Signal Naming

Bridge uses consistent signal prefixes — learn them once and every generated interface reads the same way:

Table 1.2: Signal Naming Prefixes

Prefix	Meaning
`s_*`	Slave-side interface (master port on bridge)
`m_*`	Master-side interface (slave port on bridge)
`axi4_*`	AXI4 protocol signals
`apb_*`	APB protocol signals
`cfg_*`	Configuration signals
`dbg_*`	Debug signals

7.3 Diagrams

7.3.1 Figure 1.1: Block Diagram Legend

Block diagrams in this specification use these symbols:

Table 1.3: Block Diagram Symbols

Symbol	Meaning
White rectangle	External port or interface (masters at the top, slaves at the bottom)
Shaded rectangle	Functional block; the second line names the owning RTL
Solid arrow	A flow, labeled with what it carries: requests down, responses back up their own lane
Heavy arrow	The main flow out of a decision point, or a path on a clock other than `aclk`
Dashed arrow	Sideband: tracking writes, configuration, clocks
Dashed box	Optional or build-dependent block
Trapezium, wide edge up	A many-to-one pick (the per-slave arbiter): contenders enter the wide edge

7.4 Code Examples

SystemVerilog examples are formatted like this:

```
// Module instantiation example
bridge_4x4 u_bridge (
    .aclk       (sys_clk),
    .aresetn    (sys_rst_n),
    // ... port connections
);
```

7.5 Parameter Notation

Parameter tables throughout the spec use this format:

Table 1.4: Parameter Format Example

Parameter	Type	Range	Default	Description
NUM_MASTERS	int	1-32	2	Number of master ports
NUM_SLAVES	int	1-256	2	Number of slave ports

8 Definitions and Acronyms

8.1 Acronyms

Table 1.5: Acronyms and Abbreviations

Acronym	Definition
AMBA	Advanced Microcontroller Bus Architecture
APB	Advanced Peripheral Bus
AR	AXI4 Read Address channel
AW	AXI4 Write Address channel
AXI	Advanced eXtensible Interface
AXI4	AXI Protocol Version 4
B	AXI4 Write Response channel
BID	Bridge ID (internal master identifier)
CAM	Content-Addressable Memory
CDC	Clock Domain Crossing
CSV	Comma-Separated Values
DECERR	Decode Error (AXI response)
DMA	Direct Memory Access
FIFO	First-In First-Out buffer
FSM	Finite State Machine
HAS	Hardware Architecture Specification
ID	Transaction Identifier
MAS	Micro-Architecture Specification
MUX	Multiplexer
NxM	N masters by M slaves (topology notation)
OOO	Out-of-Order
OOR	Out-of-Range
QoS	Quality of Service

Acronym	Definition
R	AXI4 Read Data channel
RTL	Register-Transfer Level
SLVERR	Slave Error (AXI response)
SoC	System-on-Chip
TOML	Tom’s Obvious Minimal Language
W	AXI4 Write Data channel

8.2 Definitions

Address Decode: Determining which slave receives a transaction, from its address.

Arbitration: Selecting which master gets a slave when several masters contend for it.

Bridge ID (BID): The issuing master's index, width clog2(NUM_MASTERS). With more than one master it is both prepended to the AXI ID inside the fabric (slave-side IDs are `{BRIDGE_ID, id}`, wider than master-side ones) and carried as a sideband into the slave adapter's response tracker (a `bridge_cam` or an in-order FIFO), which routes B and R back to the master.

Channel-Specific Master: A master that uses only a subset of AXI4 channels (write-only or read-only).

Crossbar: An NxM interconnect allowing any master to communicate with any connected slave.

Grant Locking: Mechanism that holds arbitration grant until transaction completes.

Out-of-Order Response: (defined for completeness; NOT supported by this bridge) Responses returned in different order than requests were issued.

Protocol Conversion: Transformation between different bus protocols (e.g., AXI4 to APB).

Response Routing: Directing B/R channel responses back to the originating master.

Round-Robin Arbitration: Fair arbitration where priority rotates among requesters.

Width Conversion: Transformation between different data bus widths (upsize or downsize).

9 Use Cases

9.1 Primary Applications

9.1.1 SoC Interconnects

In SoC designs, Bridge is the main interconnect fabric:

- **Multi-core processor memory subsystems** - Connect multiple CPU cores to shared memory
- **Accelerator integration** - Route GPU, DSP, or custom accelerator traffic
- **DMA engine routing** - Connect DMA controllers to memory and peripherals
- **Peripheral bus bridges** - Convert AXI4 to APB for low-speed peripherals

9.1.2 Memory Systems

Typical memory-system uses:

- **Multi-port DDR controllers** - Multiple masters accessing shared DDR
- **SRAM buffer sharing** - Shared packet buffers for networking
- **Cache coherency interconnects** - Connect cache controllers
- **Memory-mapped I/O** - Unified address space for peripherals

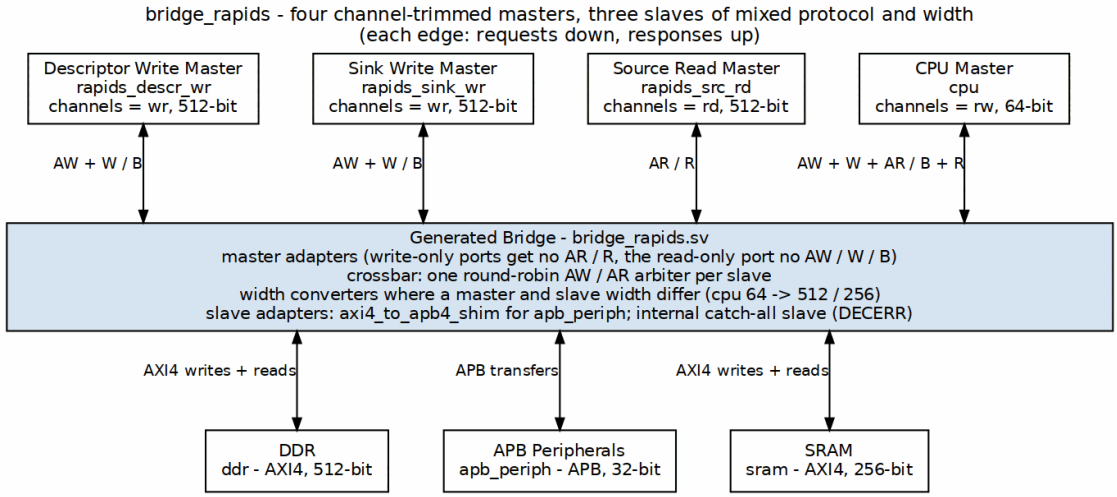
9.1.3 Accelerator Systems

Bridge supports custom accelerator architectures like RAPIDS:

- **Descriptor write masters** - Write control descriptors (write-only)
- **Sink write masters** - Write incoming data packets (write-only)
- **Source read masters** - Read outgoing data packets (read-only)
- **CPU configuration** - Full access for register configuration

9.2 Example: RAPIDS Accelerator

9.2.1 Figure 2.1: RAPIDS System Topology



RAPIDS System Topology

Bridge topology for RAPIDS accelerator with channel-specific masters.

9.2.2 Configuration

```
[bridge]
  name = "bridge_rapids"
  masters = [
    {name = "rapids_descr_wr", channels = "wr", data_width = 512},
    {name = "rapids_sink_wr", channels = "wr", data_width = 512},
    {name = "rapids_src_rd", channels = "rd", data_width = 512},
    {name = "cpu", channels = "rw", data_width = 64}
  ]
  slaves = [
    {name = "ddr", protocol = "axi4", data_width = 512},
    {name = "apb_periph", protocol = "apb", data_width = 32},
    {name = "sram", protocol = "axi4", data_width = 256}
  ]
```

9.2.3 Benefits

- **40% fewer channels** for write-only masters (3 of 5: AW, W, B)
- **60% fewer channels** for read-only masters (2 of 5: AR, R)

Those are CHANNEL counts, which is the honest way to state it – the saving in actual wires depends on the widths. At DW=64/AW=32/IW=4/UW=1 the five channels are roughly 295 bits, and dropping AR+R saves about 48% of them while dropping AW+W+B saves about 52%; at DW=512 it is nearer 47%/53%. Earlier revisions of this page quoted “39%” and “61%”, which match neither

basis. - **Automatic width conversion** for 64b CPU to 512b DDR - **Protocol conversion** for APB peripheral access

9.3 Rapid Prototyping

Bridge accelerates design exploration:

- **Quick topology exploration** - Try different master/slave configurations
- **Performance analysis** - Evaluate arbitration and bandwidth
- **Design space exploration** - Compare resource usage
- **Educational projects** - Learn AXI4 protocol and interconnects

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

10 Key Features

10.1 Configuration-Driven Generation

10.1.1 CSV/TOML Configuration

Everything about a Bridge instance is set in human-readable text files:

- **ports configuration** - Define each master and slave port
- **connectivity matrix** - Specify which masters connect to which slaves
- **Version-control friendly** - Text-based, easy to diff and review

10.1.2 Example Configuration

Port Definition (TOML):

```
masters = [
  {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_m_axi", data_width = 64, channels =
"rw"},
  {name = "dma", prefix = "dma_m_axi", data_width = 256, channels =
"rw"}
]
slaves = [
  {name = "ddr", prefix = "ddr_s_axi", data_width = 512, protocol =
"axi4"},
  {name = "uart", prefix = "uart_apb", data_width = 32, protocol =
"apb"}
]
```

Connectivity Matrix (CSV):

```
master\slave,ddr,uart
cpu,1,1
dma,1,0
```

10.2 Multi-Protocol Support

Table 2.1: Supported Protocols

Master Protocol	Slave Protocol	Conversion Type
AXI4	AXI4	Direct or width convert
AXI4	AXI4-Lite	Protocol downgrade
AXI4	APB	Full protocol conversion
AXI5	AXI4 / AXI4-Lite / APB	Base-subset interop; sideband terminates at the boundary (warning)
AXI5	AXI5 (width-matched)	Native sideband pass-through; atomics (read-return classes need an rw port); poison
AXI4 / AXI5	APB5	APB4 conversion core + APB5 sideband surface
AXI4-Lite / AXI5-Lite	any	Lite requester: single-beat AXI4 inside; the AXI5-Lite ID and `user` group ride the fabric, the rest terminate at the boundary
APB / APB5	any	APB requester: `apb4_to_axi4` / `apb5_to_axi4` front end, one AXI4 transaction per transfer, SLVERR and DECERR fold to PSLVERR
any	Wishbone B4	`axi4_to_wb4`: one Wishbone transfer per AXI4 beat, ERR/RTY fold to SLVERR
Wishbone B4	any	`wb4_to_axi4` front end: single-beat AXI4 inside, SLVERR/DECERR terminate ERR

AMBA5 ports are declared per port (`protocol = "axi5"` / `"axil5"` / `"apb5"` with an optional `axi5_features` list); the fabric stays AXI4 internally. Every protocol value is legal on a master port as well as a slave port (bridge TASK-004, was BRIDGE-014). See AXI5 and APB5 Interfaces.

10.2.1 Protocol Features

- **AXI4 Full** - Complete 5-channel implementation with bursts
- **AXI4-Lite** - Simplified single-beat transactions
- **APB** - Low-power peripheral access
- **Wishbone B4** - The open FPGA bus, pipelined mode, on either side (bridge TASK-008, was BRIDGE-019)

10.3 Channel-Specific Masters

10.3.1 Write-Only Masters (wr)

Generate only write channels: - AW (Write Address) - W (Write Data) - B (Write Response)

Use case: DMA write engines, descriptor writers

10.3.2 Read-Only Masters (rd)

Generate only read channels: - AR (Read Address) - R (Read Data)

Use case: DMA read engines, source data fetchers

10.3.3 Full Masters (rw)

Generate all five channels for complete read/write capability.

Use case: CPU interfaces, configuration masters

10.3.4 Resource Savings

Table 2.2: Channel-Specific Resource Savings

Master Type	Channels	Signal Reduction
Write-only (wr)	3 of 5	40% fewer channels (~48% fewer wires at DW=64)
Read-only (rd)	2 of 5	60% fewer channels (~52% fewer wires at DW=64)
Full (rw)	5 of 5	Baseline

10.4 Automatic Converters

10.4.1 Width Conversion

Bridge automatically inserts width converters:

- **Upsize** - Narrow master to wide slave (e.g., 64b to 512b)
- **Downsize** - Wide master to narrow slave (e.g., 512b to 32b)
- **Per-path** - Only where needed, not global conversion

10.4.2 Protocol Conversion

Bridge inserts protocol converters for mixed systems:

- **AXI4 to APB** - Full conversion with burst handling
- **AXI4 to AXI4-Lite** - Simplified conversion

10.5 Flexible Topology

10.5.1 Scalability

- **Masters:** 1-32 master ports
- **Slaves:** 1-256 slave ports
- **Partial connectivity** - Not all masters need access to all slaves

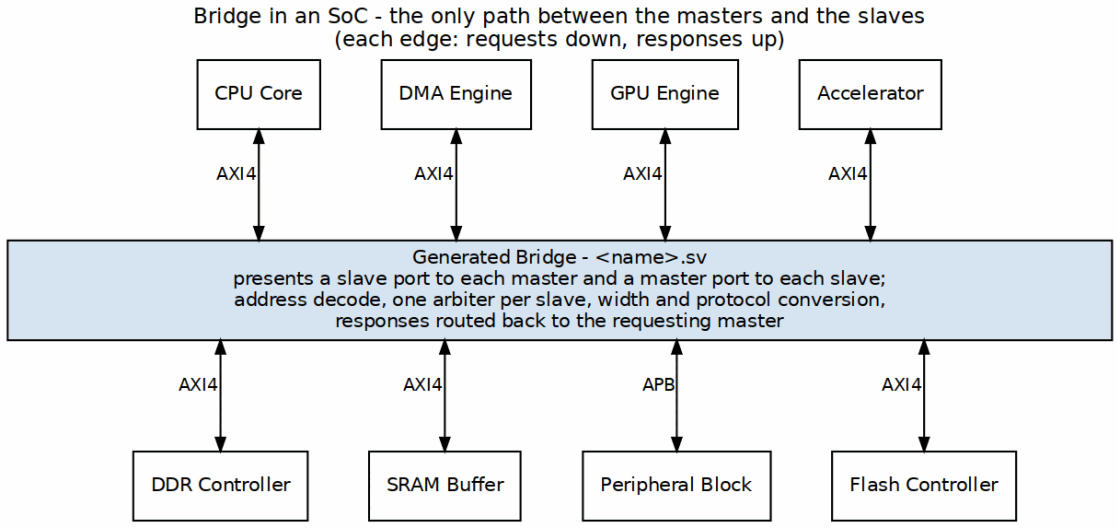
10.5.2 Mixed Configurations

- **Mixed protocols** - AXI4, AXI4-Lite, and APB slaves in same crossbar
- **Mixed data widths** - 32b, 64b, 128b, 256b, 512b
- **Mixed channels** - Write-only, read-only, and full masters

11 System Context

11.1 Bridge in SoC Architecture

11.1.1 Figure 2.2: Bridge System Context



Bridge System Context

Bridge as central interconnect connecting masters to slaves with protocol conversion.

11.2 Interface Boundaries

11.2.1 Master-Side (Upstream)

Bridge presents slave interfaces to upstream masters:

- Accepts AXI4 transactions from masters
- Provides flow control via ready signals
- Returns responses (B/R channels) to correct master

11.2.2 Slave-Side (Downstream)

Bridge presents master interfaces to downstream slaves:

- Issues AXI4/APB transactions to slaves
- Accepts responses from slaves
- Routes responses back through ID tracking

11.3 Address Space

11.3.1 Address Map Organization

Each slave occupies a configurable address region:

Table 2.3: Address Map Organization

Slave	Base Address	Address Range	Size
Slave 0	`base_addr` from its own TOML entry	`addr_range`	Variable
Slave 1	`base_addr` from its own TOML entry	`addr_range`	Variable
Slave N	`base_addr` from its own TOML entry	`addr_range`	Variable

Windows are not derived from a single BASE and are not contiguous. Each slave carries its own `base_addr`, subject only to 4 KB alignment and non-overlap (Parameters). An earlier revision of this table showed `BASE + addr_range_0` and "sum of previous ranges", which no shipped config follows – `bridge_mix_d` places a 1 GB `ddr` at `0x0000_0000`, a 4 KB `doorbell` at `0x4000_0000` and a 64 KB `apb_periph` at `0x4000_1000`, and gaps between windows are legal (they decode-miss).

11.3.2 Address Decode

- **Subtractive decode** - the ranges are tested in order and the chain ends in an `else`, so the one-hot result is *never* all-zero
- **One-hot result** - exactly one slave selected per transaction, always
- **Out-of-range** - an address matching no slave range selects the internal subtractive slave, which completes the transaction with **DECERR** and `0xDEADBEEF` read data rather than leaving it unanswered

Until 2026-09-07 the last bullet was aspirational: the decode chain had no `else`, so an unmapped address produced an all-zero select, no slave ever saw AWVALID/ARVALID, READY never rose, and **the master waited forever**. A hang is the worst available failure here because it destroys the evidence – there is no response to inspect, no error bit to read, and the offending address is whatever the master still has latched. See 4.5 for the status/interrupt path that now reports it.

11.4 Clock and Reset

11.4.1 Clock Domain

- **One fabric clock** - All Bridge logic and every master port synchronous to `aclk`
- **CDC slave ports** - An AXI4 slave declared `cdc = true` runs on its own `<slave>_aclk` behind an async-FIFO crossing (HAS 4.5a); other slaves share `aclk`

11.4.2 Reset

- **Active-low asynchronous** - Standard `aresetn` convention
- **Full reset** - All internal state cleared on reset
- **Transaction safety** - Outstanding transactions aborted on reset

11.5 Dependencies

11.5.1 Required Infrastructure

- AXI4-compliant masters and slaves
- Proper clock and reset distribution
- Address map configuration matching slave address ranges

11.5.2 Optional Features

- Width converters (only if widths mismatch)
- Protocol converters (only if protocols differ)
- Per-slave response tracker: `bridge_cam` by ID for multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slaves (or `enable_ooo`), an in-order bridge_id FIFO otherwise

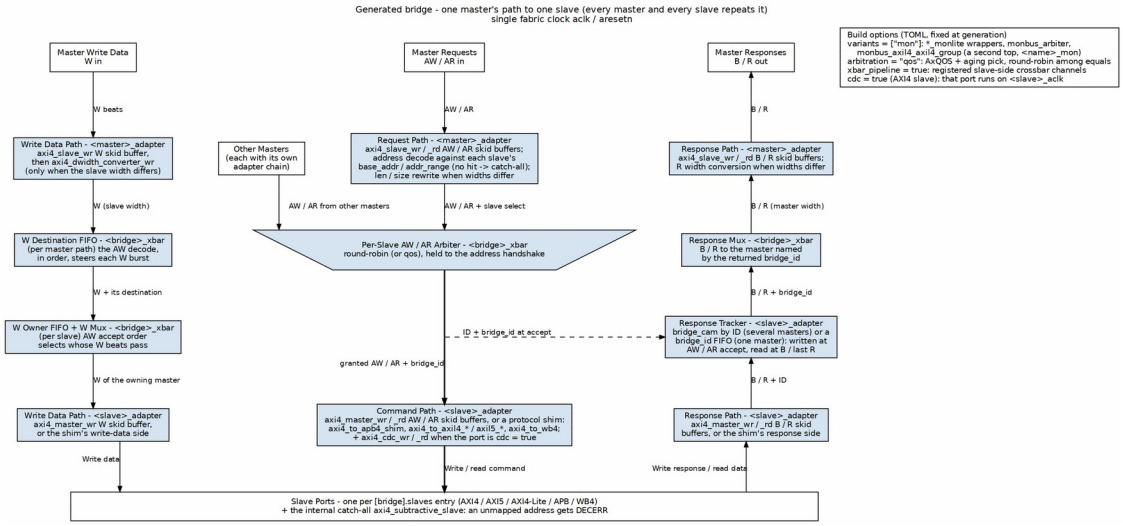
11.6 References

- Jantsch & Tenhunen (eds.), *Networks on Chip*, Kluwer 2003 — the resource-network-interface (RNI) concept that Bridge's master/slave adapters map to: a protocol-dependent wrapper plus a resource-independent crossbar side (ch5 §3.4.2). (Reference archive)
- Eschemann, *The FPGA Programming Handbook*, Packt 2023 — educational secondary source noting that an AXI interconnect's cost scales with active masters, buffering, and whether it is a full crossbar (ch8 §8.3). (Reference archive)

12 Block Diagram

12.1 Bridge Architecture Overview

12.1.1 Figure 3.1: Bridge Block Diagram



Bridge Block Diagram

One master's path through the generated bridge to one slave; every master and every slave repeats it. Write data drops down the left lane, requests take the center through the per-slave arbiter (the trapezium, where every master's AW / AR contend), and B / R responses climb the right lane back to the master named by the returned `bridge_id`. The response tracker in the slave adapter is written at AW / AR accept (dashed) and read when the response returns.

12.2 Functional Blocks

12.2.1 Master Adapter

One per master (`<master>_adapter`), receives transactions from the upstream master:

- **Skid buffers** - `axi4_slave_wr` / `axi4_slave_rd` register every channel at the port
- **Address decode** - a one-hot slave select from each slave's `base_addr` / `addr_range`; no hit selects the catch-all
- **Width conversion** - `axi4_dwidth_converter_wr` / `_rd`, one path per distinct slave width, only where the widths differ
- **Fabric ID** - the AXI ID is prefixed with the master's `BRIDGE_ID` (`{BRIDGE_ID, id}`), so a slave port's ID is wider than a master port's

12.2.2 Crossbar Core

Central switching fabric (`<bridge>_xbar`):

- **5-channel routing** - Independent AW, W, B, AR, R paths
- **Arbitration** - one AW and one AR arbiter per slave, round-robin (or `arbitration = "qos"`), grant held until the address handshake
- **W steering** - a W destination FIFO per master path and a W owner FIFO per slave keep each W burst with its AW
- **Response muxes** - B and R return to the master named by the `bridge_id` the slave adapter hands back

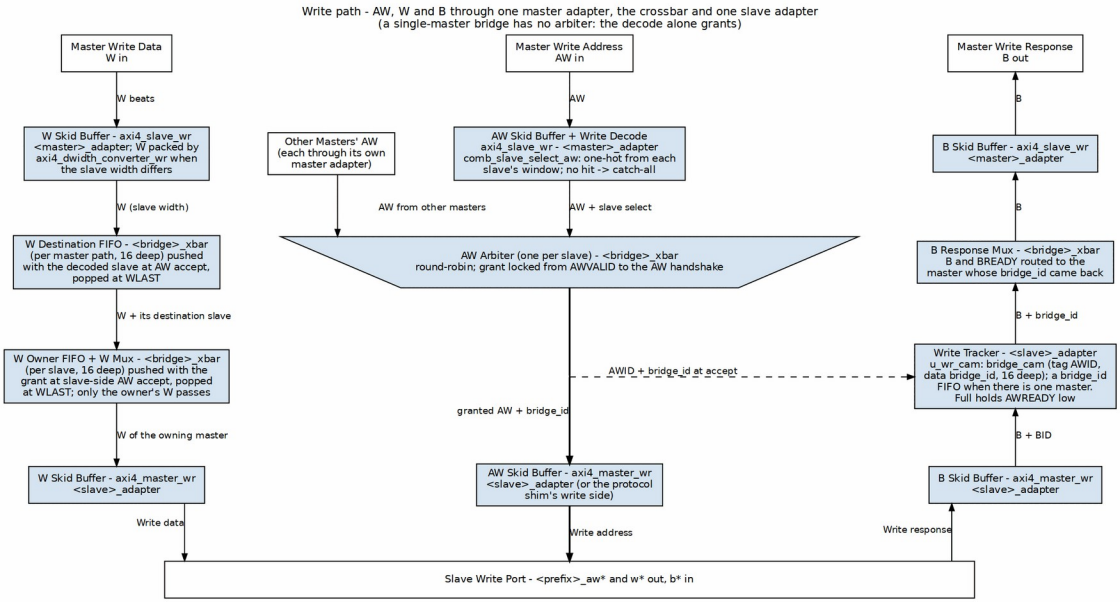
12.2.3 Slave Adapter

One per slave (`<slave>_adapter`), delivers transactions to the downstream slave:

- **Response tracking** - `bridge_cam` keyed by AXI ID when several masters share the slave, or an in-order `bridge_id` FIFO when one master does; written at AW / AR accept, read at B / last R
- **Skid buffers or protocol conversion** - `axi4_master_wr` / `_rd`, or `axi4_to_apb4_shim`, `axi4_to_axil4_*` / `axi4_to_axil5_*`, `axi4_to_wb4`
- **Clock crossing** - `axi4_cdc_wr` / `_rd` when the slave port is `cdc = true`

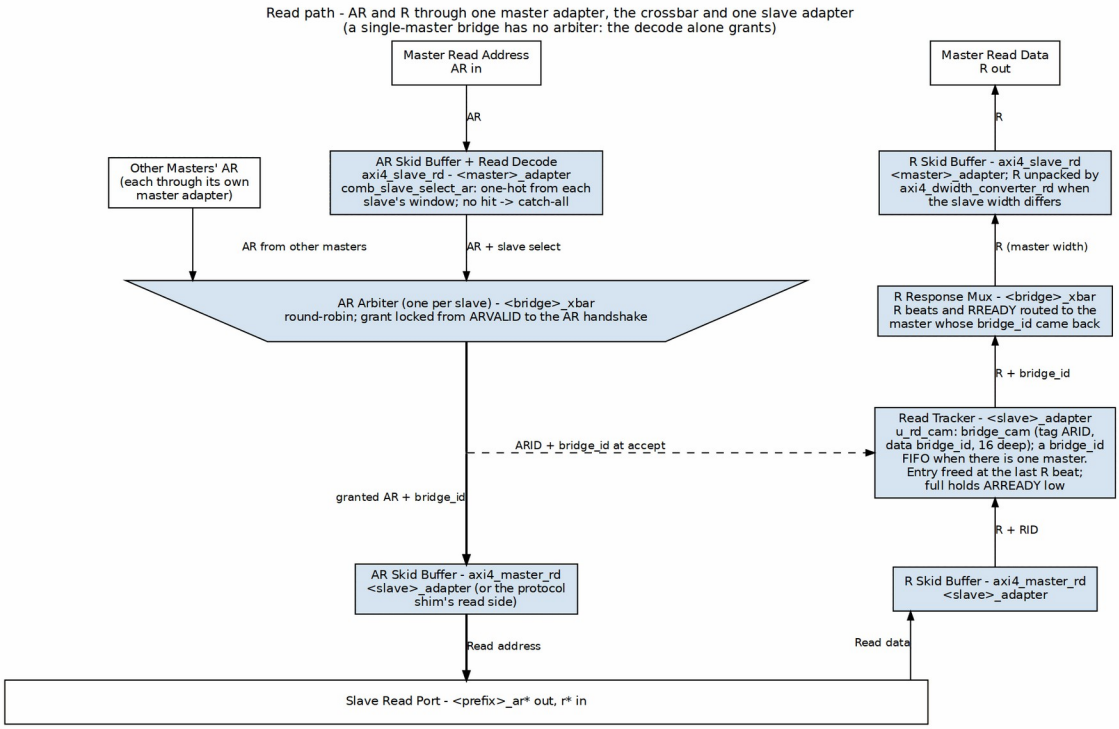
12.3 Data Flow

12.3.1 Figure 3.2: Write Path



Write Path Flow

12.3.2 Figure 3.3: Read Path



Read Path Flow

12.4 Scalability

12.4.1 Topology Parameters

Table 3.1: Topology Parameter Scaling

Parameter	Range	Impact
NUM_MASTERS	1-32	Linear MUX growth
NUM_SLAVES	1-256	Linear decoder growth
DATA_WIDTH	32-512	Linear data path growth
ID_WIDTH	1-16	Scales the ID wires (slave side carries {BRIDGE_ID, id}) and the tracker CAM tags

12.4.2 Resource Scaling

- **Logic:** O(M x N) for crossbar core
- **Routing:** O(M + N) for address/response paths
- **Memory:** O(M x outstanding) for ID tracking

12.5 References

- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — per-slave arbiters on AW and AR as the degenerate case of a separable allocator (ch18 §19.3), and skid buffers as buffered flow control (ch12). (Reference archive)
- Roy, *Advanced Digital System Design*, Springer 2023 — AXI permits W to trail AW independently; the W-owner FIFO records the AW grant so the data path follows the address decision (§18.2.3). (Reference archive)
- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — deterministic routing preserves order only along a single path; safe out-of-order completion requires explicit ID-keyed tracking such as the CAM mode Bridge keeps available (ch3/4). (Reference archive)

13 Data Flow

13.1 Transaction Flow Overview

13.1.1 Write Transaction Flow

1. **Master issues AW** - Address and control information
2. **Bridge decodes address** - Determines target slave
3. **Arbitration** - Grants access if multiple masters contend
4. **AW forwarded to slave** - ID unchanged; the originating master is pushed onto the slave adapter's `bridge_id` FIFO
5. **Master sends W data** - Following the granted AW
6. **W forwarded to slave** - Using same grant
7. **Slave returns B response** - with the master's own ID; the FIFO head selects the destination
8. **Bridge routes B to master** - Using ID to find originator

13.1.2 Read Transaction Flow

1. **Master issues AR** - Address and control information
2. **Bridge decodes address** - Determines target slave
3. **Arbitration** - Grants access if multiple masters contend
4. **AR forwarded to slave** - ID unchanged; master recorded in the read `bridge_id` FIFO
5. **Slave returns R data** - Potentially multiple beats
6. **Bridge routes R to master** - Using ID to find originator

13.2 Channel Independence

13.2.1 AXI4 Channel Separation

Each AXI4 channel operates independently:

Table 3.2: AXI4 Channel Summary

Channel	Direction	Contents	Arbitration
AW	Master to Slave	Write address	Per-slave
W	Master to Slave	Write data	Follows AW grant
B	Slave to Master	Write response	ID-based routing
AR	Master to Slave	Read address	Per-slave
R	Slave to Master	Read data	ID-based routing

13.2.2 Parallel Operation

- Read and write transactions can proceed simultaneously
- Different masters can access different slaves in parallel
- Same slave serializes access via arbitration

13.3 Bridge ID and ID Widening

13.3.1 Bridge ID (BID) Concept

```
Master ID:                  [MASTER_ID_WIDTH-1:0]
Bridge ID (master index):  BRIDGE_ID_WIDTH = clog2(NUM_MASTERS)
AXI ID on a slave port:    {BRIDGE_ID, master ID}, XBAR_ID_WIDTH bits
```

13.3.2 IDs are widened inside the fabric

With more than one master, each master adapter prepends its index to every request ID (bridge TASK-005), so two masters can never alias an ID at a slave. In `bridge_2x2_rw`:

```
input  logic [3:0]  cpu_m_axi_awid     // master side: 4 bits
output logic [4:0]  ddr_s_axi_awid     // slave side: {BRIDGE_ID, id}
= 5 bits
```

The slave-side width is the widest master's `id_width` plus `$clog2(NUM_MASTERS)` bits (`XBAR_ID_WIDTH` in `<bridge>_pkg.sv`); a slave declared narrower is rejected by the config validator. A single-master bridge prepends nothing. On B and R the master adapter returns only the low master-ID bits, so a master always sees its own ID.

13.4 Response Routing

The prefix bits are not decoded to route a response. Each slave adapter also receives the granted master's index as a sideband (`bridge_id`), stores it at the address handshake, and returns it with the response (`bid_bridge_id` / `rid_bridge_id`); the crossbar's B and R muxes select on that. Which store a slave gets is fixed at generation:

Slave	Tracker	Order the slave may complete in
AXI4 / AXI5 slave, more than one master	`bridge_cam` (`u_wr_cam` / `u_rd_cam`), tag = AXI ID, data = `bridge_id`, 16 deep	any order across IDs
any slave with `enable_ooo = true`	`bridge_cam`	any order across IDs
single-master bridge, apb / axil / wb shim slaves, internal subtractive slave	in-order `bridge_id` FIFO, 16 deep	request order across all IDs

```
// CAM form (multi-master AXI4 slave)
bridge_cam #(.TAG_WIDTH(ID_WIDTH), .DATA_WIDTH(BRIDGE_ID_WIDTH),
             .DEPTH(16), .ALLOW_DUPLICATES(1)) u_wr_cam (
    .allocate_tag  (xbar_ddr_axi_awid),   .allocate_data
(xbar_bridge_id_aw),
    .deallocate_tag(xbar_ddr_axi_bid),    .deallocate_data(bid_bridge_
id), ...);

// FIFO form
wr_fifo[wr_ptr[...]] <= xbar_bridge_id_aw;      // push on AW accept
assign bid_bridge_id  = wr_fifo[rd_ptr[...]];   // route by FIFO head
```

13.4.1 B Channel (Write Response)

1. Slave issues B carrying the fabric ID it was sent
2. The slave adapter looks the BID up in its CAM (or pops its FIFO)
3. The returned `bridge_id` selects the master
4. The master adapter strips the prefix and forwards B

13.4.2 R Channel (Read Data)

1. Slave issues R carrying the fabric ID
2. The slave adapter's read tracker names the master; the entry is freed on RLAST

3. The master adapter strips the prefix

Either tracker holds 16 transactions; when it is full the slave's AWREADY / ARREADY toward the crossbar drops (bridge BUG-009).

13.4.3 The requirement the FIFO form creates

A FIFO-tracked slave is routed by *position*, so it must return B/R in request order across ALL IDs. Those slaves are in order by construction (the protocol shims and the subtractive slave) or have a single master; a simulation-only check flags a violation (bridge BUG-008, was BRIDGE-010). A multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slave has no such requirement: the CAM routes by ID.

13.5 Ordering: what the fabric actually guarantees

Per-ID ordering is the slave's AXI obligation; across IDs a CAM-tracked slave may complete in any order. The fabric adds one structural rule:

Per master – one target at a time. A master may not have transactions outstanding to more than one slave simultaneously. `aw_gate_ok`/`ar_gate_ok` hold off a new address phase until every outstanding transaction targets the same slave. This is a deadlock fix: the response mux replays in address-issue order, slaves respond in their own order, and cross-slave outstanding transactions from several masters can wedge the heads against each other. Same-slave pipelining is unaffected.

Per FIFO-tracked slave – responses must come back in order. See "The requirement the FIFO form creates" above.

The sequence an earlier revision of this page offered as a worked example – master 0 issuing to slave 0 and slave 1 concurrently, then the fast slave answering first – is exactly what `aw_gate_ok` prevents. It cannot occur.

13.6 References

- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — per-slave arbiters as a separable allocator degenerated to one resource per channel (ch18 §19.3), and skid buffers as buffered flow control (ch12). (Reference archive)
- Roy, *Advanced Digital System Design*, Springer 2023 — AXI's lack of a strict timing relationship between AW and W, and the use of the stored transaction ID to correlate B back to AW (§18.2.3). (Reference archive)
- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — deterministic routing preserves order only on a single path; out-of-order responses across IDs need explicit ID-keyed tables such as Bridge's CAM mode (ch3/4). (Reference archive)

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

14 Protocol Support

14.1 Supported Protocols

14.1.1 AXI4 Full

Complete AMBA AXI4 protocol support:

- **5 channels:** AW, W, B, AR, R
- **Burst transactions:** FIXED, INCR, WRAP
- **Transaction IDs:** Configurable width
- **Out-of-order:** NOT supported – responses must return in request order (bridge BUG-008, was BRIDGE-010)
- **Data widths:** 32, 64, 128, 256, 512 bits

14.1.2 AXI4-Lite

Simplified AXI4 for register access:

- **5 channels:** Same as AXI4
- **Single-beat only:** AWLEN/ARLEN = 0
- **No IDs:** Transaction ordering by channel
- **Fixed width:** Typically 32 or 64 bits

14.1.3 AXI3

Legacy AMBA AXI3 protocol support, added as a boundary conversion so the internal crossbar remains AXI4:

- **5 channels:** AW, W, B, AR, R, with `WID` present on write data
- **Burst length:** 1–16 beats on the boundary; longer AXI4 bursts are chopped by the boundary converter
- **Per-port data width:** Same width as the paired AXI4 side; width adaptation happens inside the bridge behind the converter when necessary
- **Lock mapping and interleaving constraints:** set by the converter, not the crossbar — see HAS 6.5 AXI3 Integration

14.1.4 APB (Advanced Peripheral Bus)

Low-power peripheral protocol:

- **Single channel:** Combined address and data

- **Simple handshake:** PSEL, PENABLE, PREADY
- **No bursts:** Single transfer per transaction
- **Low overhead:** Minimal logic for slow peripherals

14.2 Protocol Conversion Matrix

Table 3.3: Protocol Conversion Matrix

Master	Slave	Conversion Type	Notes
AXI4	AXI4	Direct	Width conversion if needed
AXI4	AXI4-Lite	Downgrade	Burst split to single beats
AXI4	APB	Full convert	Channel and timing conversion
AXI4-Lite	AXI4	Upgrade	Single-beat pass-through
AXI4-Lite	AXI4-Lite	Direct	Width conversion if needed
AXI4-Lite	APB	Convert	Simplified conversion
AXI5-Lite	any	Upgrade	As AXI4-Lite plus the AXI5-Lite ID; `user` rides the fabric, TRACE/POISON terminate at the boundary (no LOCK/LOOP/MPAM/MECID/NSAID on AXI5-Lite, IHI 0022L

Master	Slave	Conversion Type	Notes
			B2.1.5)
APB / APB5	any	Full convert	`apb{4,5}_to_axi4` front end, then as AXI4-Lite
any	Wishbone B4	Full convert	`axi4_to_wb4`: one transfer per beat, in-order termination
Wishbone B4	any	Full convert	`wb4_to_axi4` front end, then as AXI4-Lite
AXI4	AXI3	Protocol convert	`axi4_to_axi3` slave boundary; same data width only
AXI3	AXI4	Protocol convert	`axi3_to_axi4` master boundary; same data width only

14.3 Automatic Conversion Shims at Slave Boundary

When a slave port's TOML entry names a protocol other than native AXI4 (e.g., `protocol = "axi3"`, `protocol = "axil"` or `protocol = "apb"`), the generator emits the conversion shims between the crossbar core and that slave port. This happens once, at generation time; there is nothing to configure at runtime.

Supported Slave Protocols – these are the exact TOML values the generator accepts (`config_validator.valid_protocols`); anything else is a generation error, so spelling matters:

Table 3.4: Slave-port protocol values

`protocol`	Meaning	Shim emitted at the slave boundary
`axi4`	Native AXI4	none
`axi3`	AMBA AXI3	`axi4_to_axi3`
`axi5`	AXI5, interop mode	`axi5_master_{wr,rd}` boundary wrappers
`axil`	AXI4-Lite	`axi4_to_axil4_{rd,wr}`
`axil5`	AXI5-Lite	`axi4_to_axil5_{rd,wr}`
`apb`	APB3/APB4	`axi4_to_apb4_shim`
`apb5`	APB5	`axi4_to_apb5_shim`
`wb4`	Wishbone B4 (pipelined)	`axi4_to_wb4`

Note the spelling: it is `axil`, not `axi4lite`. Earlier revisions of this page used the latter, which the generator rejects.

The shim modules live in `projects/components/utility-ip/converters/rtl/`; the generator instantiates them into each generated top-level module. The slave port still presents the configured protocol (AXIL or APB) to the outside; inside, the crossbar core is uniformly AXI4.

14.4 Automatic Conversion at the Master Boundary

The same `protocol` values are legal on a master port (bridge TASK-004, was BRIDGE-014). The bridge presents the requester's own protocol on the boundary – the AXI4-Lite signal set, the AXI5-Lite set with its sideband, or the APB completer set – and the master adapter converts to the AXI4 the crossbar speaks:

Table 3.5: Master-port protocol values

`protocol`	Boundary presents	Conversion in the master adapter
`axi4`	AXI4	none (timing wrapper only)
`axi3`	AXI3	`axi3_to_axi4`, then the AXI4 timing wrapper
`axi5`	AXI5 (minus REGION, plus enabled features)	`axi5_slave_{wr,rd}` boundary wrappers
`axil`	AXI4-Lite	AXI4 extras tied (`AxLEN=0`, INCR, `WLAST=1`, ID = placeholder); the wide-slave aligner toward wider slaves
`axil5`	AXI5-Lite: ID + optional signals	as `axil`, but `awid`/`arid` -> the AXI4 ID and `bid`/`rid` back; `user` -> the 1-bit USER fields; TRACE/POISON terminated at the top
`apb`	APB4 completer	`apb4_to_axi4`, then the AXI4 timing wrapper
`apb5`	APB5 completer (+ `PAUSER/PWUSER/PWAKEUP` in – all requester-driven, IHI 0024E 3.7.2 – `PRUSER/PBUSER` out)	`apb5_to_axi4` (`PAUSER[0]`/`PWUSER[0]` -> USER), then the AXI4 timing wrapper
`wb4`	Wishbone B4 completer (pipelined)	`wb4_to_axi4`, then the AXI4 timing wrapper; SLVERR/DECERR

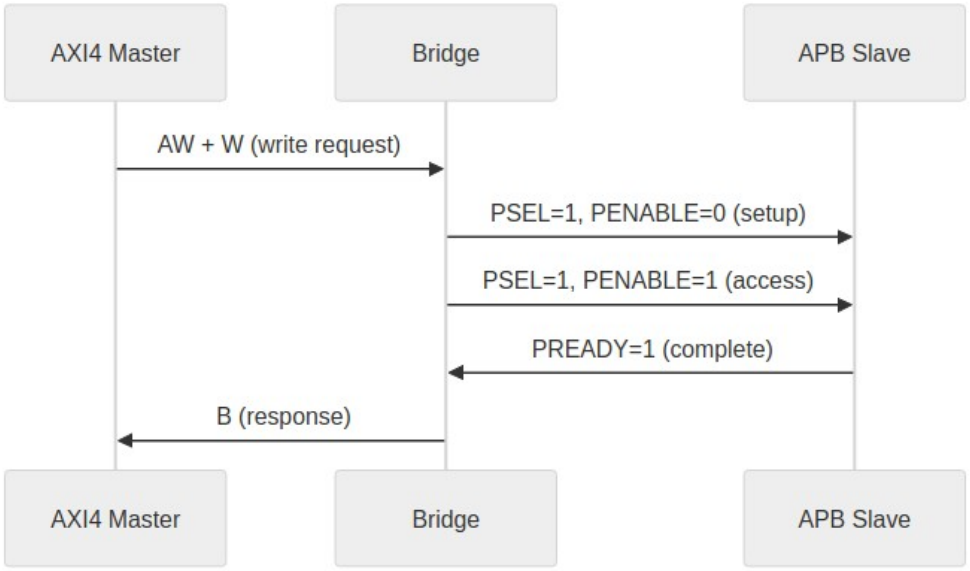
protocol	Boundary presents	Conversion in the master adapter
		terminate ERR

Rules the validator enforces on these ports: AXI4-Lite masters have `id_width = 0` (no ID pins exist; the fabric ID is the master index, bridge TASK-005 (was BRIDGE-016)), AXI5-Lite masters `id_width >= 1` (AWID/ARID are required on an AXI5-Lite Subordinate, IHI 0022L B2.1.5, GitHub #102 item 3), APB and Wishbone masters have `addr_width = 32` (the requester addresses the whole fabric – an APB *slave* port's `PADDR` is a window offset, a master's is not), and `axi5_features` on an `axil5` port may name only `user`, the one group with an AXI4 destination (`exclusive`, `loop`, `mpam`, `mecid` and `nsaid` are rejected as not existing on AXI5-Lite).

14.5 AXI4 to APB Conversion

14.5.1 Conversion Process

14.5.2 Figure 3.4: AXI4 to APB Conversion Sequence



AXI4 to APB Conversion

14.5.3 Burst Handling

- AXI4 bursts split into individual APB transfers
- WSTRB converted to per-byte enables
- B response generated after all beats complete

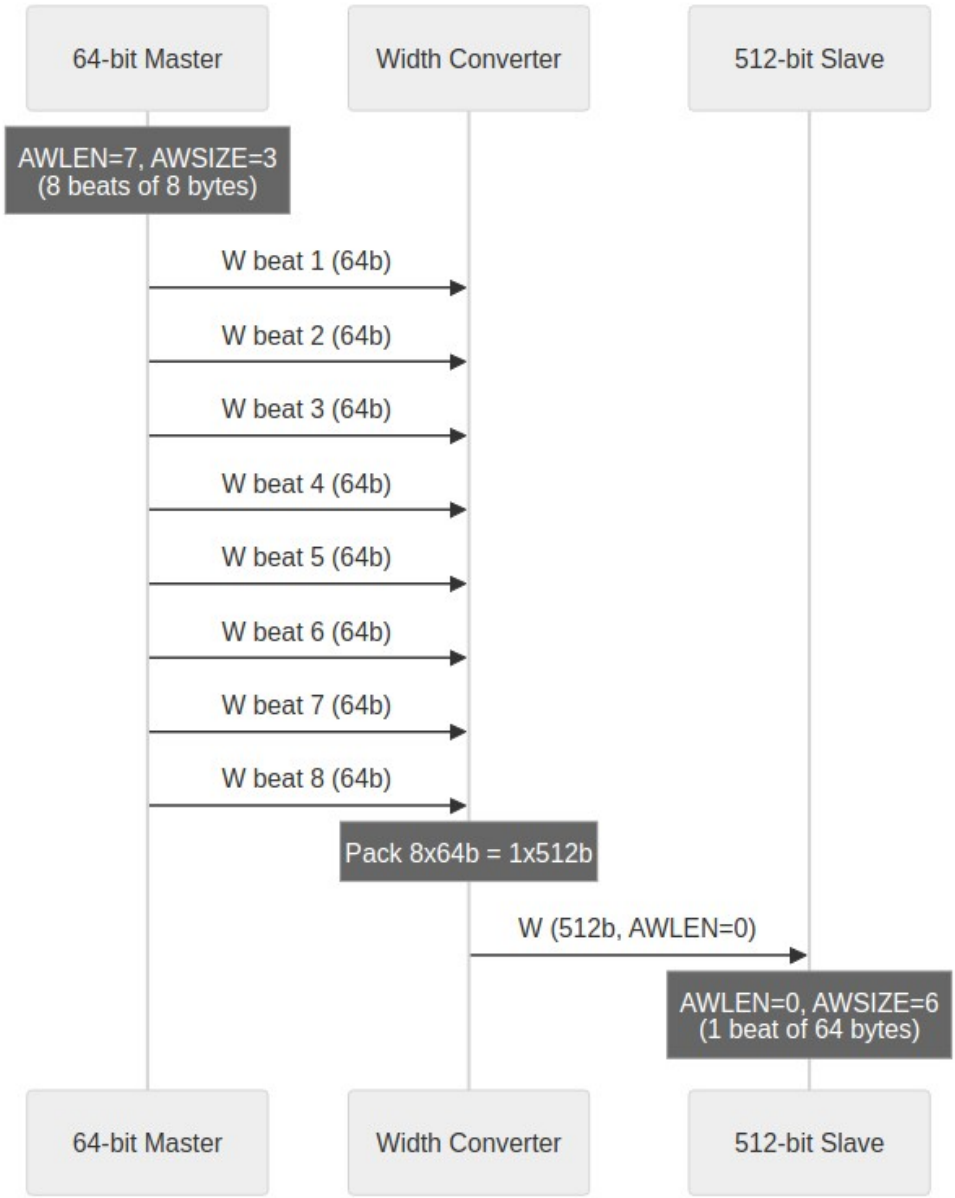
14.5.4 Timing Considerations

- APB is inherently slower (minimum 2 cycles per transfer)
- Pipeline stalls during APB access
- Consider separate APB crossbar for multiple slow peripherals

14.6 Width Conversion

14.6.1 Upsize (Narrow to Wide)

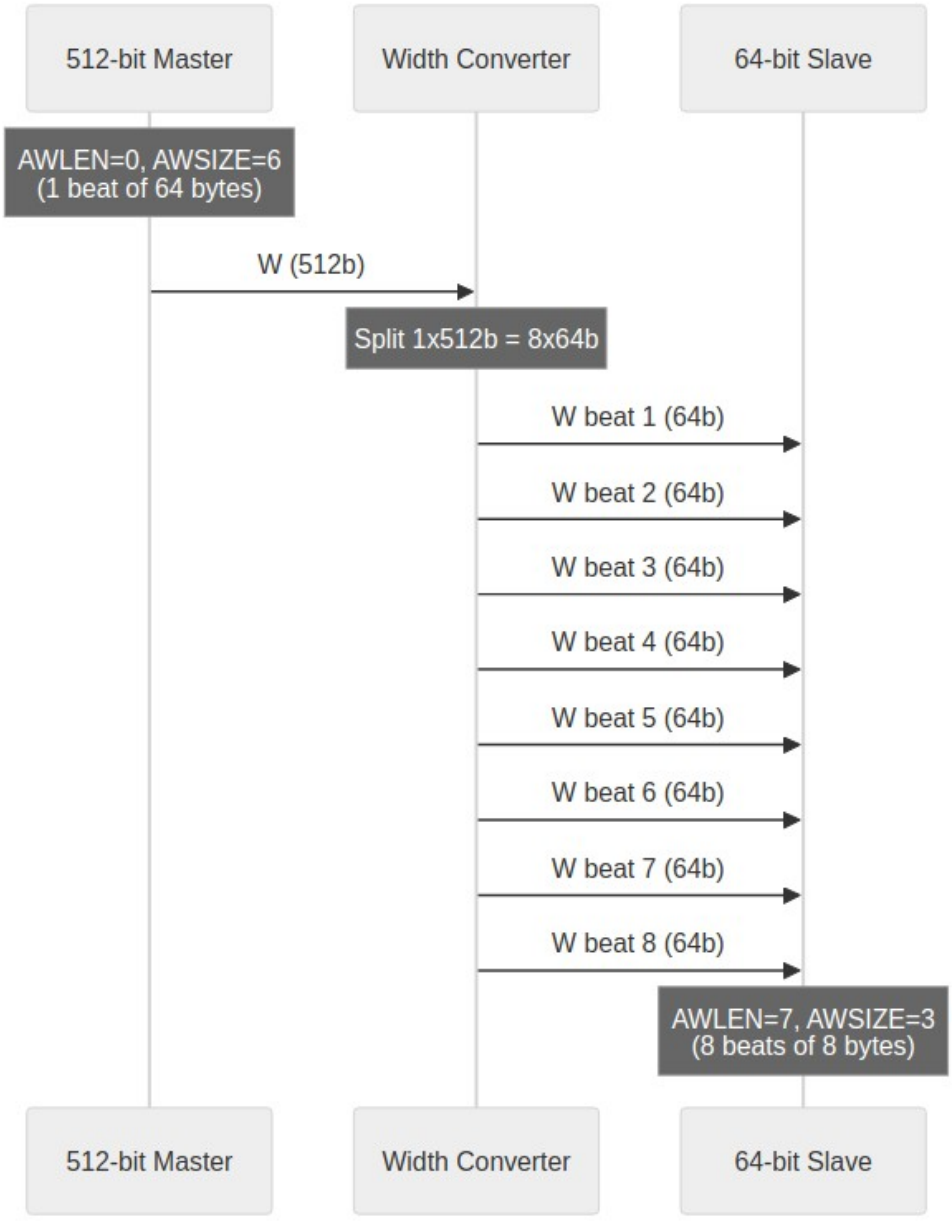
14.6.2 Figure 3.5: Width Upsize Conversion



Width Upsize

14.6.3 Downsize (Wide to Narrow)

14.6.4 Figure 3.6: Width Downsize Conversion



Width Downsize

14.7 Channel-Specific Protocol

14.7.1 Write-Only Masters

Only AW, W, B channels active:

- AR permanently deasserted
- R channel ignored (no routing logic)
- Reduced signal count and logic

14.7.2 Read-Only Masters

Only AR, R channels active:

- AW, W, B channels ignored
- No write arbitration for this master
- Reduced signal count and logic

14.8 ACE and Coherency — Explicitly Out of Scope

The bridge implements AMBA 5 **AXI5** interop and sideband features, but it is **not a coherence interconnect**: there are no ACE snoop channels (AC/CR/CD), no `ACVALID/ACREADY/CRVALID/CRREADY/CDVALID/CDREADY` signals anywhere in the generated RTL, and cache-coherent masters are not supported. Coherent systems belong to the cache-ip domain (see the amber/jet/onxy work). This mirrors `PRD.md`: "No ACE protocol extensions (cache coherency)."

14.9 References

- Eschemann, *The FPGA Programming Handbook*, Packt 2023 — educational secondary source for AXI4 full and AXI4-Lite channel structure and handshake rules (ch8 §8.3). (Reference archive)
- Roy, *Advanced Digital System Design*, Springer 2023 — secondary source for AXI channel structure and headline protocol features (§18.2.2, §18.2.2.1). (Reference archive)
- Maaref, *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt 2022 — AMBA-suite context and the evolution of AXI4 features such as QoS/Region (ch3 §4.2). (Reference archive)
- ARM, *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022E — the authoritative AXI4 protocol definition. (Reference archive)
- ARM, *AMBA 3 AXI Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022 — the AXI3 protocol authority; 4-bit `AxLEN`, 2-bit `AxLOCK`, write-data `WID`, absence of `QoS`/`REGION`. (Reference archive)

---

15 AXI4 Interface Overview

15.1 Interface Organization

15.1.1 Master-Side Interfaces

Bridge presents **slave interfaces** to upstream masters. Each master port includes:

Table 4.9: Master-Side Interface Channels

Channel	Signals	Direction (to Bridge)
AW	AWVALID, AWREADY, AWADDR, AWID, AWLEN, AWSIZE, AWBURST, ...	Input
W	WVALID, WREADY, WDATA, WSTRB, WLAST	Input
B	BVALID, BREADY, BID, BRESP	Output
AR	ARVALID, ARREADY, ARADDR, ARID, ARLEN, ARSIZE, ARBURST, ...	Input
R	RVALID, RREADY, RDATA, RID, RRESP, RLAST	Output

15.1.2 Slave-Side Interfaces

Bridge presents **master interfaces** to downstream slaves. Each slave port includes:

Table 4.10: Slave-Side Interface Channels

Channel	Signals	Direction (from Bridge)
AW	AWVALID, AWREADY, AWADDR, AWID, AWLEN, AWSIZE, AWBURST, ...	Output
W	WVALID, WREADY, WDATA, WSTRB, WLAST	Output
B	BVALID, BREADY, BID, BRESP	Input
AR	ARVALID, ARREADY, ARADDR, ARID, ARLEN, ARSIZE, ARBURST, ...	Output
R	RVALID, RREADY, RDATA, RID, RRESP, RLAST	Input

15.2 Signal Naming Convention

15.2.1 Custom Prefixes

Each port uses a custom prefix for signal naming:

```
// Example: Master 0 with prefix "cpu_m_axi_"
input  logic [31:0] cpu_m_axi_awaddr,
input  logic [3:0]  cpu_m_axi_awid,
input  logic        cpu_m_axi_awvalid,
output logic        cpu_m_axi_awready,
// ... remaining AW signals

// Example: Slave 0 with prefix "ddr_s_axi_"
output logic [31:0] ddr_s_axi_awaddr,
output logic [4:0]  ddr_s_axi_awid,  // {BRIDGE_ID, id}: master width
+ clog2(NUM_MASTERS)
output logic        ddr_s_axi_awvalid,
input  logic        ddr_s_axi_awready,
```

15.2.2 ID Width Extension

With more than one master, slave-side IDs are WIDER than master-side:

```
Master ID Width: id_width of the master port (widest master =
MASTER_ID_WIDTH)
Bridge ID Width: clog2(NUM_MASTERS)           (ID_PREFIX_WIDTH; 0 for
one master)
Slave ID Width:  MASTER_ID_WIDTH + ID_PREFIX_WIDTH  (XBAR_ID_WIDTH)

bridge_2x2_rw: cpu_m_axi_awid [3:0]  ->  ddr_s_axi_awid [4:0]
```

Each master adapter sends `{BRIDGE_ID, id}` into the fabric and strips the prefix from B and R. A slave port's declared `id_width` must be at least `XBAR_ID_WIDTH`; the validator rejects a narrower AXI3/AXI4/AXI5 slave. Responses are routed by the `bridge_id` sideband the slave adapter stores: a `bridge_cam` looked up by BID/RID for a multi-master AXI4/AXI5 slave (any completion order), or an in-order FIFO for single-master bridges and shim slaves (request order required, bridge BUG-008). See HAS 3.2.

15.3 Channel-Specific Interfaces

15.3.1 Write-Only Master (wr)

Only AW, W, B channels generated:

```
// Write Address Channel
input  logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] descr_m_axi_awaddr,
input  logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]   descr_m_axi_awid,
// ... full AW channel

// Write Data Channel
input  logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0] descr_m_axi_wdata,
input  logic [STRB_WIDTH-1:0] descr_m_axi_wstrb,
// ... full W channel

// Write Response Channel
output logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]   descr_m_axi_bid,
output logic [1:0]            descr_m_axi_bresp,
// ... full B channel

// NO AR or R channels
```

15.3.2 Read-Only Master (rd)

Only AR, R channels generated:

```
// Read Address Channel
input  logic [ADDR_WIDTH-1:0] src_m_axi_araddr,
input  logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]   src_m_axi_arid,
// ... full AR channel

// Read Data Channel
output logic [DATA_WIDTH-1:0] src_m_axi_rdata,
output logic [ID_WIDTH-1:0]   src_m_axi_rid,
// ... full R channel

// NO AW, W, or B channels
```

15.4 Monitor Bus Output (when `variants` includes `mon`)

When monitor collection is enabled (via the bridge TOML `variants` list including `"mon"`), each bridge instance exposes a unified monitor interface at the bridge top level:

Signal	Type	Width	Direction	Description
`s_mon_axil_*`	AXIL Slave	32-bit addr, 64-bit data	Input	Monitor packet read interface for CPU consumption
`m_axil_mon_*`	AXIL Master	32-bit addr, 64-bit data	Output	Monitor packet write interface for bulk trace capture
`stream_irq`	logic	1-bit	Output	Interrupt signal (asserted when error FIFO has records)

Per-port collection comes from the `axi4_master_{rd,wr}_monlite` and `axi4_slave_{rd,wr}_monlite` wrappers (`axi_monitor_lite`; the full `_mon` wrappers are no longer used in generated bridges, 2026-09-26).

Packet Format: the canonical 128-bit packet layout and field definitions live in `docs/markdown/rtl-amba/includes/ocelus_package_spec.md` — see that reference for bit-field descriptions, protocol-type enumerations, and packet-type codes.

15.5 Handshake Protocol

15.5.1 Valid/Ready Handshake

All channels use AXI4 valid/ready handshake:

```
Transfer occurs when: VALID && READY
```

15.5.2 Backpressure

- Bridge asserts READY when able to accept
- Masters must hold VALID until READY
- Bridge does not drop transactions

15.6 Burst Support

15.6.1 Supported Burst Types

Table 4.11: Supported Burst Types

AWBURST/ARBURST	Type	Description
2'b00	FIXED	Same address each beat
2'b01	INCR	Incrementing address
2'b10	WRAP	Wrapping at boundary
2'b11	Reserved	Not used

15.6.2 Burst Length

- AWLEN/ARLEN: 8-bit field
- Length = AXLEN + 1 (1 to 256 beats)
- Burst does not cross 4KB boundary (AXI4 rule)

16 APB Interface

16.1 Overview

APB is where the slow things live: UARTs, GPIO, configuration registers. This page covers the bridge's APB surface — the signal set, the port-naming convention, transaction timing, and what the AXI4-to-APB conversion actually does.

16.2 Ports

16.2.1 Signal Definition

Table 4.1: APB Signal Definitions

Signal	Width	Direction	Description
PSEL	1	Output	Slave select
PENABLE	1	Output	Transaction phase
PADDR	ADDR_WIDTH	Output	Address
PWRITE	1	Output	Write enable
PWDATA	DATA_WIDTH	Output	Write data
PSTRB	DATA_WIDTH/8	Output	Byte strobes
PPROT	3	Output	Protection
PRDATA	DATA_WIDTH	Input	Read data
PSLVERR	1	Input	Slave error
PREADY	1	Input	Slave ready

16.2.2 Signal Naming

APB slave ports use custom prefixes:

```
// Example: APB slave with prefix "uart_apb_"
output logic        uart_apb_psel,
output logic        uart_apb_penable,
output logic [31:0] uart_apb_paddr,
output logic        uart_apb_pwrite,
output logic [31:0] uart_apb_pwdata,
output logic [3:0]  uart_apb_pstrb,
output logic [2:0]  uart_apb_pprot,
input  logic [31:0] uart_apb_prdata,
input  logic        uart_apb_pslverr,
input  logic        uart_apb_pready
```

16.3 Functional Description

16.3.1 AXI4 to APB Conversion

When an AXI4 master accesses an APB slave, the bridge:

1. **Burst splitting** - AXI4 bursts become multiple APB transfers
2. **Channel mapping** - AW+W combined into PADDR+PWDATA
3. **Response generation** - APB PSLVERR maps to AXI4 BRESP/RRESP
4. **Timing adaptation** - Insert wait states as needed

16.3.2 Burst Handling

Table 4.2: AXI4 to APB Burst Conversion

AXI4 AWLEN	APB Transfers
0 (1 beat)	1 transfer
1 (2 beats)	2 transfers
N (N+1 beats)	N+1 transfers

16.3.3 Error Mapping

Table 4.3: APB to AXI4 Error Mapping

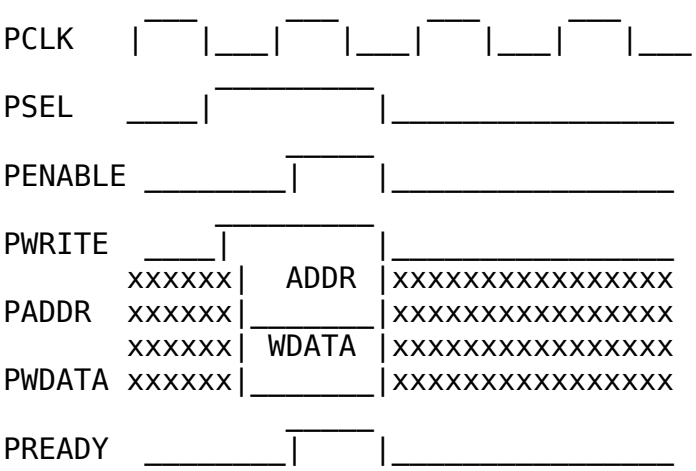
APB PSLVERR	AXI4 BRESP/RRESP
0 (OK)	2'b00 (OKAY)
1 (Error)	2'b10 (SLVERR)

16.4 Timing

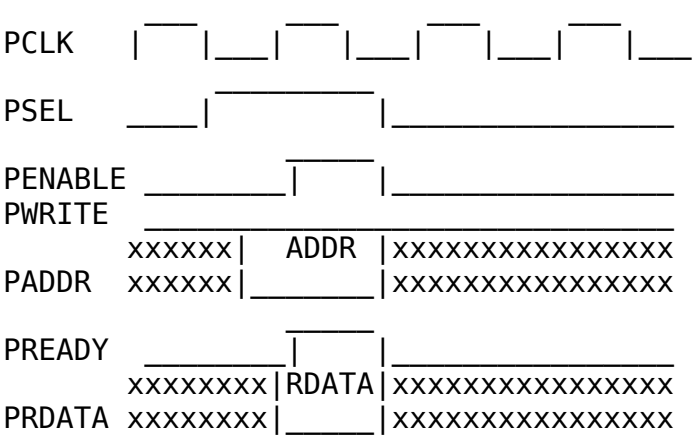
Every APB transfer pays for a setup phase plus an access phase, so the floor is two cycles per transfer. There is no pipelining — transfers run sequentially — and no bursts: each beat requires the full handshake.

16.5 Waveforms

16.5.1 Write Transaction



16.5.2 Read Transaction



16.6 APB Requester Ports

Since bridge TASK-004 (was BRIDGE-014) an APB port can also be a *master*: `protocol = "apb"` or `"apb5"` in `[[bridge.masters]]`. The signal set is the same ten (fifteen for APB5) with the directions of the slave table reversed – the bridge is the completer, so `PSEL`, `PENABLE`, `PADDR[31:0]`, `PWRITE`, `PWDATA`, `PSTRB`, `PPROT` are inputs and `PREADY`, `PRDATA`, `PSLVERR` outputs. `PADDR` is the full 32-bit fabric address (the validator insists on `addr_width = 32`); each transfer becomes one single-beat AXI4 transaction through `apb4_to_axi4` / `apb5_to_axi4`, and both `SLVERR` and `DECERR` come back as `PSLVERR`. The requester is one-outstanding by nature of APB, so throughput is one transfer per fabric round trip.

16.7 Design Notes

- Use APB only for slow peripherals (UART, GPIO, config registers)
- Group APB slaves behind dedicated sub-crossbar
- Use AXI4/AXI4-Lite for higher-bandwidth slaves

---

17 Clock and Reset

17.1 Overview

One clock, one reset. The AXI fabric runs in a single synchronous domain — there is exactly one exception, an AXI4 slave port declared `cdc = true`, and it gets its own discussion below — and the reset is asynchronous, active-low. This page covers what that means for your clock tree, your reset strategy, and your constraint file.

17.2 Ports

17.2.1 Clock

Table 4.4: Clock Requirements

Signal	Description	Requirements
aclk	System clock	All interfaces synchronous
Frequency	Operating frequency	Design-dependent
Duty cycle	Clock duty cycle	40-60% typical

17.2.2 Reset

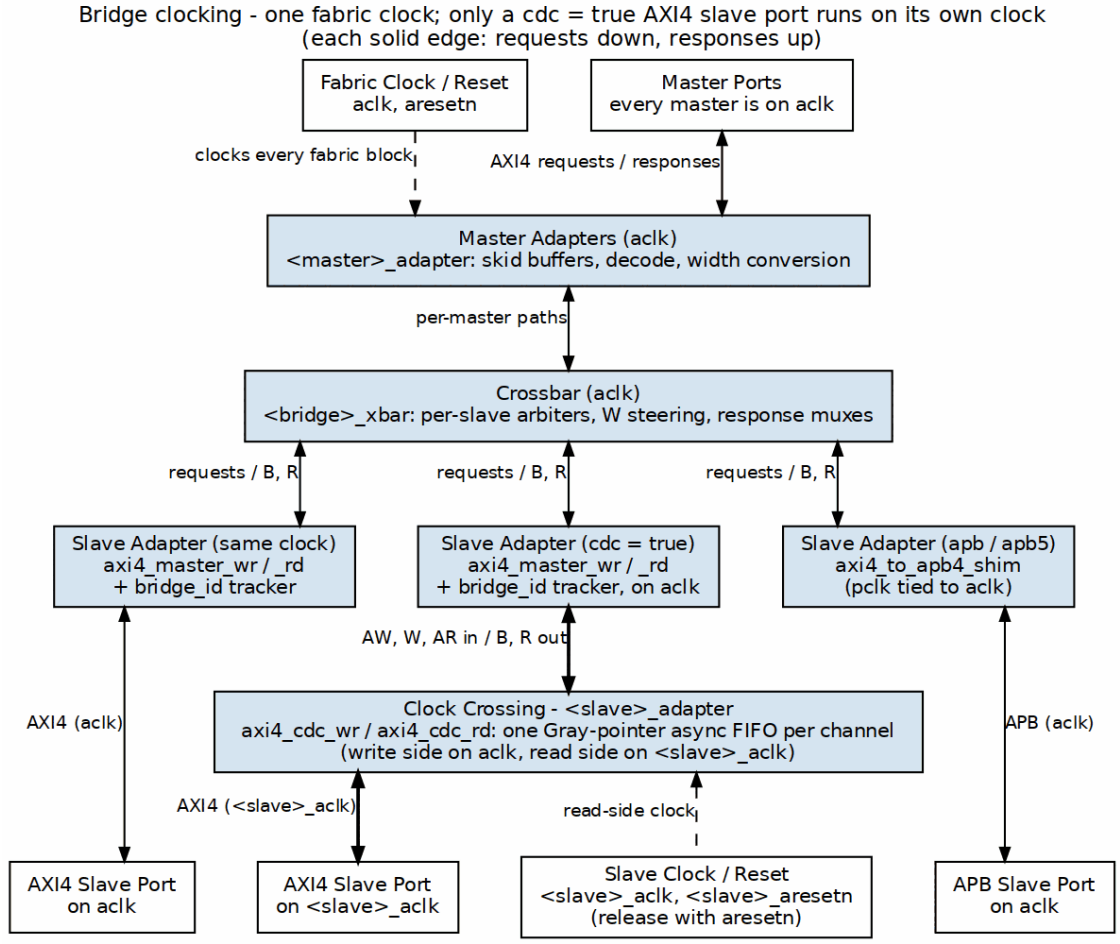
Table 4.5: Reset Signal

Signal	Description	Polarity
aresetn	Async reset	Active-low

17.3 Functional Description

17.3.1 One Fabric Clock

17.3.1.1 Figure 4.1: Clock Distribution



Clock Distribution

Every master port and the fabric itself run on `aclk`. A slave port may run on its own clock when declared `cdc = true` (next section); every other slave port shares `aclk` too.

17.3.2 Clock Domain Crossing: CDC Slave Ports

The FABRIC is one clock domain (`aclk`). Since bridge TASK-006 (was BRIDGE-017) a slave port can live in another: `cdc = true` on an AXI4 slave adds `<slave>_aclk` / `<slave>_aresetn` to the bridge top, and the slave adapter carries AW, W and AR to the port and B, R back through `axi4_cdc_{wr,rd}` – one Gray-pointer async FIFO per channel (`rtl/amba/axi4/axi4_cdc.md`) – downstream of its timing wrapper, which stays on `aclk` with its monitor and the bridge-id

tracking. Everything upstream of the crossing is unchanged; the port itself runs entirely on its own clock, at one beat per cycle of the slower domain.

Table 4.5a: CDC slave port clock pins (`cdc = true`)

Signal	Direction	Description
`<slave>_aclk`	Input	the CDC slave port's clock
`<slave>_aresetn`	Input	its active-low reset; release together with `aresetn` (a one-sided reset is not safe on the async FIFOs – handbook `design/cdc.md`)

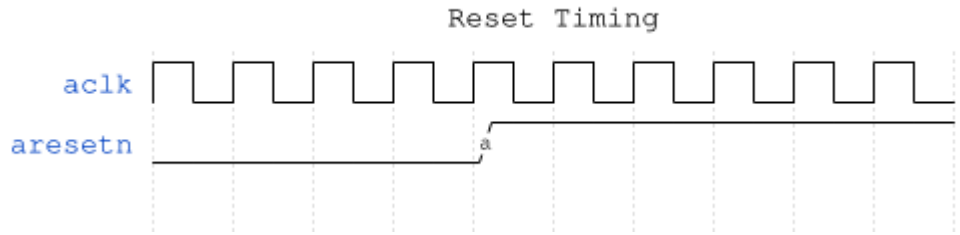
Limits: slave ports only, `protocol = "axi4"` (the crossing carries the AXI4 signal set; AXI5 sideband and the APB/AXIL/WB4 shims have no crossing yet – the validator rejects those). Measured on `bridge_2x2_rw_cdc` (`test_bridge_2x2_rw_cdc_ratio`) with the slave clock at 3, 10 and 23 ns against a 10 ns fabric: every burst from both masters completes, the port's beats appear on the slave clock, the sustained rate is set by the slower clock (>= 0.85 beat per cycle of it), and the same-clock port beside it is unaffected.

An `apb`/`apb5` slave's `axi4_to_apb4_shim` core is built around two async FIFOs and has its own `pclk`/`presetn` pins, but the generator ties them to `aclk`/`aresetn` (`periph_adapter.sv` in `bridge_2x3_apb_req`), and the bridge top has no APB clock port. A generated APB slave port therefore runs on `aclk`. For every port that is not `cdc = true`:

- All inputs sampled on aclk rising edge
- All outputs generated on aclk rising edge
- External CDC required if a master, or a non-AXI4 slave, uses a different clock

17.3.3 Reset Behavior

17.3.3.1 Figure 4.2: Reset Timing



Reset Timing

Reset is active-low: the bridge is in reset whenever `aresetn = 0`.

17.3.4 Reset Effects

During reset (aresetn = 0):

Table 4.6: Reset Effects

Component	State
Arbiters	Cleared (no grants)
bridge_id FIFOs	Pointers cleared (no outstanding)
FIFOs	Emptied
Outputs	Deasserted (VALID = 0)

17.3.5 Outstanding Transactions

Warning: reset discards transactions in flight:

- Master may see timeout (no response)
- Slave may receive partial transaction
- System must ensure quiescence before reset

17.3.6 Reset Release

After reset release (aresetn = 1):

1. Bridge accepts new transactions after 1 cycle
2. All state machines start in IDLE
3. No residual grants or locks

17.4 Timing

17.4.1 Setup and Hold

All inputs must meet setup/hold relative to aclk:

Table 4.7: Timing Constraints

Constraint	Typical Value
Setup time	Process-dependent
Hold time	Process-dependent

17.4.2 Clock-to-Output

All outputs appear after aclk rising edge:

Table 4.8: Clock-to-Output Delays

Path	Typical Delay
aclk to VALID	1 cycle (registered)
aclk to READY	1 cycle (registered)
aclk to DATA	1 cycle (registered)

READY is registered like the rest, which an earlier revision of this table gave as “Combinational”. Every external port terminates in a `gaxi_skid_buffer` inside its boundary wrapper – a master port’s `awready` is `axi4_slave_wr.s_axi_awready`, wired straight to the skid’s `wr_ready`, and that is assigned in an `ALWAYS_FF_RST` block. A master budgeting a combinational ready path against this bridge would be wrong by a register stage.

17.5 Usage Example

17.5.1 Recommended Constraints

```
# Example SDC constraints
create_clock -period 10 [get_ports aclk]  ;# 100 MHz

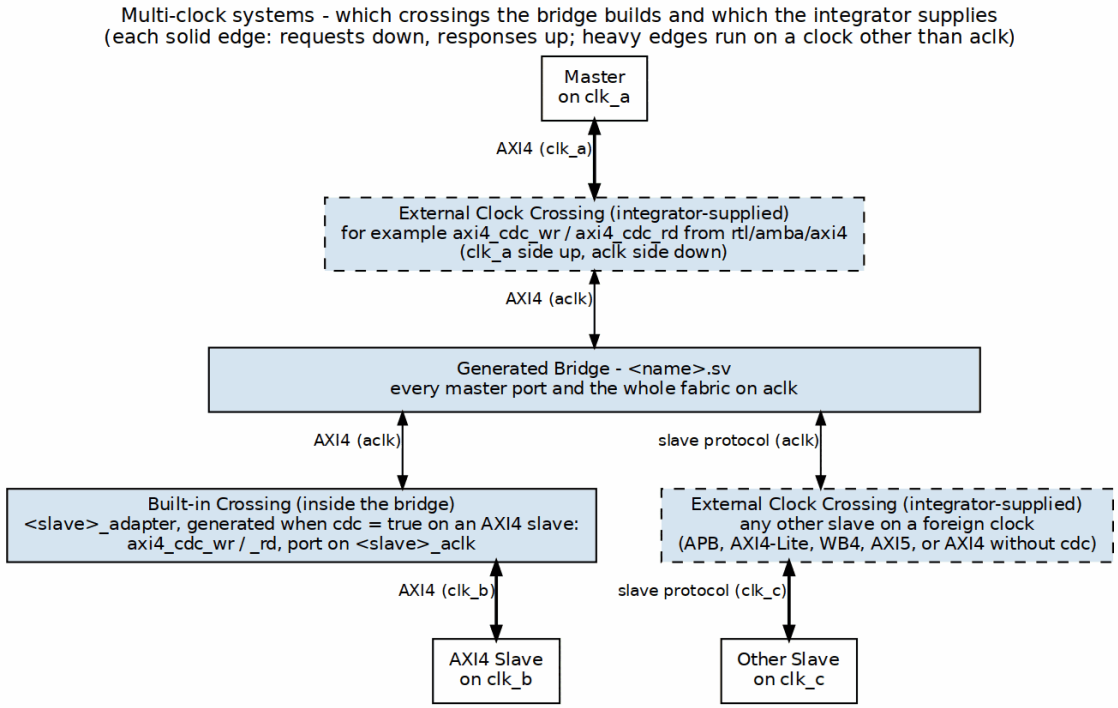
# Reset is async - synchronize externally
set_false_path -from [get_ports aresetn]
```

17.6 Design Notes

17.6.1 External CDC Required

For master ports, and for slave ports that are not `cdc = true` AXI4 ports, in systems with multiple clock domains:

17.6.1.1 Figure 4.3: Multi-Clock CDC



Multi-Clock CDC

17.6.2 CDC Recommendations

- Use AXI4 async FIFO bridges
- Consider AXI4 clock converter IP
- Ensure proper gray-coding for pointers

18 AXI5 and APB5 Interfaces (AMBA5 Support)

18.1 Overview

The bridge is AXI4-shaped internally with every AXI5 feature the library wrappers carry riding alongside in the channel structs — since bridge TASK-007 (was BRIDGE-018) that includes Memory Tagging and read-data chunking, so there is no AXI5 signal an `axi5` port can present that the fabric cannot carry natively to another `axi5` port. Any master or slave port can be declared AMBA5. This chapter covers the external surfaces; the mechanism lives in the MAS (AMBA5 Boundary and Native Sideband).

18.2 Parameters

18.2.1 Declaring AMBA5 Ports

AMBA5 is declared per port, in the TOML:

```
[[bridge.masters]]
name = "cpu_wr"
protocol = "axi5"
axi5_features = ["trace", "atomic"]   # optional; empty = base AXI5
# ... standard fields unchanged

[[bridge.slaves]]
name = "periph5"
protocol = "apb5"                     # APB5 peripheral via the apb5
shim
channels = "rw"                       # APB rules unchanged (rw-only,
32-bit)

[[bridge.masters]]
name = "lite5"
protocol = "axil5"                    # AXI5-Lite requester (bridge
TASK-004, was BRIDGE-014)
id_width = 1                          # AWID/ARID: required on an
AXI5-Lite Subordinate
axi5_features = ["user"]              # the one group with an AXI4
destination

[[bridge.masters]]
name = "apb5m"
protocol = "apb5"                     # APB5 requester (bridge TASK-
004, was BRIDGE-014)
id_width = 0
addr_width = 32                       # the requester addresses the
whole fabric
channels = "rw"
```

18.3 Ports

18.3.1 AXI5 Port Surface

An `axi5` port exposes the AXI4 signal set **minus AW/ARREGION** (AXI5 removed REGION) **plus** the enabled features' sideband signals. Disabled features' signals are not exposed at all — the boundary wrapper ties them off internally.

Feature	Signals added	Class
`nsaid`	`aw/arnsaid[3:0]`	Droppable sideband
`trace`	`aw/artrace`, `btrace`, `rtrace`	Droppable sideband
`mpam`	`aw/armpam[10:0]`	Droppable sideband
`mecid`	`aw/armecid[15:0]`	Droppable sideband
`unique`	`aw/aridunq` in; `bidunq`, `ridunq` out (IHI 0022L A5.2)	Droppable sideband; the response indicators are regenerated at the master port (below)
`wakeup`	`awakeup` (one signal for both request channels, present on rd-only, wr-only and rw ports alike)	Not path sideband; see "AWAKEUP" below
`poison`	`wpoison`, `rpoison`	**Connectivity-gated**
`atomic`	`awatop[5:0]`	**Connectivity-gated**; read-return classes native on rw ports, DECERR on write-only ports
`mte`	`aw/artagop[1:0]`, `wtag`, `wtagupdate`, `btagmatch[1:0]`, `rtag` (tag buses are 4 bits per 16 bytes of data, `wtagupdate` one bit per 16 bytes; IHI 0022L A12.2 has no `AWTAG`, `BTAG` or `RTAGMATCH`, and `BTAGMATCH` encodes Table	**Connectivity-gated**; 128-bit ports or wider (bridge TASK-007, was BRIDGE-018)

Feature	Signals added	Class
chunking	A12.14: 00 none, 01 separate, 10 fail, 11 pass) archunken, rchunkv, rchunknum[3:0], rchunkstrb (one bit per 128 bits of data)	Droppable sideband; 128-bit ports or wider (bridge TASK-007, was BRIDGE-018)

18.3.2 APB5 Slave Surface

An apb5 slave exposes the APB4 requester surface plus the APB5 sideband, mirroring rtl/amba/apb5/apb5_slave.sv pin-for-pin:

Direction	Signals
Requester → completer	APB4 set + PAUSER, PWUSER (driven '0 — nothing upstream sources them) + PWAKEUP (below)
Completer → requester	APB4 set + PRUSER, PBUSER (accepted and terminated)

PWAKEUP is a **requester output** (IHI 0024E 3.7.2, Table 3-7). The bridge port used to take it as an input, following a library convention that had the direction backwards (GitHub #102 item 7). axi4_to_apb5_shim now drives it from a flop of PSEL: glitch-free, high from the cycle after the Setup phase and held through the PREADY cycle, so a completer that waits for PWAKEUP before PREADY always receives it, and low when no transfer is in progress. 3.7.2 permits assertion during or after PSEL; the recommended one-cycle lead is not available because the command queue that would predict a transfer is inside the shared APB4 conversion core. No *CHK check signals are exposed (the port is Check_Type = False).

The transfer protocol is unchanged from APB4, so the axi4_to_apb5_shim is a sideband wrapper over the APB4 conversion core; APB constraints (rw-only, 32-bit data) apply unchanged.

18.3.3 AXI5-Lite Master Surface

An axil5 master port (bridge TASK-004, was BRIDGE-014) exposes the AXI4-Lite requester set, the AXI5-Lite ID (awid/arid in, bid/rid out, id_width bits – required on an AXI5-Lite Subordinate, IHI 0022L B2.1.5, so id_width must be at least 1), and the **whole** AXI5-Lite optional set, every group whether or not it is enabled – the same rule as the slave surface, so the boundary keeps one shape. The directions flip relative to the slave table: requester-driven groups are bridge inputs, completer-driven groups bridge outputs.

AXI5-Lite sideband groups at an `axil5` master boundary

Group	Signals	Behaviour
ID	`awid`, `arid` in; `bid`, `rid` out	reach the adapter's AXI4 face, ride the fabric inside `{master index, id}` and come back unchanged
FORWARDED (when enabled)	`awuser`, `wuser`, `aruser` (`user`)	reach the adapter's AXI4 face and ride the fabric to the slave
TERMINATED inputs	`aw/artrace`, `wpoison`; `awuser`/… when `user` is off	consumed at the bridge top (a reduction into an `_unused` wire), never floating
TERMINATED outputs	`btrace`, `rtrace`, `rpoison`; `buser`/`ruser` when `user` is off	driven `'0`
Response USER	`buser`, `ruser` with `user` on	connected, but read 0: the master adapters tie response-side USER (see the PRD)

18.3.4 APB5 Master Surface

An `apb5` master port makes the bridge the APB5 **completer**: the APB4 set with the requester-driven signals as inputs and `PREADY/PRDATA/PSLVERR` as outputs, plus `PAUSER`, `PWUSER`, `PWAKEUP` in and `PRUSER`, `PBUSER` out, one bit each (the fabric USER width). `PAUSER[0]`/`PWUSER[0]` become `awuser`/`aruser`/`wuser` on the fabric – observable at an `axil5` slave with `user` enabled. `PWAKEUP` is requester-driven (an input here, since the bridge is the completer) and is accepted and terminated: the bridge never waits for it. Behind the surface sits `apb5_to_axi4` (`apb4_to_axi4` for `protocol = "apb"`), then the same AXI4 timing wrapper an AXI4 master port gets; from there the port is an AXI4-Lite-shaped single-beat requester and takes the wide-slave aligner toward wider slaves. An unmapped address answers `PSLVERR` (the subtractive slave's DECERR folds into APB's one error bit).

18.3.5 AXI5-Lite Slave Surface

An `axil5` slave gets `axi4_to_axil5_{rd,wr}` at the boundary: the AXI4-Lite conversion core plus the AXI5-Lite ID and optional signals. The signal set is IHI 0022L B2.1.5 / Table B2.2: AXI5-Lite has **no** AxLOCK (no exclusive access), AxMPAM, AxMECID, AxNSAID or xLOOP – the bridge

carried all five until GitHub #102 item 3 – and it **does** carry AWID/BID and ARID/RID. Because the master side is AXI4, the rest splits three ways, and which group a signal falls in is the whole story of what an AXI4 front end can and cannot express.

AXI5-Lite sideband groups at an `axil5` slave boundary

Group	Signals	Behaviour
ID	`awid`, `arid` (request); `bid`, `rid` (response)	The fabric ID (`{master index, id}`, the crossbar ID width), carried across the converter and returned unchanged.
FORWARDED	`awuser`, `wuser`, `aruser` (request); `buser`, `ruser` (response)	AXI4 has an equivalent, passed straight through and returned to the master. AXI4 `AxLOCK` has nowhere to go: an exclusive access completes as a normal one with OKAY.
TIED	`awtrace`, `wpoison`, `artrace`	AXI5-Lite optional signals with no AXI4 source. The port exists and is driven to `'0` — never left floating. There is deliberately no `ENABLE_` knob: there is nothing it could switch between.
TERMINATED	`btrace`, `rtrace`, `rpoison`	Completer-driven, with nothing on the AXI4 side to return them to. Accepted and dropped.

18.4 Functional Description

Droppable sideband passes natively end-to-end when both ends of a path are AXI5, feature-enabled, and width-matched; on any other path it terminates at the fabric boundary with a generation-time warning.

Connectivity-gated features are a config **error** unless *every* connected path is native (AXI5 both ends, feature enabled both ends, data widths matched — dwidth converters cannot carry per-beat sideband). Dropping POISON silently would launder corrupted data; dropping ATOP would turn an atomic into a plain write; dropping a tag operation would turn a tagged write into an untagged one and a Match into a plain access, with the requester none the wiser — so `mte` is gated the same way.

Chunking is permission, not demand. `ARCHUNKEN` tells the completer it *may* return the burst in chunks; a completer that cannot simply returns ordered data with `RCHUNKV` low, and every chunking requester must accept that. So `chunking` is droppable: toward an AXI4 slave, or through a width converter, the enable terminates with a generation-time warning and the read completes unchunked. Toward an AXI5 slave that chunks, the enable and the chunk fields ride the structs natively; the fabric never looks inside them — it routes each R beat by ID and frees its tracking on `RLAST` exactly as for an ordered burst, so chunks may arrive in any order the completer chooses.

Both need a 128-bit bus. Tags are one per 16 bytes and chunks are 128 bits; the validator rejects `mte` or `chunking` on a narrower port (`bridge_2x2_axi5_native` and `bridge_1x2_rd_axi5c` are the 128-bit fixtures; MAS 7.1a lists what their tests check).

Atomics depend on the port having a read path. `AWATOP = 01xxxx` (AtomicStore) and plain writes forward natively on any atomic-enabled port. Read-return classes (AtomicLoad `10xxxx`, AtomicSwap/Compare `11000x`) answer on the R channel with the AW's ID:

- On an **rw** master port they forward natively. The slave performs the operation and returns the location's original data on R; the bridge routes that beat back by ID (`axi5_atomic_rr_tracker` at the slave adapter, an extra AR->R tracking slot at the master adapter). Every connected atomic slave must be `rw` – the validator rejects a write-only one, since it could never return the data.
- On a **write-only** master port there is nowhere to deliver the R beat, so the boundary's `axi5_atomic_filter` answers those classes locally with **DECERR** – no slave-side AW handshake, no memory side effect. IHI 0022L A6.4.8 also requires the read data transfers to be sent even when the write response is an error; the filter generates them (GitHub #102 item 2), but a write-only port has no R channel to carry them, so the bridge accepts and **discards** them inside the filter (its `s_rready` is tied high, which also keeps its read-return queue from filling and stalling AW). The atomic therefore

completes with DECERR on **B only**. A manager that issues a load-class atomic on a write-only port is outside the spec – such a port has no read data channel to receive the result – and **must not** issue them; the DECERR exists so a stray one cannot hang the port. To use load-class atomics, declare the port `rw`.

Unique-ID indicators are regenerated, not routed back. IHI 0022L A5.2 makes `BIDUNQ` equal the request's `AWIDUNQ`, `RIDUNQ` equal `ARIDUNQ`, and an atomic's `RIDUNQ` equal its `AWIDUNQ`. The request indicator is droppable sideband: an AXI4 slave, a dwidth converter, the subtractive DECERR slave and the atomic filter's local response never see it. So the response indicators do not ride the fabric; each AXI5 master port with `unique` keeps one bit per ID, written at every AW (and AR, and read-return atomic AW) handshake and read by `BID`/`RID`. A5.2 forbids an `AxIDUNQ=1` request while any same-ID request is outstanding, and any request reusing an outstanding `AxIDUNQ=1` ID, so every outstanding transaction of one ID carries the same indicator and the per-ID bit is exact under any response order. On a write-only atomic port the table sits on the wrapper side of the filter, so a local DECERR carries the right bit.

AWAKEUP (IHI 0022L A14.1.1, feature `wakeup`). A master port accepts `AWAKEUP` and does not wait for it – the bridge is always clocked, and a Subordinate is permitted, not required, to wait. A wake-capable AXI5 slave port drives `AWAKEUP` as the OR of (a) every connected wake-capable master's request – the master's `AWAKEUP` OR'd with requests held in its boundary wrapper – so the slave can wake before a request reaches it, which is the A14.1.1 recommendation; the bridge cannot know which slave a request decodes to before it arrives, so every connected wake-capable slave sees it; and (b) the slave wrapper's own held requests, so `AWAKEUP` is high on every cycle the port presents `AWVALID`, `WVALID` or `ARVALID` and stays high until the handshake, as A14.1.1 requires – including traffic from a master without `AWAKEUP` (A14.1.1's "derive from AxVALID" fallback). Every term is a flop or a top-level `AWAKEUP` input, so the OR is glitch-free (A14.1). It falls when nothing is requested. The read and write halves of a port each produce a copy and the port ORs them: `AWAKEUP` is one signal for both request channels.

The tied group is the honest limit of an AXI4 front end. MPAM partition IDs, MECID encryption contexts and NSAID security IDs are properties of the *originating* master; a bridge whose masters speak AXI4 has nowhere to learn them, so an `axi5` slave reached from an `axi4` master sees zeros rather than invented values. If a design needs real MPAM or MECID at the slave, the master port has to be `axi5`, not `axi4`. (AXI5-Lite has no MPAM, MECID or NSAID at all.)

Sideband is held for the whole burst, not just the address beat. AXI4 presents `AWID`/`AWUSER` once, with AW; AXI5-Lite needs them stable across every beat that follows. The shims capture on the address handshake and hold:

```
wire w_aw_accept = s_axi_awvalid && s_axi_awready;
wire [AXI_USER_WIDTH-1:0] w_awuser_sel = w_aw_accept ? s_axi_awuser
                                                     : r_held_awuser;
```

A combinational passthrough here is a real defect rather than a style question: with two bursts in flight, burst A's later beats would carry burst B's `AWUSER`.

18.4.1 Interop Matrix

Master Slave	axi4	axi5	apb / apb5 / axil	axil5
axi4	native	base subset	via shim	via shim, sideband TIED to `'0`
axi5	sideband drops (warning)	**native sideband** when width-matched	sideband drops (warning)	forwarded where AXI4-expressible
axil / axil5	single-beat AXI4	single-beat AXI4	via shim	ID and `user` forwarded end to end (axil5 master); rest tied
apb / apb5	single-beat AXI4	single-beat AXI4	via shim (APB in, APB out)	`PAUSER[0]` visible as `awuser` (apb5 master)

Connectivity-gated features tighten the axi5→axi5 cell: they *require* it.

19 Unmapped-Address Handling

19.1 Overview

19.1.1 Why the bridge answers an address no slave owns

A positively-decoded fabric answers only addresses that fall inside some slave's range. An address in none of them selects nothing: the one-hot select is all-zero, no slave sees `AWVALID`/`ARVALID`, `READY` never rises, and the master waits forever.

A hang is the worst failure available here, because it destroys the evidence. There is no response to inspect, no error bit to read, and the offending address is whatever the master still has latched. A stray pointer in software becomes a wedged interconnect with nothing to point at the cause.

The bridge therefore ends its decode chain in an `else` – subtractive decode – and that `else` selects an internal slave that always answers.

19.2 Ports

19.2.1 Status, interrupt and clearing

The catch-all latches its status. Every bridge exposes:

Port	Dir	Meaning
`unmapped_irq`	out	**sticky**: set by the first unmapped access, held until cleared
`unmapped_addr[31:0]`	out	address of that **first** access
`unmapped_count[7:0]`	out	number of unmapped accesses, saturating at 255
`unmapped_clear`	in	pulse to clear the flag and the count

Three choices worth knowing about:

- **Sticky, not a pulse.** A one-cycle pulse is gone before software can look, and this is precisely the access nobody expected.
- **The first address wins.** A later fault does not overwrite it; the first one is usually what explains the rest.
- **The address survives the clear**, so a late reader still learns where the fault was after the flag is acknowledged. The count saturates rather than wrapping – “255+” is honest, a wrapped 3 is not.

19.3 Functional Description

19.3.1 Behaviour

Write	every W beat is accepted; one B per AW
Read	AxLEN+1 beats, RLAST on the last
Response	**DECERR** on both, always
Read data	0xDEADBEEF, replicated to the bus width

DECERR rather than SLVERR is the AXI4 code for “no slave at this address”: nothing failed to service the request, there was nothing there to service it. There is no OKAY mode and no parameter to select one – a mode switch here is where lint, simulation and synthesis end up disagreeing about what the fabric does.

The read data is a recognisable pattern rather than zeros because zeros are indistinguishable from real memory. 0xDEADBEEF in a dump is a fault; 0 is a plausible value.

Write data is discarded. There is nowhere for it to go, and inventing a destination would be worse than saying so.

19.3.2 Register access (cfg regblock builds)

Bridges built with the cfg register block also expose the status over the cfg **AXI4-Lite** window. The port is s_cfg_axil_* – AXI4-Lite, not APB. An APB-attached CPU reaches it through an axi4_to_apb4_shim upstream of the bridge, which is an integration choice and not part of this module:

Unmapped-address status registers

Register	Field	Access	Meaning
SUBTRACTIVE_STATUS	HIT[0]	RO	mirrors unmapped_irq
	CLEAR[1]	W	write 1 to clear the flag and count
	COUNT[15:8]	RO	mirrors unmapped_count
SUBTRACTIVE_ADDR	ADDR[31:0]	RO	mirrors unmapped_addr

The sticky state lives in the RTL, not in the register block: one owner for one piece of state, so the two cannot disagree about whether a fault happened. These registers are a window onto it plus a clear. Clearing works from either the `unmapped_clear` pin or a `CLEAR` write; neither disables the other.

These registers are appended **after** every pre-existing register, so adding them did not move any existing offset. That is deliberate: a register map is an ABI. An earlier attempt inserted per-slave configuration for the catch-all midway through the map, which renumbered everything after it, silently moved the monitor-enable bits, and left the monitors switched off while every functional test still passed.

19.3.3 When it can never fire

The catch-all is the `else` of the decode chain, so it is reachable only if the slave ranges leave a **gap**. A map that tiles the whole address space has no unmapped address to catch, and the `else` is unreachable logic that synthesis removes – it costs nothing and reports nothing.

Most shipped variants are in exactly that position. Of the 22 generated bridges, **18 tile the space completely** and 4 leave gaps. `bridge_2x2_rw` is typical of the first group: `ddr` takes `<= 0x7FFF_FFFF` and `sram` takes `>= 0x8000_0000`, between them the entire 32-bit range.

This is worth knowing before wiring `unmapped_irq` to anything: on a fully-tiled bridge it is tied low by construction, and a test that expects it to assert will wait forever. Check your own address map, not this table – it changes with the TOML.

The insurance is still worth having. A map is tiled *today*; the next slave added, or the next range narrowed, opens a gap, and the difference between “reports it” and “hangs the master” is decided at that moment rather than at integration time.

19.3.4 What this does not do

The catch-all does not make an unmapped access *correct*. It makes it **visible and survivable**: the master gets an error instead of stalling, and software gets an address instead of a puzzle. An address that reaches it is still a configuration or software fault.

19.4 Navigation

Previous: AXI5 and APB5 Interfaces

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

20 Wishbone B4 Interface

20.1 Overview

Wishbone B4 is the open bus of the FPGA world – the fabric OpenCores cores speak and the one most soft CPUs ship with. Since bridge TASK-008 (was BRIDGE-019) a bridge port can be Wishbone on either side: a **slave port** with `protocol = "wb4"` makes the bridge the Wishbone requester toward an external completer; a **master port** with `protocol = "wb4"` makes the bridge the completer for an external Wishbone requester. The fabric between stays AXI4.

The mode is **B4 pipelined** – a new STB every clock while STALL is low, in-order termination – which is what `rtl/amba/wb4` and the converters implement. B4 standard ("classic") mode exists in the converters as a parameter but is not selectable from the TOML; the two modes do not mix on one bus, so a classic peer needs a classic bridge build.

20.2 Ports

20.2.1 Signal Definition

Table 4.7: Wishbone B4 Signal Definitions

Signal	Width	Slave port (bridge requests)	Master port (bridge completes)	Description
CYC	1	Output	Input	Bus cycle in progress
STB	1	Output	Input	Transfer request
WE	1	Output	Input	1 = write, 0 = read
ADR	ADDR_WIDTH	Output	Input	Byte address (the fabric address, unwindowed)
DAT_W	DATA_WIDTH	Output	Input	Write data (the spec's DAT_O from the requester)
SEL	DATA_WIDTH/8	Output	Input	Byte lane select = AXI WSTRB
CTI	3	Output	Input	Burst hint (carried, not acted on; CLASSIC when the bridge drives it)
BTE	2	Output	Input	Burst type extension (LINEAR when the bridge drives it)
STALL	1	Input	Output	Pipelined back-pressure
ACK	1	Input	Output	Normal termination
ERR	1	Input	Output	Error termination
RTY	1	Input	Output	Retry termination (never driven by the bridge)
DAT_R	DATA_WIDTH	Input	Output	Read data (the spec's DAT_I at the requester)

20.2.2 Signal Naming

Wishbone ports use the TOML prefix followed by the uppercase B4 name, the convention `rtl/amba/wb4` and the RDS-DV BFMs share:

```
// Slave port, prefix "wbp_wb_" -- the bridge drives the bus
output logic        wbp_wb_CYC,
output logic        wbp_wb_STB,
output logic        wbp_wb_WE,
output logic [31:0] wbp_wb_ADR,
output logic [31:0] wbp_wb_DAT_W,
output logic [3:0]  wbp_wb_SEL,
output logic [2:0]  wbp_wb_CTI,
output logic [1:0]  wbp_wb_BTE,
input  logic        wbp_wb_STALL,
input  logic        wbp_wb_ACK,
input  logic        wbp_wb_ERR,
input  logic        wbp_wb_RTY,
input  logic [31:0] wbp_wb_DAT_R
```

A master port has the same thirteen with the directions reversed.

20.3 Functional Description

20.3.1 Slave port: AXI4 to Wishbone

`axi4_to_wb4` (converters MAS, chapter 3) sits in the slave adapter: the AXI4-Lite decomposers turn each AXI4 burst into one single-beat transfer per beat, and `axil4_to_wb4` turns those into Wishbone transfers, in order. `WSTRB` becomes `SEL`. Termination maps back as:

Table 4.8: Wishbone termination to AXI4 response

Wishbone	AXI4 response
ACK	OKAY
ERR	SLVERR
RTY	SLVERR (`RTY_RESP`; AXI has no retry)

The monitored (`mon`) variant places the `axi4_master_*_monlite` wrappers between the crossbar and the converter, exactly as for APB slave ports.

20.3.2 Master port: Wishbone to AXI4

`wb4_to_axi4` sits in the master adapter in front of the ordinary AXI4 timing wrapper: `wb4_to_axil4` merges AXI's two response channels back into Wishbone's single in-order termination stream, and the wrapper promotes the AXI4-Lite face to AXI4 (`AxLEN = 0`, full-width `AxSIZE`, INCR, `WLAST = 1`, a constant ID – the fabric prepends the master index, bridge TASK-005 (was BRIDGE-016)). From the wrapper on, the port is an AXI4-Lite-shaped single-beat requester: decode, the width converters, the wide-slave aligner toward wider slaves and the response mux are the ones every other master uses. `SLVERR` and `DECERR` both terminate `ERR` – an unmapped address (the subtractive slave) is indistinguishable from a failing completer on this bus. `RTY` is never generated.

20.3.3 Rules the validator enforces

- `channels = "rw"` (one bus carries both directions), `id_width = 0`.
- `data_width` is 8, 16, 32 or 64.
- A master port has `addr_width = 32`: `ADR` is the full fabric address, where an APB or Wishbone *slave* port's address is whatever the fabric forwards for its window.

20.4 Design Notes

- **In-order by construction.** Wishbone terminates in issue order and the bridge's slave-side tracking is in-order for shim-converted slaves, so a Wishbone completer never needs the CAM. Two masters sharing a Wishbone completer are serialised by the crossbar's arbitration and answered in that order.
- **One transfer per beat.** A 16-beat AXI4 burst is sixteen Wishbone transfers; the pipelined bus takes one per clock when the completer does not stall, so the cost is latency, not bandwidth.
- **Burst hints are not generated.** `CTI`/`BTE` are CLASSIC/LINEAR on a slave port; a Wishbone completer that needs registered-feedback bursts to perform will not see them from the bridge.
- **Best effort, by decision (2026-09-13).** The Wishbone ports are spec-legal and regress green, and that is the accepted state: forming pipelined Wishbone bursts from AXI bursts and putting a Wishbone slave in its own clock domain (`cdc` is AXI4-only) are not owed. They cost only Wishbone throughput nobody has asked for; a consumer that needs either files a task against that need.

Verified by `dv/tests/test_bridge_2x2_wb4_paths.py` on `bridge_2x2_wb4` (error folding both ways, SEL lanes at both a Wishbone and a 64-bit AXI4 completer, burst decomposition, both requesters in flight at the Wishbone completer) plus the generated tests of that fixture.

21 Throughput Characteristics

21.1 Overview

What the fabric can move when everything goes right, and what eats into that number when it doesn’t. The short version: bursts and matched widths win; conversions and contention cost you.

21.2 Functional Description

21.2.1 Peak Throughput

One master driving one slave — no contention, no conversion:

Table 5.1: Peak Throughput by Data Width

Data Width	Frequency	Peak Throughput
32-bit	100 MHz	400 MB/s
64-bit	100 MHz	800 MB/s
128-bit	100 MHz	1.6 GB/s
256-bit	100 MHz	3.2 GB/s
512-bit	100 MHz	6.4 GB/s

21.2.2 Formula

```
Peak Throughput = DATA_WIDTH (bits) × Frequency (Hz) / 8 bytes/bit
```

21.2.3 Measured (2026-09-11)

`bridge_2x2_rw` (two 32-bit AXI4 masters, two 32-bit AXI4 slaves, no width or protocol conversion), 16-beat INCR bursts, every BFM channel back-to-back, each figure computed over its own window from the first to the last beat at the port named. `test_bridge_2x2_rw_perf` asserts a floor under every row, so a change that costs bandwidth fails there instead of ageing this table.

Table 5.1a: Measured throughput, direct 32-bit AXI4 paths

Traffic	Where measured	Beats / cycle	Notes
One master streaming reads	R at the master port	**1.00**	128 bursts, 2048 beats in 2048 cycles
One master streaming writes	W at the slave port	**0.89-0.90**	0 cycles of WREADY low at the master port: the ~2-cycle gap per burst is the requester re-arming W between bursts, not the fabric
Two masters	W at the shared	**1.00**	the port stays full;

Traffic	Where measured	Beats / cycle	Notes
streaming writes to one slave	slave port		the other master's beats fill the gaps above
– per-master share of the contended window	W at each master port	**0.499 / 0.501**	128 bursts each (0.475 / 0.525 at 8 bursts: round-robin, window-length effects only)
Two masters to two different slaves	W at both slave ports	**1.78-1.80**	two independent paths; neither slows the other

So the formula above holds for this fabric: a saturated port moves one beat per cycle, two masters on one port split it evenly, and paths to different slaves do not share anything. The write-stream row is the requester's figure, not the bridge's – the contention row is the bridge's.

The current performance tests measure throughput floors under uniform-style patterns; a full saturation study (accepted traffic vs. applied load, latency vs. offered load) is tracked as bridge vault TASK-014.

21.2.4 Factors Affecting Throughput

Table 5.2: Factors Affecting Throughput

Factor	Impact	Mitigation
Arbitration contention	Reduces per-master throughput	Increase slave ports
Width conversion	UNVERIFIED – see note	Match widths where possible
Protocol conversion	2+ cycles for APB	Use AXI4 for high-bandwidth
Response routing	Minimal (pipelined)	N/A

> **The width-conversion figure is not measured.** "1-cycle penalty per direction" has no source: the converters (`axi_data_upsize`, `axi_data_dnsize`, `axi4_dwidth_converter_{rd,wr}`) decompose or combine beats, so the cost depends on the width RATIO and the burst length, and a single constant cannot be right for 256b->32b and 64b->32b alike.

It is left marked rather than replaced with a guess. Measuring it needs a propagation measurement on a converted path in `bridge_4x4_rw` (gpu 256b -> periph 32b) against a matched one (cpu 64b -> ddr0 64b), in the style of `test_bridge_2x2_rw_latency`. An attempt at that test could not reliably observe the master-side reference and was withdrawn rather than committed half-working.

21.2.5 Multi-Master Scaling

With fair round-robin arbitration (measured above: 0.499 / 0.501 at the shared port; the sum stays at one beat per cycle):

```
Per-Master Throughput = Peak Throughput / Active Masters (to same
slave)
```

21.2.5.1 Example: 4 Masters, 2 Slaves

```
All 4 masters accessing Slave 0:
  Per-master = Peak / 4

2 masters to Slave 0, 2 masters to Slave 1:
  Per-master = Peak / 2 (full parallelism)
```

21.2.6 Burst Efficiency

Table 5.3: Burst Efficiency Comparison

Transaction Type	Overhead	Efficiency
Single beat	1 cycle address + 1 cycle data	50%
4-beat burst	1 cycle address + 4 cycle data	80%
16-beat burst	1 cycle address + 16 cycle data	94%
256-beat burst	1 cycle address + 256 cycle data	99.6%

21.2.7 Width Conversion Impact

21.2.7.1 Upsize (Narrow to Wide)

```
64-bit to 512-bit (8:1 ratio):
  Input: 8 beats × 64 bits = 512 bits
  Output: 1 beat × 512 bits = 512 bits
```

```
Throughput: Preserved (same data, fewer beats)
Latency: +1 cycle (packing delay)
```

21.2.7.2 Downsize (Wide to Narrow)

```
512-bit to 64-bit (8:1 ratio):
  Input: 1 beat × 512 bits = 512 bits
  Output: 8 beats × 64 bits = 512 bits

Throughput: Preserved (same data, more beats)
Latency: +7 cycles (sequential output)
```

21.2.8 Protocol Conversion Impact

Table 5.4: AXI4 vs APB Protocol Impact

Metric	AXI4 Direct	AXI4 to APB
Min cycles/transfer	1	2
Burst support	Yes	No (split)
Pipeline depth	1+	1
Peak throughput	DATA_WIDTH/cycle	DATA_WIDTH/2 cycles

21.3 Design Notes

Bursts buy you efficiency:

- Use bursts whenever possible
- AXI4 supports up to 256 beats per burst
- APB does not support bursts (split internally)

And protocol choice matters more than most people expect:

- Keep high-bandwidth traffic on AXI4 paths
- Use APB only for low-bandwidth peripherals
- Group APB slaves to avoid impacting AXI4 traffic

21.4 References

- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — the standard network-evaluation methodology plots accepted traffic vs. applied load and latency vs. applied load, normalized to network capacity (ch9). (Reference archive)
- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — uniform-random traffic is benign; permutation, hot-spot, and adversarial patterns are the stresses that reveal allocation limits (ch3 §3.2-3.3). (Reference archive)

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

22 Latency Analysis

22.1 Overview

Where the cycles go on the way through the bridge: address path, data path, response path, then the end-to-end best cases and the conversion costs. The headline numbers for a direct AXI4 path are measured, not estimated — the note after Table 5.7 explains how, and why an earlier version of that table was wrong.

The current latency measurements are best-case and lightly-loaded figures; a full latency-vs-offered-load sweep to find the saturation knee is tracked as bridge vault TASK-014.

22.2 Timing

22.2.1 Address Path Latency

Table 5.5: Address Path Latency

Stage	Cycles	Notes
Master Adapter (skid)	1	Pipeline registration
Address Decode	0	Combinational
Arbitration	0-1	0 if no contention, 1 if arbitrate
Slave Router	1	Pipeline registration
Total Address	**2-3**	Best/worst case

22.2.2 Data Path Latency

Table 5.6: Data Path Latency

Stage	Cycles	Notes
W follows AW	0	Same grant
Width conversion	0-1	0 if match, 1 if convert
Protocol conversion	0-2+	0 for AXI4, 2+ for APB
Total Data	**0-3+**	Best/worst case

22.2.3 Response Path Latency

Table 5.7: Response Path Latency

Stage	Cycles	Notes
Slave response	Variable	Slave-dependent
ID extraction	0	Combinational – routing is by FIFO position, no lookup
Response routing + master delivery	2	Registered; NOT a direct connection
Total Response	**2 + slave**	Plus slave latency

Measured. `bridge_2x2_rw`, cpu master to ddr slave, idle bridge:

Path	Cycles
AW accepted at the master -> AWVALID at the slave port	**2**
B accepted at the slave port -> BVALID at the master	**2**

Two skid stages each way: the master adapter's `axi4_slave_wr` AW skid, then the slave adapter's `axi4_master_wr` AW skid. The response path has the same structure, which is why the two figures match.

The response row previously read "Master delivery 0 (Direct connection)", total 1. It is registered, and the figure is 2.

What this measures, and what an earlier revision of this note got wrong. These are PROPAGATION times – how long a beat takes to appear on the far side. An earlier revision quoted 4 cycles for the request path, measured accept-to-accept. That metric also counts however long the far side held READY low, so it describes the attached slave's timing as much as the bridge's, and it was not even stable: successive runs gave 4/2 and then 2/6. Propagation is 2/2 on every run.

`test_bridge_2x2_rw_latency` asserts both values EXACTLY, so adding or removing a pipeline stage fails the test rather than silently ageing this table.

Other configurations differ – width converters and the APB/AXIL shims add stages – so this is the figure for a direct AXI4 path, not a universal constant.

With the registered crossbar (`[bridge] xbar_pipeline = true`, bridge TASK-006 (was BRIDGE-017)) both figures are **3**: one skid stage each way inside the xbar. `test_bridge_2x2_rw_pipe_latency` asserts 3/3 on `bridge_2x2_rw_pipe` exactly as the baseline test asserts 2/2, and `test_bridge_2x2_rw_perf` runs its four phases on both fixtures with the same floors – the stage costs a cycle of latency and no bandwidth.

22.2.4 Loaded Write Latency (measured)

`test_bridge_2x2_rw_perf` streams 16-beat write bursts from one master and pairs the k-th AW accepted at the master port with the k-th BVALID there:

Table 5.7a: Write latency under load, `bridge_2x2_rw`, 32-bit direct path

Queue	AW accepted -> BVALID (cycles)
First burst, fabric empty	**23** = 16 W beats + the 2 + 2 skid stages + the slave's turnaround
k bursts queued ahead	about 16 k + 7; maximum 323 at a 20-deep queue

The queue exists because the bridge accepts AWs ahead of their W data – the master adapter's AW skid, the slave adapter's 16-entry response-tracking FIFO and its AW skid together hold about 20 bursts – so a requester that issues many AWs before its data sees its B responses spaced by the data time, not by the fabric. Read latency does not queue the same way: the R stream is one beat per cycle end to end (Table 5.1a).

22.2.5 End-to-End Latency

22.2.5.1 Write Transaction (Best Case)

```
Cycle 0: AW arrives at Bridge
Cycle 1: AW exits to Slave (skid buffer)
Cycle 2: Slave receives AW
Cycle 1: W arrives (same cycle as AW skid)
Cycle 2: W exits to Slave
Cycle 3: Slave receives W, generates B
Cycle 4: B routed back to Master

Total: 4 cycles (minimum)
```

22.2.5.2 Read Transaction (Best Case)

```
Cycle 0: AR arrives at Bridge
Cycle 1: AR exits to Slave (skid buffer)
Cycle 2: Slave receives AR, generates R
Cycle 3: R routed back to Master

Total: 3 cycles (minimum)
```

22.2.5.3 Contention Latency

When multiple masters contend for same slave:

```
Arbitration adds 1 cycle per contending master

Example: 4 masters requesting same slave
  Worst case: Wait for 3 other masters = 3 extra cycles
  Average case: Wait for 1.5 masters = 1-2 extra cycles
```

22.2.6 Width Conversion Latency

22.2.6.1 Upsize Latency

Table 5.8: Upsize Latency by Ratio

Ratio	Extra Cycles	Notes
1:1	0	No conversion
2:1	0	Pack on fly
4:1	0	Pack on fly
8:1	0-1	May need accumulation

22.2.6.2 Downsize Latency

Table 5.9: Downsize Latency by Ratio

Ratio	Extra Cycles	Notes
1:1	0	No conversion
1:2	+1	2 output beats
1:4	+3	4 output beats
1:8	+7	8 output beats

22.2.7 Protocol Conversion Latency

Table 5.10: AXI4 to APB Conversion Latency

Phase	Cycles
AXI4 AW decode	1
APB setup	1
APB access	1+ (PREADY)
B generation	1
Total	**4+ cycles**

22.2.7.1 APB Wait States

APB slaves may insert wait states:

```
PREADY deasserted: +1 cycle per wait
Typical UART/GPIO: 0-2 wait states
Slow peripherals: May have many wait states
```

22.3 Design Notes

22.3.1 Design Recommendations

1. **Match data widths** - Avoid conversion latency
2. **Use AXI4 for fast paths** - Avoid APB latency
3. **Minimize contention** - Spread traffic across slaves
4. **Use bursts** - Amortize address latency
5. **Pipeline responses** - Don't block on slow slaves

22.4 References

- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — accepted traffic vs. applied load and latency vs. applied load are the standard evaluation plots for finding the saturation point (ch9). (Reference archive)
- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — uniform-random traffic is benign; permutation and hot-spot patterns expose the allocation limits that matter for worst-case latency (ch3 §3.2-3.3). (Reference archive)

23 Resources

23.1 Overview

What a generated bridge costs on an FPGA, measured. The numbers below come from the out-of-context synthesis and implementation flow in `projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/fpga/` (HAS 6.4: how it constrains the bridge, how to repeat a run, how to read a line of `reports/summary.csv`), on the two parts this repository's boards carry. Earlier revisions of this page carried hand estimates per component and per configuration; they did not reconcile with each other and had never been checked against a synthesis report, so they are gone. Anything not in the tables below is a configuration nobody has synthesized yet, and the flow takes minutes to answer for it.

23.2 Measured Utilization and Timing

Table 5.11: Measured utilization and timing, Artix-7 100T -1 at 10 ns (HAS 6.4 flow)

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
bridge_2x2_axi5	4,441	3,325	0	+0.40	104.2	8
bridge_2x2_axi5_native	8,007	6,213	0	+0.04	100.4	12
bridge_2x2_rw	4,615	3,253	0	+0.12	101.2	9
bridge_2x2_rw_cdc	4,851	3,413	0	+0.27	102.7	9
bridge_2x2_rw_pipe	5,646	4,227	0	+1.27	114.6	6
bridge_2x2_rw_qos	5,136	3,317	0	-2.91	77.4	14
bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe	5,494	4,291	0	+0.17	101.7	9
bridge_4x4_rw	30,278	29,508	0	-1.57	86.4	14
bridge_5x3_channels	19,243	16,932	0	-2.66	79.0	16
bridge_mix_a	6,456	5,697	0	-0.29	97.1	16

Table 5.12: Measured utilization and timing, Kintex-7 325T -2 at 6.667 ns

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
bridge	4,430	3,325	0	+0.69	167.4	9

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
`_2x2_axi5`						
`bridge_2x2_axi5_native`	7,969	6,213	0	+0.26	156.1	12
`bridge_2x2_rw`	4,612	3,253	0	+0.97	175.6	9
`bridge_2x2_rw_cdc`	4,842	3,413	0	+0.55	163.4	9
`bridge_2x2_rw_pipe`	5,647	4,227	0	+1.73	202.6	6
`bridge_2x2_rw_qos`	4,963	3,317	0	-0.18	146.0	13
`bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe`	5,475	4,291	0	+0.70	167.6	9
`bridge_4x4_rw`	29,719	29,508	0	+0.28	156.5	13
`bridge_5x3_channels`	19,035	16,932	0	-0.13	147.1	17
`bridge_mix_a`	6,375	5,697	0	+0.53	162.9	8

Fmax is an estimate from the register-to-register slack at the constrained period; the I/O budget and the reading of each row are in HAS 6.4. The rows that miss on the Artix-7 all fail on one path – master adapter, crossbar arbitration and mux, slave CAM allocate – and `xbar_pipeline` is the register that splits it: `bridge_2x2_rw_qos` at -2.91 ns becomes `bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe` at +0.17 ns.

23.2.1 Scaling

Table 5.13: Resource Scaling

Component	Scales with
Crossbar core	O(M x N) muxing, plus one arbiter per slave channel
Master adapters	O(M), each holding a full beat per channel in its skid buffers
Slave adapters	O(N), plus a converter and its monitor sandwich for every non-AXI4 or width-stepped port
bridge_id FIFOs	O(N x depth), small LUT arrays, no BRAM
Registered crossbar (`xbar_pipeline`)	one 2-deep skid per slave-side channel
CDC slave port (`cdc`)	one async FIFO per channel of that port

Block RAM and DSP usage are zero in every configuration measured: the per-slave bridge_id FIFOs and the CAM are LUT arrays, and there is no arithmetic.

The current resource figures come from a small set of configurations driven with uniform-style traffic; a systematic resource-vs-load characterization across adversarial patterns is tracked as bridge vault TASK-014.

23.3 Design Notes

23.3.1 Resource Reduction

1. **Use channel-specific masters** - a read-only or write-only master builds half the adapter and half the crossbar columns
2. **Match data widths** - a width step costs a converter each way
3. **Use APB and AXI-Lite slaves sparingly** - each carries a shim and a second monitor
4. **Limit outstanding transactions** - shallower per-slave bridge_id FIFOs

23.3.2 Performance/Resource Trade-off

Table 5.14: Performance/Resource Trade-offs

Feature	Resource Impact	Performance Impact
Deeper skid buffers	+registers	+timing margin
Deeper bridge_id FIFOs	+LUTs	+outstanding depth (no OOO support)
Pipeline stages	+registers	+frequency
Wider data paths	+routing	+throughput

23.4 References

- Duato/Yalamanchili/Lionel, *Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2003 — accepted traffic vs. applied load and latency vs. applied load are the standard network-evaluation plots; resource counts must be paired with those load sweeps to be meaningful (ch9). (Reference archive)
- Dally & Towles, *Principles and Practices of Interconnection Networks*, Morgan Kaufmann 2004 — uniform-random traffic is benign; permutation and hot-spot patterns are the standard stresses that reveal allocation and buffer-sizing limits which in turn drive resource growth (ch3 §3.2-3.3). (Reference archive)

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

---

24 System Requirements

24.1 Overview

Everything your system owes the bridge before it will do its job: one clean clock, an asynchronous active-low reset, a single power domain, interfaces that follow the AXI4 rules, and an address map with no overlaps. Gaps in the map are allowed — the bridge answers those addresses itself — and the checklist at the end tells you how to prove all of it.

24.1.1 Clock Infrastructure

Table 6.1: Clock Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Clock source	One fabric clock (`aclk`) for the fabric and every master port; a `cdc = true` AXI4 slave port brings its own `<slave>_aclk` (HAS 4.5a)
Clock quality	Low jitter, stable frequency
Clock distribution	Must reach all Bridge ports

24.1.2 Reset Infrastructure

Table 6.2: Reset Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Reset type	Asynchronous, active-low (aresetn)
Reset synchronization	External synchronizer recommended
Reset distribution	Must reach all Bridge ports

24.1.3 Power

Table 6.3: Power Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Power domains	Single domain (no power gating)
Voltage	FPGA/ASIC process-dependent

24.2 Parameters

24.2.1 Address Map

Table 6.4: Address Map Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Slave ranges	Must not overlap
Range alignment	Power-of-2 recommended
Coverage	Gaps are permitted: an address in no slave range is claimed by the internal subtractive slave and answered with DECERR (see 4.5). It is still a fault – it is reported, not tolerated.

24.2.2 Connectivity

Table 6.5: Connectivity Requirements

Requirement	Specification
Matrix completeness	All masters must access at least one slave
Reachability	Consider traffic patterns for performance

24.3 Ports

24.3.1 Master Requirements

Masters connecting to Bridge must:

1. **Comply with AXI4 protocol** - Valid/ready handshake
2. **Use correct ID width** - Match configured ID_WIDTH
3. **Use correct data width** - Match configured DATA_WIDTH
4. **Use correct address width** - Match configured ADDR_WIDTH
5. **Stay within address range** - Target valid slave addresses

24.3.2 Slave Requirements

Slaves connecting to Bridge must:

1. **Comply with AXI4/APB protocol** - Based on configuration
2. **Accept the widened ID** - a slave sees `{master index, master id}`: the widest master's id_width plus `$clog2(NUM_MASTERS)` bits (none for a single master). Declare the slave's `id_width` at least that wide; the validator refuses less.
3. **Match configured data width** - Or use width conversion
4. **Respond to all transactions** - No hanging

24.4 Timing

24.4.1 Setup/Hold

Table 6.6: Timing Requirements

Constraint	Requirement
Input setup	Meet FPGA/ASIC requirements
Input hold	Meet FPGA/ASIC requirements
Clock-to-output	Per process characterization

24.4.2 Recommended Margins

Table 6.7: Recommended Timing Margins

Margin	Value	Purpose
Setup margin	10-20%	Variation tolerance
Hold margin	Positive	No hold violations
Clock uncertainty	Include in constraints	PLL/MMCM jitter

24.5 Testing

24.5.1 Pre-Integration Checks

1. **RTL lint clean** - No Verilator warnings
2. **Parameter validation** - All parameters in valid range
3. **Address map review** - no overlaps. Complete coverage is NOT required: a gap is claimed by the subtractive slave and answered with DECERR (4.5). Decide deliberately which you want – a gap that is meant to be a gap is fine, a gap you did not know about is a bug the fabric will now report.
4. **ID width calculation** - Sufficient for NUM_MASTERS

24.5.2 Integration Checks

1. **Signal connectivity** - All ports connected
2. **Width matching** - DATA_WIDTH, ADDR_WIDTH, ID_WIDTH
3. **Protocol matching** - AXI4 vs APB correctly configured
4. **Clock/reset connectivity** - All ports share same domain

24.5.3 Post-Integration Checks

1. **Basic transaction test** - Read/write to each slave
2. **Arbitration test** - Multi-master contention
3. **Error handling test** - unmapped-address response: DECERR + 0xDEADBEEF, `unmapped_irq` sticky, `SUBTRACTIVE_STATUS.CLEAR` clears it (see 4.5)
4. **Performance validation** - Meet throughput targets

24.6 Assumptions and Known Limitations

24.6.1 Response-Ordering Assumption

Bridge routes B and R by a sideband master index stored per slave. For an AXI4/AXI5 slave of a multi-master bridge (or any slave with `enable_ooo`) the store is `bridge_cam`, looked up by the returned BID/RID, so the slave may complete different IDs in any order (ARM IHI 0022E §A4). Every other slave – single-master bridges, AXI4-Lite/APB/Wishbone shim slaves and the internal subtractive slave – uses an in-order FIFO and must return responses in request order, which those slaves do by construction.

24.6.2 Buffer and CAM Depths

All adapter skid depths, response-tracking FIFO depths, and CAM dimensions are generation-time constants. There is no runtime sizing API. A systematic sizing rule that relates buffer depth to credit-loop latency, outstanding-transaction count, and width-converter buffering is tracked as bridge vault TASK-016.

24.7 References

- ARM, *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022E — AXI4 ordering rules allow out-of-order completion across IDs (§A4). (Reference archive)
- Maaref, *Architecting and Building High-Speed SoCs*, Packt 2022 — AMBA-suite context and the AXI ID ordering rules that Bridge's FIFO mode simplifies (ch3 §4.2). (Reference archive)
- Eschemann, *The FPGA Programming Handbook*, Packt 2023 — educational secondary source describing out-of-order reads as a normal AXI4 feature (ch8 §8.3). (Reference archive)

25 Parameter Configuration

25.1 Overview

Every bridge the generator emits starts here: port counts, bus widths, per-port configuration, and the address map. This chapter collects the full parameter set — the core knobs, the widths the generator derives from them, the per-port fields, the monitor options, and the checks the generator runs before it accepts your configuration.

25.2 Parameters

25.2.1 Core Parameters

Table 6.8: Bridge Core Parameters

Parameter	Type	Range	Default	Description
NUM_MASTERS	int	1-32	2	Number of master ports
NUM_SLAVES	int	1-256	2	Number of slave ports
ADDR_WIDTH	int	12-64	32	Address bus width
DATA_WIDTH	int	32-512	64	Data bus width
ID_WIDTH	int	1-16	4	Master ID width
USER_WIDTH	int	1-16	1	User signal width

25.2.2 Registered Crossbar (`xbar_pipeline`)

Table 6.8a: Crossbar options (bridge TASK-006, was BRIDGE-017)

TOML key (`[bridge]`)	Type	Default	Effect
`xbar_pipeline`	bool	`false`	`true` puts a 2-deep skid stage on every slave-side channel (AW, W, AR, B, R) inside the crossbar. Propagation 3/3 cycles instead of 2/2 (Table 5.7), throughput unchanged. For high-fanout or wide fabrics that

TOML key ([bridge])	Type	Default	Effect
			miss timing on the arbiter-plus-mux or the response OR-merge cone. Measured (HAS 6.4): the register that splits the arbitration-mux-CAM path; on the Artix-7 at 100 MHz any configuration beyond a plain 2x2 – QoS, wide ports, more masters – needs it.
`arbitration`	`"rr"` / `"qos"`	`"rr"`	Per-slave arbitration policy. `"qos"` grants the highest `AxQOS` plus aging (MAS 2.3, Per-Slave Request Arbitration); it decides among requests pending at the arbiter, so it shows at a slave that backpressures AW, not at one that accepts every AW on arrival; equals share round-robin.
`qos_aging_shift`	int 0..7	4	With `"qos"`: a

TOML key ([bridge])	Type	Default	Effect
			waiting request gains one priority level every `2**shift` cycles, so the worst wait for a QoS-0 request is `15 * 2**shift` cycles.

Table 6.8b: CDC slave port option (bridge TASK-006, was BRIDGE-017)

TOML key ([[bridge.slaves]])	Type	Default	Effect
`cdc`	bool	`false`	`true` gives this AXI4 slave port its own clock: `<name>_aclk` / `<name>_aresetn` on the top, `axi4_cdc_{wr,rd}` between the adapter's timing wrapper and the port (HAS 4.5a). Slave ports, `protocol = "axi4"` only.

Table 6.8c: Monitor preset

TOML key ([bridge])	Type	Default	Effect
`mon_preset`	`"lite"` (also accepted: `"error_only"` /	`"lite"`	Accepted for compatibility; since 2026-09-26

TOML key ([bridge])	Type	Default	Effect
	"functional" / "all" / "none")		every monitored port builds axi_monitor_lite through the *_monlite wrapper (error, timeout, completion and active-count threshold packets, same monbus, about a fifth of the full monitor's LUTs), so the cone presets no longer select hardware. Which packets a port emits is the runtime cfg_*_enable pins. To remove a monitor use use_monitor = false on the port or use_no_monitors = true on the bridge. mon_add / mon_remove are validated and ignored.

25.2.3 Derived Parameters

The generator works these out from the core set — you never write them yourself:

Table 6.9: Derived Parameters

Parameter	Formula	Example
BRIDGE_ID_WIDTH	clog2(NUM_MASTERS), minimum 1	4 masters = 2 bits
MASTER_ID_WIDTH	widest master `id_width`	4
ID_PREFIX_WIDTH	clog2(NUM_MASTERS), 0 for one master	4 masters = 2 bits
XBAR_ID_WIDTH	MASTER_ID_WIDTH + ID_PREFIX_WIDTH	4 + 2 = 6 bits
STRB_WIDTH	DATA_WIDTH / 8	64b = 8 strobes

`BRIDGE_ID_WIDTH` sizes the sideband master index stored in each slave adapter's response tracker. `XBAR_ID_WIDTH` is the AXI ID width inside the fabric and on every AXI slave port, because each master adapter widens its IDs to `{BRIDGE_ID, id}`; a slave's `id_width` must be at least this. All four are emitted into `<bridge>_pkg.sv`. There is no `TOTAL_ID_WIDTH`.

25.2.4 Per-Port Configuration

Each master and slave port carries its own field set in the configuration file.

25.2.4.1 Master Port Configuration

Table 6.10: Master Port Configuration

Field	Type	Description
name	string	Unique identifier
prefix	string	Signal prefix
channels	enum	"rw", "wr", or "rd"
data_width	int	Port data width
id_width	int	Port ID width
use_monitor	bool	Optional, defaults to `true`. Per-port monitor wrappers. Only meaningful on a `mon` variant; on a `no` variant there is nothing to disable.

25.2.4.2 Slave Port Configuration

Table 6.11: Slave Port Configuration

Field	Type	Description
name	string	Unique identifier
prefix	string	Signal prefix
protocol	enum	`axi4`, `axi5`, `axil`, `axil5`, `apb`, `apb5`, `wb4` – the exact values `config_validator.valid_protocols` accepts. Note `axil`, not `axi4lite`.
axi5_features	list	On an `axi5` port: any of `nsaid`, `trace`, `mpam`, `mecid`, `unique` (droppable), `chunking` (droppable, 128-bit ports), `wakeup` (AWAKEUP, not path sideband), `poison`, `atomic`, `mte` (connectivity-gated; `mte` 128-bit ports). On an `axil5` port: `user` only. Classes and rules in HAS 4.4.
data_width	int	Port data width
base_addr	hex	Base address (must be 4K-aligned)
addr_range	hex	Address range size (must be multiple of 4K)
use_monitor	bool	Optional, defaults to `true`. Per-port monitor wrappers. Only meaningful on a `mon` variant; on a `no` variant there is nothing to disable.

25.2.4.3 Slave Address Window Rules (MANDATORY)

Every slave must occupy a 4K-aligned address window that is a multiple of 4 KB:

```
Rule 1: Base Address Alignment
  base_addr & 0xFFF == 0x000

  Valid:   0x00000000, 0x00001000, 0x80000000, 0xFFFF0000
  Invalid: 0x00000001, 0x80000800, 0xC0000100

Rule 2: Range Alignment
  addr_range % 0x1000 == 0
```

```
  Valid:   0x1000 (4 KB), 0x2000 (8 KB), 0x10000 (64 KB)
  Invalid: 0x800 (2 KB), 0x1001, 0x7FFF

Rule 3: Non-Overlapping Windows
  All slaves must have non-overlapping address ranges

  Valid:   Slave0: 0x00000000-0x0FFFFFFF, Slave1: 0x10000000-
0x1FFFFFFF
  Invalid: Slave0: 0x00000000-0x10000000, Slave1: 0x0FFFFFFF-
0x1FFFFFFF
```

Why This Rule Exists:

- Real memory systems use 4K page boundaries (virtual memory, MMU)
- Linker scripts and memory maps assume 4K granularity
- Address decoders simplify to bit masks with 4K alignment
- Prevents ambiguity in address decode logic

There's nothing arbitrary about the 4K requirement — it's the granularity the rest of the system already assumes.

25.2.5 Top-Level Monitor Configuration

When monitor collection is desired, the bridge TOML configuration includes:

Field	Type	Description
variants	list	List of bridge variants to generate. Supported: `["no"]` (no monitor), `["mon"]` (monitor only), `["no", "mon"]` (both). Default: `["no"]`

25.2.5.1 Monitor Identifiers

Each monitored port gets a unique `(UNIT_ID, AGENT_ID)` pair for identification in monitor packets:

```
UNIT_ID Assignment:
  - UNIT_ID = 1: Master-side monitor wrappers
(axi4_master_{rd,wr}_monlite)
  - UNIT_ID = 2: Slave-side monitor wrappers
(axi4_slave_{rd,wr}_monlite)

AGENT_ID Assignment (per port):
  - AGENT_ID = (port_index << 4) | channel_bit
  - channel_bit: 0 = read channel (AR/R), 1 = write channel (AW/W/B)
```

```
  - Example: Master port 2, write direction → AGENT_ID = (2 << 4) | 1
= 0x21
```

25.2.5.2 AXIL→Wider-Slave Master-Side Alignment

When an AXI4-Lite master connects to a wider AXI4 slave through the bridge (e.g., 32-bit AXIL master to 64-bit AXI4 slave), the generator emits a master-side alignment converter (the `axil_to_axi4_wide_align_{rd,wr}` modules) between the master adapter and the crossbar core. The converter handles partial-word alignment on the narrow side while preserving AXIL's single-beat semantics; the protocol stays AXIL — protocol shims are a slave-boundary concern, applied separately.

25.2.6 Parameter Validation

25.2.6.1 Generator Checks

The generator checks every configuration against these rules:

Table 6.12: Generator Validation Checks

Check	Error Condition
NUM_MASTERS	< 1 or > 32
NUM_SLAVES	< 1 or > 256
DATA_WIDTH	Not power of 2
Address overlap	Slave ranges intersect
Connectivity	Master with no slaves
ID width	Insufficient for masters

25.2.6.2 Runtime Validation

Bridge includes optional assertions for:

- Address alignment
- Burst boundary crossing
- Protocol violations
- ID mismatch

25.3 Usage Example

A complete configuration is two parts: the TOML file that describes the bridge, and the CSV that describes the connectivity.

25.3.1 TOML Configuration

```
[bridge]
  name = "my_bridge"
  description = "Example bridge configuration"

  defaults.skid_depths = {ar = 2, r = 4, aw = 2, w = 4, b = 2}

  masters = [
    {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_m_axi", channels = "rw",
     id_width = 4, addr_width = 32, data_width = 64, user_width = 1},
    {name = "dma", prefix = "dma_m_axi", channels = "rw",
     id_width = 4, addr_width = 32, data_width = 256, user_width = 1}
  ]

  slaves = [
    {name = "ddr", prefix = "ddr_s_axi", protocol = "axi4",
     id_width = 6, addr_width = 32, data_width = 512, user_width = 1,
     base_addr = 0x80000000, addr_range = 0x40000000},
    {name = "uart", prefix = "uart_apb", protocol = "apb",
     addr_width = 12, data_width = 32,
     base_addr = 0x00000000, addr_range = 0x00001000}
  ]
```

25.3.2 CSV Connectivity

```
master\slave,ddr,uart
cpu,1,1
dma,1,0
```

Two configurations to use as starting points:

25.3.3 Simple 2x2

```
[bridge]
  name = "bridge_simple"
  masters = [
    {name = "m0", prefix = "m0_axi", data_width = 64},
    {name = "m1", prefix = "m1_axi", data_width = 64}
  ]
  slaves = [
    {name = "s0", prefix = "s0_axi", base_addr = 0x0, addr_range =
0x10000000},
    {name = "s1", prefix = "s1_axi", base_addr = 0x10000000,
```

```
addr_range = 0x10000000}
  ]
```

25.3.4 Mixed Protocol

```
[bridge]
  name = "bridge_mixed"
  masters = [
    {name = "cpu", prefix = "cpu_axi", data_width = 64, channels =
"rw"}
  ]
  slaves = [
    {name = "mem",  prefix = "mem_axi",  protocol = "axi4", data_width
= 512,
     base_addr = 0x00000000, addr_range = 0x80000000},
    {name = "gpio", prefix = "gpio_apb", protocol = "apb",  data_width
= 32,
     base_addr = 0x80000000, addr_range = 0x00010000},
    {name = "uart", prefix = "uart_apb", protocol = "apb",  data_width
= 32,
     base_addr = 0x80010000, addr_range = 0x00010000}
  ]
```


---

26 Verification Strategy

26.1 Overview

Bridge gets verified at three levels — unit, integration, and system — and all of it runs on CocoTB with protocol BFMs doing the driving. This chapter lays out the test infrastructure, the execution model, the coverage targets, the debug hooks, and the regression schedule, then closes with the gaps we know about.

26.2 Testing

26.2.1 Verification Levels

26.2.1.1 Unit Level

Test individual Bridge components:

Table 6.13: Unit Level Test Focus

Component	Test Focus
Master Adapter	Skid buffer, sideband bridge_id (IDs pass through)
Slave Router	Address decode, arbitration
Width Converter	Upsize/downsize correctness
Protocol Converter	AXI4 to APB timing
Response Router	ID extraction, routing

26.2.1.2 Integration Level

Test complete Bridge functionality:

Table 6.14: Integration Test Coverage

Test Category	Coverage
Address routing	All master-slave paths
Arbitration	Contention, fairness
ID tracking	Response routing
Error handling	OOR, timeouts
Performance	Throughput, latency

26.2.1.3 System Level

Test Bridge in target system:

Table 6.15: System Level Tests

Test Category	Focus
End-to-end	CPU to memory
Multi-master	DMA + CPU
Mixed protocol	AXI4 + APB
Stress	Maximum traffic

Test Category	Focus

26.2.2 Test Infrastructure

26.2.2.1 CocoTB Framework with Protocol-BFM-Only Driving

Bridge verification runs on CocoTB with protocol BFMs only: **all test stimulus is driven through protocol BFMs (AXI4Master, AXI4Slave, etc.) with no direct DUT signal manipulation**. Each slave port is backed by an in-memory model (`MemoryModel`), and checking is assertion-based (readback matches write) rather than routing-based.

```
from CocoTBFramework.components.axi4 import AXI4Master, AXI4Slave
from TBClasses.shared.tbbase import TBBase

class BridgeTB(TBBase):
    def __init__(self, dut):
        super().__init__(dut)
        self.masters = [AXI4Master(dut, dut.aclk, f"m{i}_axi") for i
in range(NUM_MASTERS)]
        self.slaves = [MemoryModel(dut, dut.aclk, f"s{i}_axi") for i
in range(NUM_SLAVES)]

@cocotb.test()
async def cocotb_test_basic_write(dut):
    tb = BridgeTB(dut)
    await tb.setup_clocks_and_reset()

    # Write transaction via BFM only
    await tb.masters[0].write(addr=0x1000, data=0xDEADBEEF)

    # Verify: readback matches write (memory-model assertion)
    readback = await tb.masters[0].read(addr=0x1000)
    assert readback == 0xDEADBEEF
```

26.2.2.2 Test Categories

Table 6.16: Test Categories

Category	Description	Example
Basic	Single transactions	Read/write
Burst	Multi-beat transactions	16-beat burst
Concurrent	Multiple masters active	M0 + M1
Boundary Probe	Address window edges	Top/mid/bottom of each slave page

Category	Description	Example
Stress	Maximum utilization	Back-to-back
Error	Error conditions	SLVERR injection, timeout
Monitor	Monitor packet collection	Packet capture, IRQ assertion

26.2.3 Test Execution Model

26.2.3.1 Serial Execution

Bridge tests run **serially only** (no parallel execution via pytest-xdist). Each test function is named per-module to avoid cross-test cocotb function name pollution:

```
# Naming convention: test_bridge_{N}x{M}_{variant}_{scenario}
def test_bridge_1x2_rd_basic(request):        # Test name indicates 1
master, 2 slaves, read-only
def test_bridge_1x2_rd_monitor_smoke(request): # Monitor test on 1x2
def test_bridge_4x4_rw_concurrent(request):    # Concurrent test on
4x4
```

Cocotb test functions inside each file follow the same naming pattern but with `cocotb_test_*` prefix to avoid pytest collection conflicts.

26.2.3.2 Boundary Probe Testing

Address-window boundary testing probes the **top, middle, and bottom** of each slave's address window to catch address-decode logic errors at window edges:

```
for slave_idx, (base, window_size) in enumerate(slave_windows):
    # Probe bottom (base address)
    await master.write(base + 0x000, data)

    # Probe middle (arbitrary address within window)
    await master.write(base + window_size // 2, data)

    # Probe top (base + window_size - 1)
    await master.write(base + window_size - 1, data)
```

26.2.4 Coverage Goals

26.2.4.1 Functional Coverage

Table 6.17: Functional Coverage Goals

Category	Target
Address paths	100% master-slave

Category	Target
	combinations via boundary probes
Transaction types	Read, write, burst, error (SLVERR)
Monitor modes	Enabled and disabled
ID values	Full ID range (representative)

26.2.4.2 Code Coverage

Table 6.18: Code Coverage Goals

Metric	Target
Line coverage	>95%
Branch coverage	>90%
FSM coverage	100% state transitions
Toggle coverage	>80% signals

26.2.5 Debug Features

26.2.5.1 Waveform Capture

Bridge tests support VCD/FST waveform dumps:

```
pytest test_bridge.py --vcd=waves.vcd
gtkwave waves.vcd
```

26.2.5.2 Debug Signals

Bridge includes optional debug signals:

Table 6.19: Debug Signals

Signal	Description
dbg_aw_grant	Current AW grant
dbg_ar_grant	Current AR grant
dbg_outstanding	Outstanding transaction count
dbg_state	FSM states

26.2.6 Regression Testing

26.2.6.1 Continuous Integration

Table 6.20: CI Test Schedule

Stage	Tests	Frequency
Pre-commit	Basic sanity	Each commit
Nightly	Full regression	Daily
Weekly	Performance	Weekly

26.2.6.2 Test Matrix

Table 6.21: Configuration Test Matrix

Config	Data Width	Protocol	Tested
2x2	64	AXI4	Yes
4x4	64	AXI4	Yes
4x4	256	AXI4	Yes
2x2	64	AXI4+APB	Yes
RAPIDS	512	AXI4+APB	Yes

26.2.7 Known Limitations

26.2.7.1 Test Gaps

Table 6.22: Known Test Gaps

Gap	Status	Plan
APB burst stress	Partial	Phase 3
Width downsize stress	Partial	Planned
32-master config	Not tested	Low priority

26.2.7.2 Simulator Support

Table 6.23: Simulator Support Status

Simulator	Status
Verilator	Fully supported
Icarus Verilog	Supported
Commercial (VCS, Questa)	Not tested

RTL Design Sherpa · Learning Hardware Design Through Practice GitHub · Documentation Index · MIT License

27 Synthesis and Implementation

27.1 Overview

Everything before this page is about what a generated bridge does. This page is about what it costs and how fast it closes, measured rather than estimated: a worked Vivado flow that takes any generated bridge through synthesis, placement and routing as a stand-alone block, the numbers it produced for a reference set of configurations on the two parts this repository's boards carry, and how to read and repeat them. Chapter 5.3 carries the resource tables; this chapter is the flow behind them.

27.2 The Flow

27.2.1 Where it lives

`projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/fpga/` is an FPGA build directory in the repository's standard shape (handbook `fpga/cmn-infra/build-flows`): a Makefile of variables that includes `make/fpga_flow.mk`, a `tcl/` directory the flow discovers, and `reports/`. It builds no bitstream. Its one script, `synth_only.tcl`, is a non-project batch run: read the bridge's filelist closure, synthesize the bridge as the top with no pins (Vivado's out-of-context mode), constrain its clocks, place and route, and write reports.

Table 6.24: Synthesis flow knobs

Knob	Default	Meaning
BRIDGE	bridge_2x2_rw	any generated fixture; the top module and the filelist follow from the name
PART	xc7a100tcsg324-1	the Artix-7 on the Nexys A7; xc7k325tffg900-2 is the Kintex-7 on the Genesys 2
CLK_NS	10.0	the period every clock is constrained to

```
cd projects/components/fabric-gen-ip/bridge/fpga
make lint  BRIDGE=bridge_2x2_rw_cdc                # verilator on the same closure, seconds
make synth BRIDGE=bridge_2x2_rw                    # one run, a few minutes
make synth BRIDGE=bridge_4x4_rw PART=xc7k325tffg900-2 CLK_NS=6.667
bin/synth_sweep.sh                                 # the reference set, both parts
bin/summary_table.py                               # reports/summary.csv as the tables below
```

Each run leaves `reports/<bridge>__<part>/` (utilization after synthesis and after routing, a per-instance utilization breakdown, the timing summary, the twenty worst paths overall and register-to-register, the clock-interaction and CDC reports, and a `summary.txt`) and appends one line to `reports/summary.csv`. Two bridges, or one bridge on two parts, never overwrite each other. The flow's build lock serializes Vivado runs in the directory, so the sweep is deliberately one run at a time.

27.2.2 How the bridge is constrained

The flow reads the constraints off the bridge's port list, so a new fixture needs nothing written by hand:

- **Clocks.** Every port whose name ends in `aclk` gets a clock of `CLK_NS`. A single-domain bridge gets one; a bridge with CDC slave ports (HAS 4.5a) gets one per domain, and the domains are declared asynchronous to each other, which is exactly how a system would constrain it. The crossing itself is then checked by the CDC report, not by setup analysis across it.
- **Resets.** Every `*aresetn` input is a false path. Reset is asynchronous on assertion in every generated build (MAS 6.1) and deassertion is synchronized outside the bridge.
- **Data I/O.** Inputs arrive, and outputs must be valid, 30% of the period into the cycle, against the clock of the port they belong to. This is the ordinary out-of-context convention for a block whose neighbours are registered; it is not a property of the bridge, which is why the register-to-register slack is reported on its own and is the figure the tables below quote.
- **Defines.** `XILINX` is set so `bridge_cam` takes its distributed-RAM attributes; Vivado sets `SYNTHESIS` itself, which removes the simulation-only checkers in the crossbar and subtractive adapter.

27.2.3 Reading the summary line

Table 6.25: `summary.csv` columns

Column	What it is
`luts`, `ffs`, `bram_tiles`, `dsps`	post-route utilization of the whole bridge
`wns_ns`	worst setup slack over every path, I/O budget included
`wns_reg2reg_ns`	worst setup slack between registers inside the bridge
`fmax_reg2reg_mhz`	`1000 / (CLK_NS - wns_reg2reg_ns)`: the clock the internal paths would close at, estimated at this constraint
`worst_logic_levels`	LUT depth of the worst internal path
`unrouted_nets`	must be 0; anything else is a failed run, not a slow one

The Fmax column is an estimate at the period you constrained. Vivado stops optimizing a path once it has margin, so a bridge that shows +2 ns of slack at 10 ns is not guaranteed to close at 8 ns until you run it at 8 ns. The handbook's rule applies (`fpga/cmn-infra/timing-closure`): when a run does fail, look at the magnitude, the clock interaction and the logic levels, in that order, before touching the RTL.

27.3 Measured Results

27.3.1 What the first run found

The first bridge through this flow, `bridge_2x2_rw` on the Artix-7 at 10 ns, failed timing by 22 ns with every functional test green. The worst path ran from a master adapter's tracking pointer, through the crossbar's AR arbitration and mux, into the slave adapter's CAM: 40 LUT levels, a 32 ns data path, 83% of it routing. The CAM's Mode-2 allocate computed a newcomer's ordering count as the largest count among the entries with the same ID, written as a loop over the 16 entries, and that loop synthesized to sixteen chained comparators hanging off the arbitrated ARID (MAS 4.1). The counts of one ID are always `0..k-1`, so the value is the number of matching entries, a popcount; the entry to retire, the one match with count 0, is one-hot, so its index and stored master are OR reductions. With that change the same bridge meets 10 ns.

Table 6.26: The CAM ordering-count scan, before and after (2026-09-11)

`bridge_2x2_rw`, Artix-7 100T -1, 10 ns	Before	After
LUTs	5,824	4,615
FFs	3,253	3,253
WNS register-to-register (ns)	-22.27	+0.12
Worst logic levels	40	9
Fmax estimate (MHz)	31	101

No simulation, formal proof or lint had a view of this: the block was correct and its depth was invisible until synthesis. It is why the flow exists and why it runs in minutes.

27.3.2 The reference set

Ten generated fixtures cover the shapes the generator produces: the baseline 2x2, its registered-crossbar, QoS, QoS-plus-registered and CDC variants, a 4x4 with mixed widths, a shim-heavy mix, a 32-bit AXI5 pair, the 128-bit native-AXI5 2x2 with Memory Tagging and chunking on every port, and a 5x3 with channel-specific masters. Each is constrained at 100 MHz on the Artix-7 and 150 MHz on the Kintex-7, the clocks the Nexys A7 and Genesys 2 harnesses in this repository run their fabrics at. Every row has zero unrouted nets, zero block RAM and zero DSPs.

Table 6.27: Reference set on the Artix-7 100T -1 (Nexys A7), constrained at 10 ns

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
`bridge_2x2_a`	4,441	3,325	0	+0.40	104.2	8

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
xi5						
bridge_2x2_axi5_native	8,007	6,213	0	+0.04	100.4	12
bridge_2x2_rw	4,615	3,253	0	+0.12	101.2	9
bridge_2x2_rw_cdc	4,851	3,413	0	+0.27	102.7	9
bridge_2x2_rw_pipe	5,646	4,227	0	+1.27	114.6	6
bridge_2x2_rw_qos	5,136	3,317	0	-2.91	77.4	14
bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe	5,494	4,291	0	+0.17	101.7	9
bridge_4x4_rw	30,278	29,508	0	-1.57	86.4	14
bridge_5x3_channels	19,243	16,932	0	-2.66	79.0	16
bridge_mix_a	6,456	5,697	0	-0.29	97.1	16

Table 6.28: Reference set on the Kintex-7 325T -2 (Genesys 2), constrained at 6.667 ns

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
bridge_2x2_axi5	4,430	3,325	0	+0.69	167.4	9
bridge_2x2_a	7,969	6,213	0	+0.26	156.1	12

Bridge	LUTs	FFs	BRAM	WNS reg-to-reg (ns)	Fmax est. (MHz)	Worst logic levels
xi5_native						
bridge_2x2_rw	4,612	3,253	0	+0.97	175.6	9
bridge_2x2_rw_cdc	4,842	3,413	0	+0.55	163.4	9
bridge_2x2_rw_pipe	5,647	4,227	0	+1.73	202.6	6
bridge_2x2_rw_qos	4,963	3,317	0	-0.18	146.0	13
bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe	5,475	4,291	0	+0.70	167.6	9
bridge_4x4_rw	29,719	29,508	0	+0.28	156.5	13
bridge_5x3_channels	19,035	16,932	0	-0.13	147.1	17
bridge_mix_a	6,375	5,697	0	+0.53	162.9	8

27.3.3 Reading the rows

- **Every 2x2 without QoS meets both targets**, AXI5 and CDC variants included. The CDC port adds one clock domain and about 240 LUTs and 160 FFs for its five async FIFOs, and the crossing does not enter the fabric's critical path.
- **The registered crossbar is the timing option.** `xbar_pipeline` costs about 1,000 LUTs and 1,000 FFs on the 2x2 and cuts the worst path from 9 levels to 6, the only row with more than a nanosecond of margin on the Artix-7.
- **Every Artix-7 miss is the same path**: a master adapter's request register, through the crossbar's arbitration and address/ID mux, into the slave adapter's CAM allocate (the ID compare against every entry, then the popcount), with routing at 75-80% of the delay. QoS adds its priority

compare in series with the grant and misses 10 ns by 2.9 ns; the wide 4x4 and the 5x3 miss by 1.6 and 2.7 ns on the same shape; the shim mix by 0.3 ns. `bridge_2x2_rw_qos_pipe` is the demonstration: the same QoS arbiter behind the registered crossbar meets 10 ns with margin (-2.91 ns becomes +0.17 ns, 14 levels become 9). On the Artix-7 at 100 MHz, a configuration with more than two masters, wide ports or QoS should be generated with `xbar_pipeline = true`; on the Kintex-7 at 150 MHz only QoS-without-pipeline and the 5x3 fall short, by fractions of a nanosecond.

- **The native-AXI5 fabric costs its data width, not its features.** `bridge_2x2_axi5_native` is the 32-bit AXI5 pair at 128 bits with mte and chunking added on every port: 8,007 LUTs and 6,213 FFs against 4,441 and 3,325, and it meets both targets (+0.04 ns on the Artix-7, 12 levels). The tag and chunk fields are a few bits beside a 128-bit beat; the wider beat is the cost.
- **Width steps set the size.** The 4x4 with 32/64/128/256-bit ports is six times the 2x2 in both LUTs and FFs: every converter carries a full wide beat, in each direction, per path.
- **No block RAM, no DSPs, anywhere.** The CAM and the bridge-id FIFOs are LUT arrays; there is no arithmetic.

27.4 Design Notes

27.4.1 What moves the numbers

- **Data width** sets the register count almost linearly: every skid buffer and every crossbar stage holds a full beat.
- **Masters x slaves** sets the crossbar's mux width and the arbiter count; the master adapters and slave adapters scale with their own counts.
- **`xbar_pipeline`** adds one 2-deep skid per slave-side channel (MAS 2.3), paid in registers, and returns it as the shorter worst path.
- **Protocol shims and width converters** are the expensive ports: an APB or AXI-Lite slave carries a converter plus its own monitor sandwich, a width step carries a converter each way.
- **CDC slave ports** add one async FIFO per channel (HAS 4.5a); the cost is the FIFO storage, and the crossing does not enter the fabric's critical path.

27.4.2 Before a board build

Run this flow first. It takes minutes, it needs no constraints file, and it answers "does this configuration fit and close on this part" before a harness, a clock wizard and a pinout are wrapped around it.

28 AXI3 Integration

28.1 Boundary-Conversion Architecture

The bridge crossbar is AXI4 internally. An AXI3 port is therefore converted at the boundary, not natively carried through the fabric:

- **AXI3 slave port** (`protocol = "axi3"` on a slave): the crossbar's AXI4 master face drives `axi4_to_axi3`, whose AXI3 master face presents the external slave pins.
- **AXI3 master port** (`protocol = "axi3"` on a master): the external AXI3 master drives `axi3_to_axi4`, whose AXI4 slave face feeds the ordinary AXI4 master timing wrapper and the rest of the adapter.

Both converters require the AXI3 data width and the paired AXI4 width to match; any width adaptation is the bridge's internal `dwidth_converter` or `axil_to_axi4_wide_align` path *behind* the protocol converter, exactly as it is for native AXI4 ports.

28.2 Converter-Sourced Constraints

The bridge does not enforce AXI3 semantics itself — it instantiates the converters and relies on their contracts. The constraints below are taken from the converters MAS:

1. **No write-data interleaving across IDs.** `axi4_to_axi3_wr` stamps every AXI3 W beat with the current AWID and does not support interleaved W IDs; `axi3_to_axi4_wr` accepts only one outstanding write transaction at a time and asserts `ASSERT_A3_WID_STABLE` if `WID` changes mid-burst or differs from the active AWID. The upstream AXI3 master must keep W beats in transaction order.
2. **Egress bursts longer than 16 beats are chopped.** `axi4_to_axi3_rd` and `axi4_to_axi3_wr` split AXI4 bursts into sequential AXI3 bursts of up to 16 beats each; `INCR` and `FIXED` bursts are advanced/regenerated, while `WRAP` bursts longer than 16 beats are deferred (assertion-rejected).
3. **QoS and REGION are absent on AXI3 pins.** `axi4_to_axi3` drops them; `axi3_to_axi4` drives them to zero.
4. **Same-width converters only.** `AXI_DATA_WIDTH` must be identical on both sides; the bridge places its existing width-adaptation logic behind the converter when the external AXI3 width differs from a target slave width.
5. **Lock mapping per the ARM AXI3 encoding** (ARM IHI 0022: `00` normal, `01` exclusive, `10` locked), as fixed by bridge GitHub #98:
   - `axi4_to_axi3`: `1'b0 → 2'b00`, `1'b1 → 2'b01`.
   - `axi3_to_axi4`: `2'b01 → 1'b1`; `2'b00`, `2'b10` (locked — AXI4 dropped locked accesses), and the reserved `2'b11` → `1'b0`.

See converters MAS §3.15 *AXI4 to AXI3 Converter* (`15_axi4_to_axi3.md`) and §3.16 *AXI3 to AXI4 Converter* (`16_axi3_to_axi4.md`) for the full contracts.

28.3 Validation Evidence

The following generated configurations exercise AXI3 on both boundaries and pass the bridge GATE and FUNC regression suites:

- `bridge_1x2_axi3`
- `bridge_2x2_axi3_masters`
- `bridge_2x2_axi3_slaves`
- `bridge_mix_e`

28.3.1 Configuration constraints

The bridge validator enforces these AXI3-specific rules at configuration time:

- AXI3 port data widths must be one of {32, 64, 128, 256}.
- CDC on an AXI3 port is rejected in this version.
- AXI3 masters require `id_width > 0`.
- AXI3 slave `id_width` must be at least the fabric's master-index-prefixed width (the same rule that applies to AXI4 slaves).

28.4 References

- ARM, *AMBA 3 AXI Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022 — the AXI3 protocol authority; 4-bit `AxLEN`, 2-bit `AxLOCK`, write-data `WID`, absence of `QoS`/`REGION`. (Reference archive)
- ARM, *AMBA AXI and ACE Protocol Specification*, ARM IHI 0022E — the AXI4 protocol authority. (Reference archive)